



**LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY
RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE**

REO

RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE

RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL

JULY 26, 2023

PREPARED BY:

ALMA SONIA Q. SANCHEZ-DANDAY

DIRECTOR, RESEARCH ETHICS

DOCUMENT NO. REM 1.00	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME INTRODUCTION AND AUTHORIZATION	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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This Research Ethics Manual (REM) is authorized for use in Leyte Normal University (LNU). It describes the quality management system of LNU, specifically the scope for research ethics, which covers the academic, research, and support services provided by the University.

The REM covers the mechanisms of the Research Ethics Office in facilitating the ethics review of all research studies involving human participants conducted by the students (Integrated Laboratory School, Colleges, Graduate School), faculty members, and external clients who request for issuance of research ethical clearance. This quality system ensures that all functions meet the specified standards of performance through defined responsibilities, policies, and procedures to guide the Research Ethics Committee (REC) members, consultants, office staff, researchers, and other stakeholders in consonance with the University's vision and mission.

The REM is developed in accordance with ISO 9001:2015 standard and all the requirements of ISO 9001:2015 standard are applicable to the quality management system of LNU. The REM also conforms to relevant national and international laws and regulations such as the 2022 National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants issued by the Philippine Health Research Ethics Board (PHREB), the national policy-making body in health research ethics in the country created under DOST Special Order No. 091 s. 2006. PHREB ensures adherence to the universal ethical principles for the protection and promotion of the dignity of health research participants and sets requirements for registration and accreditation as the regulatory body of all Research Ethics Review Committees (RERCs) in the Philippines.

Compliance to the provisions of this REM and reference procedures cited herein is mandatory. This manual shall serve as a guide to the regular performance of the office activities and to the continuous improvement of research ethics services.

It is intended for office and academic use, and serves all LNU's management, teaching and non-teaching employees, students, as well as assessors from an independent quality certification body.

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The copy holders of this manual are documented in the Document Approval and Distribution Matrix.

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2. ACCOUNTABILITY

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Controlled copies of this manual are considered accountable items. Holder of the controlled copies shall be required to surrender their copies to the Quality Management System Office (QMSO) upon their resignation or retirement from the University. This manual may be reproduced for other LNU Management and employees or outside parties upon approval of the QMR. All reproduction shall be considered uncontrolled copies. Employees issuing uncontrolled copies of this manual shall be held accountable for their use. (See QSM 11.01, "Control of Documented Information")

3. MAINTENANCE AND CHANGE CONTROL (REVISION)

The QMSO shall be the sole issuer of the authorized revision to this manual. It shall provide recipients of the controlled copies of this manual with amendments or any updates.

The recipients of the manual shall not put hand-written notes on the manual. This is to avoid misinterpretation by the reader. Only the controlled copies shall be considered as latest official version. Amendments or updates to the manual shall be provided to the recipients of controlled copies. Latest revisions shall be recorded in the Table of Contents of this manual.

Revision of each LNU-REC Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) is governed by SOP No. 34 under Chapter 5 on Writing and Revision of SOPs and follows the provisions of the 2022 National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants. As prescribed by the said guideline under Appendix I: The PHREB Standard Operating Procedure Template, the header of the SOPs codifies the SOP through the assignment of the SOP number and version number. The version number is the latest edition of the SOP and not of the Research Ethics Manual (REM). Hence, a different header is assigned from REM 4.00 to REM 8.00 covering all LNU-REC SOPs incorporating the provisions of the national guideline in the university-prescribed template for manuals.

If there is a new version of the Research Ethics Manual, the QMSO shall retrieve the controlled copies of the current version and replace these with the latest version. The QMSO shall be responsible for disposing superseded version of the controlled copies.

4. FEEDBACK

Any comments, suggestions, or questions regarding the Quality Management System and its documentation may be forwarded to the QMSO. Please accomplish one (1) Document Change Request Form for every revision and submit it with supporting documentation (if any) to the QMSO. This form is available at the QMSO.

PREPARED BY:  ATTY. ALMA SONIA Q. SANCHEZ-DANDAY, PhD Director, Research Ethics Office	APPROVED BY:  EVELYN B. AGUIRRE, DA University President		
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REM 2.00	Table of Contents	July 26, 2023	-	0
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LNU VISION

A globally recognized university of education, management, arts and sciences
geared towards the inclusive growth and sustainability of society

LNU MISSION

To produce globally recognized human capital along teacher education,
management, arts, and sciences, responsive to the development needs of society

CORE VALUES

Integrity
Excellence
Service

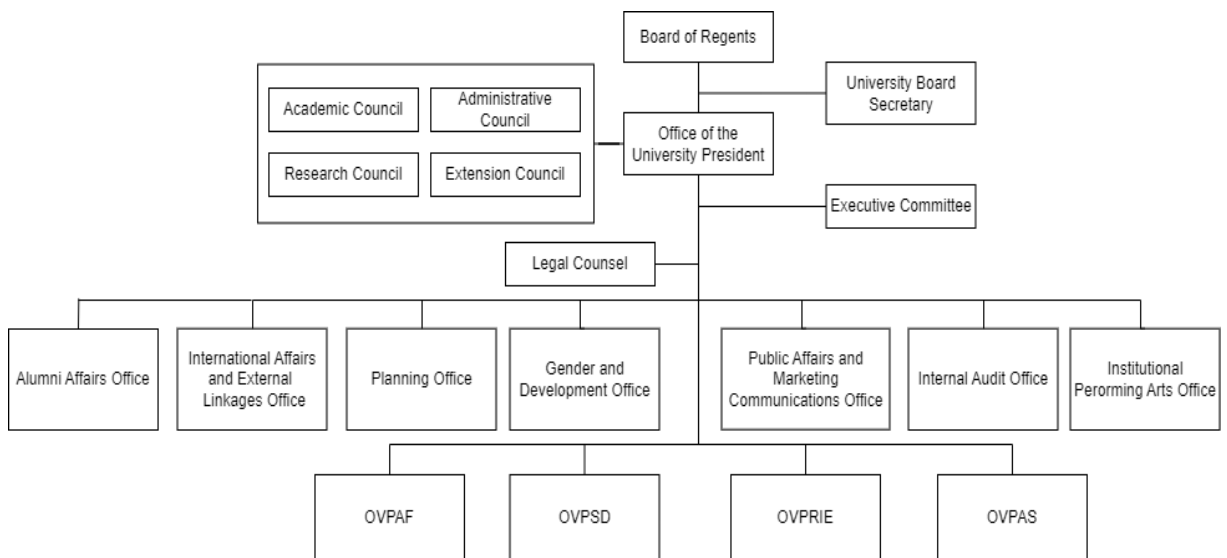
QUALITY POLICY

We, at the Leyte Normal University (LNU),
commit to pursue satisfaction of our
customers
through good governance, quality and relevant instruction,
research, extension, and support services
and to continuously improve our quality management
system in compliance with ethical standards and
applicable statutory, regulatory, and stakeholders'
requirement



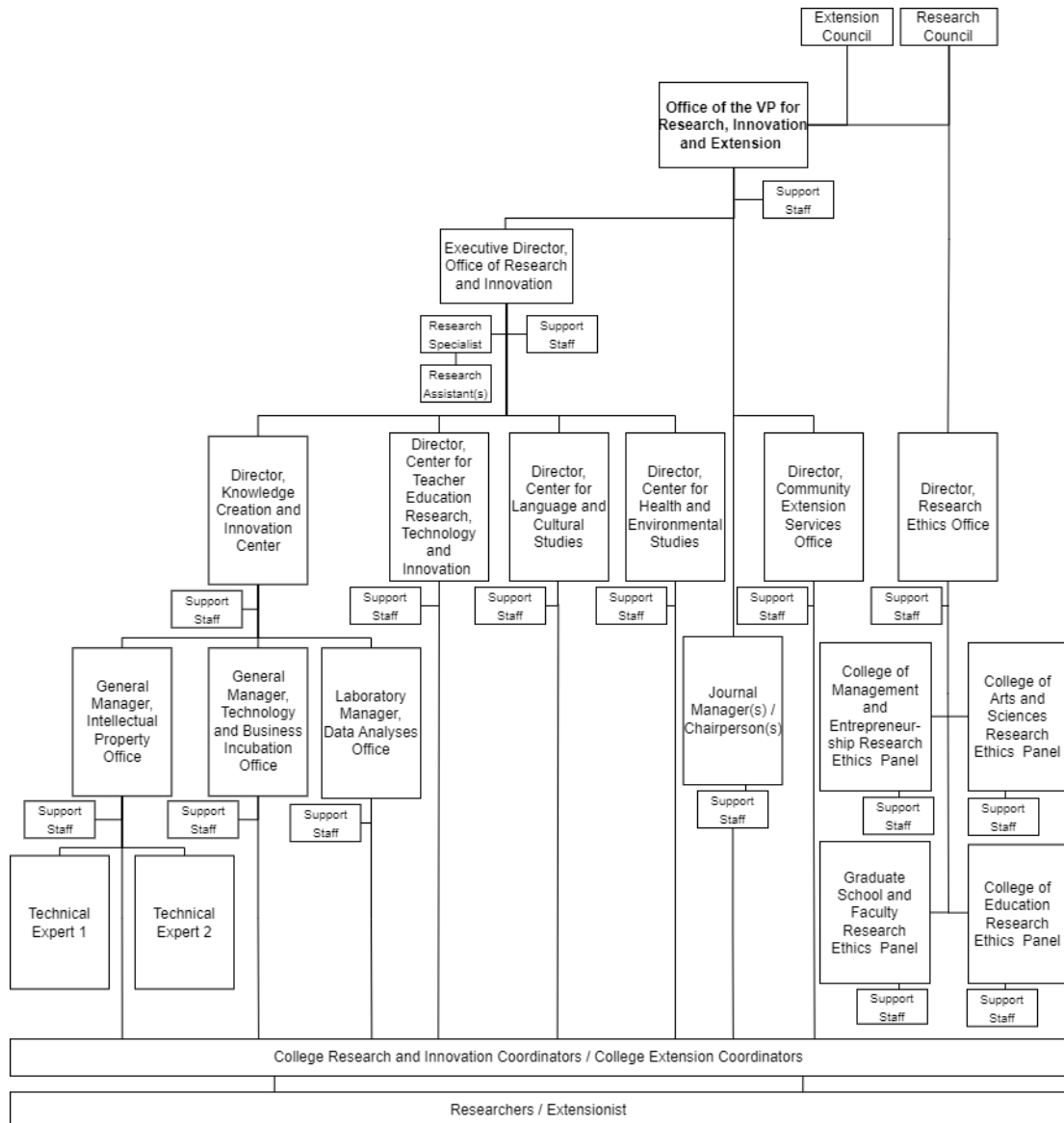
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LNU ORGANIZATIONAL CHART



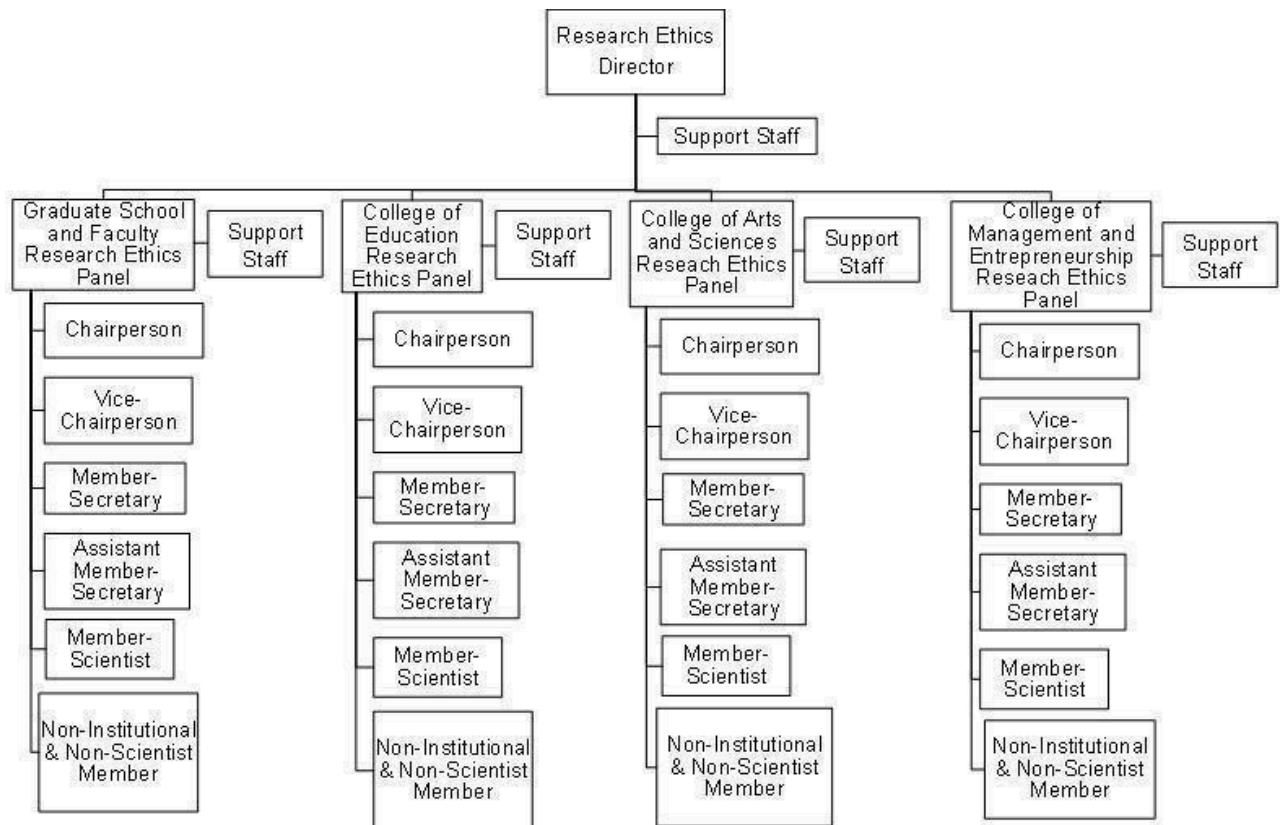
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LNU ORGANIZATIONAL CHART



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LNU-REC ORGANIZATIONAL CHART



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ESTABLISHMENT AND MANDATE OF LNU-REC

The Leyte Normal University-Research Ethics Committee (LNU-REC) is an independent body created by the university to ensure the protection of the rights, safety, and well-being of human subjects involved in the conduct of research studies. Through LNU-BOR Resolution No. 1387, s. 2022, adopted on May 04, 2022, the Research Ethics Office was created lodged under the Research Council in the new LNU Organizational Structure. In the same year, a budgetary allocation of Php 1,494,393.99 was granted for the establishment of the research ethics office through LNU-BOR Resolution No. 1423, s. 2022, adopted on August 10, 2022.

In accordance with applicable national and international regulations, the LNU-REC has the authority to approve, require modifications, or disapprove research protocols and related documents, as well as to ensure compliance with its post approval procedures.

The LNU-REC reviews and monitors the following:

- studies which involve LNU stakeholders and those done within LNU or with the use of university facilities, including those initiated by LNU students, faculty and personnel, and of the university itself;
- sponsored research studies using LNU facilities and those done in cooperation with the university; and
- external research studies such as:
 - ☐ research studies from other academic institutions and organizations; and
 - ☐ research studies referred by PHREB, SJREB, industry and government organizations, and other institutions on the condition that the host institution where the study will be done accepts the review of LNU-REC and agrees to abide by the rules and regulations that the LNU-REC imposes.

In compliance with the 2020 PHREB Policies and Requirements for Accreditation of Research Ethics Committees, only one set of Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) will be used by the four (4) Research Ethics Panels (REPs) of the LNU-REC. These REPs composed of the Graduate School and Faculty Research Ethics Panel, College of Education Research Ethics Panel, College of Arts and Sciences Research Ethics Panel, and College of Management and Entrepreneurship Research Ethics Panel decide and operate independently from each other.

The LNU-REC SOPs provide a step-by-step description of the different procedures to ensure consistency, transparency, and quality in ethical review. It adopted the Philippine Health Research Ethics Board's (PHREB) prescribed Standard Operating Procedure Template in the 2022 National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants (Appendix I). Established under DOST Special Order No. 091 s. 2006, PHREB stands as the regulatory body of all research committees in the country.

Following PHREB's prescribed template, the LNU-REC SOPs have a header which consists of the name and logo of the Institution, name of the REC, title of the SOP, SOP Number, SOP Version Number, Approval Date, and Effectivity Date. The document number assigned to each SOP in the Research Ethics Manual is reflected in the header. Each SOP is divided into eight (8) sections: Policy Statement, Objective/s, Scope,

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Workflow, Detailed Description of Procedures, Forms, History of SOP, and References. The glossaries of the different SOPs were put together as Appendix A of the whole manual.

The Policy Statement consists of institutional or committee policies upon which the activity and procedures are based. It also includes specific provisions from international and national guidelines pertinent to the activity. The Objective refers to the purpose of the activity. The Scope includes the initial and final steps involved in the activity. The Workflow section is a matrix briefly showing the different steps involved in the activity and the persons responsible. The Detailed Description of Procedures describes the performance of each step in the Workflow. The Forms section lists the specific forms used in the activity. The History section tabulates the version dates and number, authors, and the enumeration of major changes that the SOP has undergone. The References section is a list of current guidelines, other institutional SOPs, and manuals used in the development of the LNU-REC SOP. The Glossary defines and explains the terms, including acronyms and abbreviations used in the SOP.

RESPONSIBILITIES

It is the responsibility of the LNU Board of Regents to constitute and establish the university research ethics office and to allocate funds for its operation.

Appointment of the Director manning the Research Ethics Office, LNU-REC Officers, Members, Independent Consultants, and Staff/Secretariat is the responsibility of the Office of the University President (OUP). The OUP is also responsible for providing the terms of reference for these appointments in accordance with prevailing institutional policies, guidelines, and regulations.

The Research Ethics Office (REO) and the Leyte Normal University-Research Ethics Committee (LNU- REC) is responsible in crafting the Research Ethics Manual (REM) and in initiating the formulation and revision of the LNU-REC SOPs in accordance with PHREB-approved procedures. The Research Ethics Director spearheads the application for PHREB accreditation of the LNU-REC and ensures compliance with all reportorial requirements set forth in the 2020 PHREB Policies and Requirements for Accreditation of Research Ethics Committees. The REO oversees all administrative concerns of the LNU-REC without encroaching on the independence in decision-making of the REPs.

The LNU-REC Officers, Members, and Staff/Secretariat have the responsibility to study, comply, and respect the procedures and guidelines set forth in the Research Ethics Manual (REM). Newly-appointed REC Officers, Members, Staff/Secretariat have the responsibility to read, understand, and sign the required appointment forms at the start of their appointment or reappointment to the LNU-REC. Refusal of any member to sign such agreement may be a ground for disqualification in joining the LNU-REC.

All LNU-REC Members and Staff/Secretariat have the responsibility to undergo training during the course of their appointment to acquire relevant knowledge and skills and to continuously update themselves on recent regulations. Each REP Chair shall enjoin all REP members and staff to attend trainings/seminars/workshops as needed.

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BRIEF HISTORY OF LNU-REC

A functional institutional research ethics review committee was established for the first time in Leyte Normal University through LNU-BOR Resolution No. 1387, s. 2022, "Approving the New LNU Organizational Structure with the Ethics Board Lodged under the Research Council and the Center for Teacher Quality under the Office of the University President".

Consequently, the Research Ethics Office (REO) was created and on September 12, 2022, the University President, Dr. Evelyn B. Aguirre, issued a Special Order designating Atty./Dr. Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez- Danday as the Research Ethics Director.

The REO prepared to organize one (1) research ethics committee composed of four (4) panels taking into account the anticipated volume of research protocol submissions for ethical review from the students and faculty members. A Technical Working Group (TWG) was created to help craft the SOPs and Forms on December 05, 2022 at Sabin Resort, Ormoc City which targeted the SOP requirements for both Level 1 and Level II PHREB accreditation.

Part of the earlier initiatives of the university in institutionalizing the conduct of research ethics review prior to the establishment of the REO was the issuance of a Special Order to Dr. Maricel A. Gomez followed by Atty./Dr. Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday as Research Ethics Chairperson. In October 2021, Atty. Sanchez- Danday requested from PHREB the conduct of Basic Research Ethics Training for the invited LNU-REC members in view of PHREB's training requirement for membership. This certificatory training took place via Zoom on March 28-29, 2022 with thirty-three (33) successful completers. Another certification training was attended by eighteen (18) members sponsored by the Eastern Visayas Health and Development Consortium (EVHRDC). This was the Workshop on Responsible Conduct of Research (A Basic Certification Training) conducted by UPM-NIH last September 12-14, 2022. They were also invited to attend the Lecture on Ethics in Health Research conducted by the Eastern Visayas Health and Development Consortium- Ethics Review Committee (EVHRDC-ERC) last August 19, 2022.

The REO invited six (6) non-institutional and non-scientist members to undergo research ethics training for REC membership. Four (4) of them was assigned to each of the Research Ethics Panel while the two (2) members serve as alternate non-institutional and non-scientist members. These non-institutional and non- scientist members are Mrs. Rosalina H. Coral, Miss Lernaflor G. Napoles, Mrs. Nilda D. Mora, Mrs. Maria Virginia M. Faner , Mr. Nestor C. Sedanza, and Mr. Ricky T. Serrano. International and national guidelines require the presence of at least five (5) regular members including the non-affiliated and the non-scientist members to establish a quorum.

The Research Ethics Manual incorporating the LNU-REC SOPs was approved by the LNU-BOR on July 26, 2023. On September 12, 2023, the LNU-REC members officially took their oath and signed the Appointment with Terms of Reference. It was followed by a Seminar-Workshop on Effective Management of REC files and archiving.

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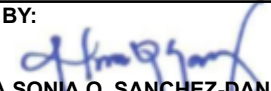
On November 24, 2023 and December 10, 2023, an Orientation on the LNU-REC SOPs and Forms was held via Zoom participated in by the LNU community, particularly the faculty members and research undergraduate and graduate students. On November 28-30, 2023, the Research Ethics Office (REO) spearheaded the Seminar-Workshop on LNU-REC SOPs and Forms cum Ethics Review Simulation participated in by the LNU-REC members

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Research Ethics Office Staff and LNU-Research Ethics Committee Members (through the years)

2023					
REO Director:		Atty./Dr. Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday			
REO Secretary:		Niño Wiellan B. Sanchez			
LNU-REC Members					
Research Ethics Panel		GS & Faculty REP	COE REP	CAS REP	CME REP
Chairperson:	Dr. Ariel B. Lunzaga	Prof. Cristina N. Estolano	Dr. Rufo A. Labarrete	Prof. Candice P. Aguilos	
Vice-Chairperson:	Prof. Jocylen A. Tiopes	Mr. Niceforo P. Casaus	Dr. Victor P. Bactol, Jr.	Dr. Leoncio P. Olobia	
Member-Secretary:	Mr. Tyrone O. Gil, Jr	Miss Ethel P. Marcellano	Miss Sheela M. Dela Cruz	Miss Kristel Joyce P. Cabacang	
Assistant Member-Secretary:	Mrs. Fabiana P. Peñeda	Mr. Leenard Niño O. Mateo	Miss Mary Ann S. Dalan	Mr. Marc Y. Llarenas	
Member-Scientist:	Miss Maricar C. Tegero	Mr. Rulf J. Alcober	Mr. Jay P. Mabini	Miss Michell T. Acala	
Non-institutional & Non-scientist Member:	Mr. Ricky T. Serrano	Mrs. Maria Virginia M. Faner	Mrs. Nilda D. Mora	Mr. Nestor C. Sedanza	
Alternate Non-institutional & Non-scientist Member:	Mrs. Rosalina H. Coral Miss Lernaflor G. Napoles				
REP Secretary:	Mr. Mark Jesse P. Atay	Miss Pearl Angelika Q. Boone	Miss Maricho Q. Calumpiano	Miss Brenda A. Danday	

Independent Consultants	
Affiliated	Non-affiliated
Dr. Ruthchel C. Zeta Mrs. Melba N. Navarra Dr. Myra A. Abayon Dr. Las Johansen B. Caluza Mr. Leo Reaywen M. Tugonon Dr. Rowena N. Ariaso Mr. Michael Jun M. Ponciano Atty. Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Dr. Lilibeth D. Alido Dr. Nilo M. Eder

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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The selection of Leyte Normal University-Research Ethics Committee (LNU-REC) members shall be done through an appointment and selection process represented by the different disciplines (scientists and non- scientists), institutional and non-institutional members, and sectors (male and female, older and younger age groups). The LNU President is the appointing authority of all LNU-REC members. In instances where vacancy occurs, the LNU-REC panels may nominate new members to the appointing officer through the Research Ethics Office (REO).

The appointed members shall serve for a period of one (1) year. Taking into account PHREB's required training for membership and the university investment to establish the LNU-REC, active former members shall be given priority for re-appointment over inexperienced nominees.

The role of the LNU-REC scientist members is to focus on the review of the study protocol while the role of the non-institutional and non-scientist members is to illuminate on the social value of the protocol. The roles of the affiliated and non-affiliated members in terms of protocol review are similar, however, the non- affiliated member is expected to provide an external perspective to ensure the independence of the position of LNU-REC from possible bias posed by the institution that may impact on the rights, safety, and well- being of human subjects. The non-scientist members are only expected to review the ethical aspect of the protocol or to accomplish the informed consent form assessment.

The four (4) Research Ethics Panels (REPs) comprising the LNU-REC: the Graduate School and Faculty Research Ethics Panel (GS/F REP), College of Education Research Ethics Panel (COE REP), College of Arts and Sciences Research Ethics Panel (CAS REP), and College of Management and Entrepreneurship Research Ethics Panel (CME REP), follow the PHREB-prescribed composition for membership.

Each REP is composed of six (6) members composed of five (5) scientist-members and one (1) non-institutional and non-affiliated member. International and national ethical guidelines require the presence of at least five (5) regular members to establish a quorum with a required presence of the non-affiliated and non-scientist members. In case of unavailability of the designated and alternate non-institutional and non- scientist members, a member serving as a non-institutional and non-scientist member of a REP may be invited to serve in another panel.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity aims to ensure that the composition of the LNU-REC is in compliance with international, national, and institutional guidelines and that appropriate expertise is taken into consideration in choosing the members per REP.

3. SCOPE

DOCUMENT NO. REM 4.01	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME CHAPTER I STRUCTURE AND COMPOSITION SOP 1 Selection and Appointment of LNU-REC Members	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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The LNU-REC members shall be appointed by the University President. Upon acceptance of the appointment, the members shall submit their Curriculum Vitae and other needed documents to the REO.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Nomination of potential new members	REP Chairperson and Members
Step 2: Submission of names of potential members to the REO Director	REP Member-Secretary
Step 3: Endorsement of potential members to the University President.	REO Director and Research Council
Step 4: Receipt of Appointment Letters by new members	REO Secretary
Step 5: Forwarding Appointment Letters to new members with confidentiality and conflict of interest disclosure agreement.	REO Secretary
Step 6: Submission of signed Appointment Letters, Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure Agreement, and Curriculum Vitae (CV)	New Members
Step 7: Filing of appointment documents and CVs in the membership file (SOP on Managing Active Files-Administrative and Study Files)	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Nomination of potential new members:

The REP will inform the Director concerning the need for new member/s of the LNU-REC. Nominations shall commence once the need is justified and will be based on qualifications and requirements as stipulated in the international, national, and institutional policies.

Step 2. Submission of names of potential member/s to REO:

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The REP deliberates on nominees' scientific and research ethics knowledge and expertise, as well as willingness to volunteer time and effort to perform the responsibilities as members of LNU-REC. The REP Member-Secretary submits a shortlist of three (3) nominees to the REO.

Step 3. Endorsement of potential members to the LNU University President:

The REO Director, through the Research Council, recommends potential members based on needed requirements and qualifications to the University President. The University President has the authority to appoint regular members or fill in vacancy for membership position.

Step 4. Receipt of Appointment Letters for new members:

The REO Secretary receives the appointment papers from the University President and informs the concerned REP Chairperson accordingly.

The Letter of Appointment with Terms of Reference (*Form 1.1.1*) specify the conditions of the appointment including the roles and responsibilities.

Step 5. Forwarding of Appointment Letters to new members:

The REO Director signs the appointment papers as noted and dated and then instructs the REO Secretary to forward the Letter of Appointment with Terms of Reference (*Form 1.1.1*) together with the Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure Agreement (Member) (*Form 1.1.2*) to the concerned new member.

Step 6. Submission of signed Appointment Letters, Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure Agreement, and Curriculum Vitae:

The new LNU-REC member/s submit/s the signed Letter of Appointment with Terms of Reference (*Form 1.1.1*), Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure Agreement (Member) (*Form 1.1.2*), and Curriculum Vitae (*Form 1.1.3*) to the REO.

Step 7. Filing of appointment documents and CVs and signed Agreements in the membership file:

The REP Secretary files the appointment documents in the membership file (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files- Administrative and Study Files).

5.1 Requirements for Membership

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1. The LNU-REC shall be composed of twenty-four (24) regular members with six (6) members per panel. There should be at least two (2) scientist-members from the college represented by a REP.
2. Membership shall be multidisciplinary and multi-sectoral to ensure diverse background and experience. Based on the functionality of structure and composition, members are integrated within the institutional structure of LNU and recognized as independent entities.
3. Relevant expertise may include social or behavioral science, education, management, law, philosophy, environmental science, and public health. It is recommended that the LNU-REC should include a person who will represent the interest and concerns of the community.
4. The LNU-REC shall aim for gender balance in its membership with equal representation of men and women members in order to promote gender sensitivity in its review procedures.
5. The LNU-REC shall have representatives from both the older and younger generations.
6. The LNU-REC shall adhere to quorum requirements as defined in international and national guidelines (50% plus one) with a minimum number of 5 members to established a quorum.

5.2 Responsibility of Members

1. Members are selected based on their good moral character and personal capacities, their ethical and/or scientific knowledge and expertise, as well as their willingness to dedicate their time and effort to perform their functions in the LNU-REC.
2. Members shall have prior training in Basic Research Ethics and research methodology or should be willing to undergo such training during their membership. Advanced Research Ethics Training shall follow upon the completion of Basic Research Ethics Training.
3. Members shall disclose verbally or in writing during meetings any financial, professional, or personal interest or involvement in a project or proposal under consideration which is in conflict with their function as a reviewer.
4. Members shall submit their curriculum vitae, properly signed and dated, and update them at least once every two (2) years.
5. Members shall be required to sign a confidentiality and conflict of interest agreement at the start of their term. The agreement should cover all applications, meeting deliberations, information on research participants, and related matters. The Secretariat is likewise expected to sign a similar document.

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The LNU-REC shall decide on how to manage specific conflicts of interest of members related to their participation in committee deliberations/actions regarding a particular protocol covered by the provisions of the Confidentiality/Conflict of Interest Agreement.

6. Members have the following participation in the conduct of study protocol review and discussion during LNU-REC meetings:
 - a. Review, discuss and consider research proposals submitted for evaluation;
 - b. Assess serious adverse event reports and recommend appropriate action;
 - c. Review progress reports and monitor ongoing studies as appropriate;
 - d. Evaluate the final report;
 - e. Maintain confidentiality of the documents and deliberations during the REP meeting;
 - f. Declare any conflict of interest; and
 - g. Participate in continuing education activities in research ethics.

Non-institutional and non-scientist members review the ethical considerations in the conduct of the research which includes social value, vulnerability issues, risk versus benefit, measures to mitigate risks, privacy and confidentiality, and the informed consent process and forms.

5.3 Conditions of Appointment of Members

All LNU-REC members must be willing to:

1. Make public his/her full name, profession, and affiliation as an LNU-REC member;
2. Disclose all financial accountability, reimbursement for work, and expenses related to their work in the LNU-REC which has the responsibility to disclose its financial records upon request; and
3. Sign the Confidentiality/Conflict of Interest Disclosure Agreement regarding meeting deliberations, applications, information on research participants, and related matters.

5.4 Resignation, Disqualification, and Replacement of Members

1. Members may resign from their positions by submitting a letter of resignation to the REP Chairperson endorsed to the University President by the REO Director and the Research Council representative (Vice-President for Research, Extension, and Innovation).
2. Members may be disqualified from serving in the REP for valid reasons as determined by a majority vote of the REP members.
3. Members who have resigned or have been disqualified may be replaced following the nomination and appointment procedures previously stated.

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- The terms of the replacement shall be limited to the remaining term of the member that he/she has replaced.

5.5 Terms of Office

- The appointing authority shall indicate in the appointment letter the terms of office, the functions/ scope of work, and compensation scheme.
- The appointed members shall serve for a period of one (1) year, renewable every year. Membership continuity shall be determined based on the annual appointment given by the University President as recommended by the REO Director and the Research Council.
- In case of withdrawal from membership, there shall be three (3) nominees for the vacancy to be submitted by the REP. The REO Director, through the Research Council, shall endorse the nominees to the LNU University President for final approval.

6. FORMS

Form 1.1.1 Letter of Appointment with Terms of Reference

Form 1.1.2 Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure Agreement
(Member) Form 1.1.3 Curriculum Vitae

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Leenard Niño O. Mateo Leoncio P. Olobia Maricar C. Tegero Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 4.01	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
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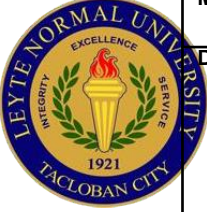
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PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2022). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

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DOCUMENT NO. REM 4.02	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME CHAPTER I	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	STRUCTURE AND COMPOSITION	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 2 Designation of LNU-REC Officers	PAGE NO. 8 of 142

1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC is composed of four (4) panels: Graduate School/Faculty Research Ethics Panel, College of Education Research Ethics Panel, College of Arts and Sciences Research Ethics Panel, and College of Management and Entrepreneurship Research Ethics Panel. Each Research Ethics Panel (REP) will be led by a Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson, Member-Secretary, and Assistant Member-Secretary who will be chosen from among the REP members who have served the committee for at least six (6) months. However, the candidate for the Chairperson position must have been a regular member of the LNU-REC for at least one (1) year. The position as REP Chairperson cannot be held for more than five (5) consecutive years. The LNU-REC officers are appointed by the University President.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity seeks to ensure that the LNU-REC officers are eligible and are appointed transparently in accordance with institutional policy and practice.

3. SCOPE

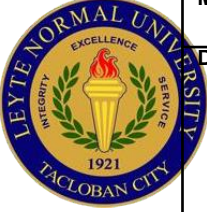
The appointment of a Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson, Member-Secretary, and Assistant Member-Secretary falls under the purview of this SOP. The process begins with the call for a special meeting to choose the relevant officers and it concludes with the filing of the officers' appointment documents.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Endorsement of LNU-REC Officers	REO Director and Research Council
Step 2: Appointment of LNU-REC Officers	University President
Step 3: Signing of conformity on appointment documents	REP Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson, Member-Secretary, Assistant Member-Secretary
Step 4: Filing of appointment documents	REO/ REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Endorsement of LNU-REC officers:

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The REO Director, through the Research Council Office, endorses the list of LNU-REC officers from the approved members of each of the REP.

Step 2. Appointment of LNU-REC officers:

The University President appoints the officers from among the list of LNU-REC members forwarded by the REO and issues the Letter of Appointment with Terms of Reference (*Form 1.1.1*) that contains the role and responsibilities of the specific officer position and the corresponding term of office.

Step 3. Signing of conformity on appointment documents:

The REO/REP Secretary notifies the officers of their appointments and the need to sign the *conforme*. The concerned officers forthwith report to the REO office to sign the appointment documents.

Step 4. Filing of appointment documents:

The REO/REP Secretary files the appointment papers accordingly. (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files- Administrative and Study Files).

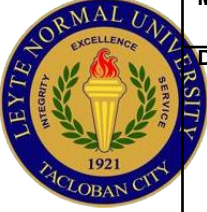
5.1 Responsibilities of the REP Chairperson

The REP Chairperson has the following responsibilities:

1. Presides over REP meetings and directly reports to the REO Director for administrative concerns;
2. Prepares an annual report summarizing REP activities and decision outcomes;
3. Ensures sufficient financial and administrative support for REP operations in coordination with the REO;
4. Encourages continuing education of REP members in research ethics review;
5. Represents the REP interests within the Leyte Normal University;
6. Represents the REP to external organizations and entities;
7. Is primarily responsible for the classification of study protocols received and assignment of Primary Reviewers; and
8. Reviews proposals for ethical concerns.

5.2 Responsibilities of the REP Vice-Chairperson

The REP Vice-Chairperson has the following responsibilities:

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1. Presides over meetings in the absence of the Chairperson;
2. Classifies study protocols and assigns Primary Reviewers in the absence of the Chairperson;
3. Reviews proposals for ethical concerns; and
4. Performs other duties as designated by the Chairperson.

5.3 Responsibilities of the Member–Secretary

The Member-Secretary has the following responsibilities:

1. Supervises the REP Secretary;
2. Calendars meetings, takes the minutes of Full Board Meetings with the assistance of the REP Secretary, supervises the taking of minutes of REP Secretary in all other meetings, and releases notice of meetings to all REP members;
3. Ensures good REP documentation;
4. Reviews proposals for ethical concerns;
5. Assists the REP Chairperson in preparing an annual report summarizing REP activities and decision outcomes; and
6. Classifies study protocols and assigns Primary Reviewers in the absence of the Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson

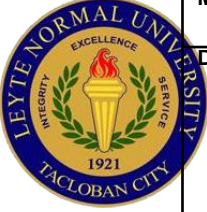
5.4 Responsibilities of the Assistant Member-Secretary

The Assistant Member-Secretary has the following responsibilities:

1. Performs all secretarial duties in the absence of the Member-Secretary;
2. Reviews proposals for ethical concerns;
3. Classifies study protocols and assign Primary Reviewers in the absence of the Chairperson, Vice- Chairperson, and Member-Secretary; and
4. Assists in the designated duties of the Member-Secretary.

6. FORMS:

Form 1.1.1 Letter of Appointment with Terms of Reference

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7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Leenard Niño O. Mateo Leoncio P. Olobia Maricar C. Tegero Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.

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PHREB (2022). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

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DOCUMENT NO. REM 4.03	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
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	DOCUMENT NAME CHAPTER I STRUCTURE AND COMPOSITION SOP 3 Appointment of Independent Consultants	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC shall maintain a roster of Independent Consultants who may be called upon when their expertise is needed for study protocols under review. The Independent Consultants need not be affiliated with the institution.

The REP Chairperson determines the external expertise requirements from various professionals with specific scientific expertise to be part of the LNU-REC roster of Independent Consultants representing expertise not present in the current LNU-REC composition. This roster of Independent Consultants will be endorsed by REO and the Research Council to the University President for approval.

The University President may also invite as Independent Consultants former members of the LNU-REC to guide and provide advice to the current LNU-REC composition regarding past practices to ensure a smooth transition within the team and to participate in special projects and other matters as the need arises.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity aims to ensure that the appointment of Independent Consultants conforms with institutional practice and complements the pool of expertise in the LNU-REC.

3. SCOPE

This SOP specifically pertains to the selection and designation of Independent Consultants in the review of research protocols of the LNU-REC. This SOP begins with the identification of the study that requires an Independent Consultant and ends with the inclusion of the name of the new Independent Consultant in the pool of consultants.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Identification of the study that requires an Independent Consultant	Primary Reviewer, REP Chairperson
Step 2: Identification of the Independent Consultant	REP Chairperson
Step 3: Invitation and appointment of the Independent Consultant	REP Chairperson, University President
Step 4: Receipt of the signed Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure Agreement	REO Secretary

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Step 5: Inclusion in the pool of Independent Consultants	REO/REP Secretary
Step 6: Filing of appointment documents and CVs in the Roster of Independent Consultants' file	REO/REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Identification of the study that requires an Independent Consultant:

The Primary Reviewer or the REP Chairperson identifies the study protocol that requires expertise necessary in the review process which may not be provided by the current members of the LNU-REC and the roster of Independent Consultants.

Step 2. Identification of the Independent Consultant:

The REP Chairperson refers to the roster of experts in the institution or in other institutions and selects the appropriate expert.

Step 3. Invitation and appointment of the Independent Consultant:

The REP Secretary prepares the Letter of Invitation for Independent Consultant with the signature of the REP Chairperson and sends this to the identified expert. The letter of invitation contains a section for acceptance of the invitation.

Upon the expert's *conforme*, the University President issues the Appointment Letter of Independent Consultant (*Form 1.3.2*), through the REO and the Research Council. The REO/REP Secretary sends the Appointment Letter to the Independent Consultant together with the Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure Agreement (*Form 1.3.3*).

Step 4. Receipt of the signed Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure Agreement:

The REO/REP Secretary receives the signed Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure agreement and files this in the appropriate folder.

Step 5. Inclusion in the pool of Independent Consultants:

The REO/REP Secretary enters the name of the new Independent Consultants in the appropriate database containing name, expertise, institution, and date of appointment.

Step 6. Filing of appointment documents, CVs, and signed Agreements in the file of Roster of Independent Consultants:

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The REO/REP Secretary files the appointment documents in the file of the Roster of Independent Consultants. (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files- Administrative and Study Files)

5.1 Responsibilities of an Independent Consultant

1. The REP Secretary provides study protocol documents to the concerned consultant for review. The review must focus on:
 - a) Scientific procedures and methodology
 - b) Any new information about the research topic and the proposed interventions
 - c) Benefits and Risks of the intervention and how to mitigate the risks
2. The consultant may attend the REP meeting onsite or online, present his/her views, and participate in the discussion but without the right to vote.
3. The Non-Institutional and Non-Scientist Consultant reviews the ethical considerations in the conduct of the research which includes social value, vulnerability issues, risk versus benefit, measures to mitigate risks, privacy and confidentiality, and the informed consent process and forms. The Non- Institutional and Non-Scientist consultants cannot review SAE's and SUSARs.
4. The consultant will be given an honorarium per expert services rendered to the LNU-REC.

5.2 Termination of Services

1. Consultant's services may be terminated by either the consultant or by the LNU-REC.
2. Upon termination of the consultant's services, the LNU-REC Secretary shall ensure that all the necessary documentation related to the Independent Consultant is filed with the other administrative documents.

6. FORMS

Form 1.3.1 Letter of Invitation for Independent Consultant
 Form 1.3.2 Appointment Letter of Independent Consultant
 Form 1.3.3 Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure Agreement (Independent Consultant)

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7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Leenard Niño O. Mateo Leoncio P. Olobia Maricar C. Tegero Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

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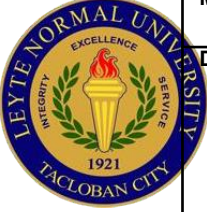
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WHO (2011). Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participants.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 4.04	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME CHAPTER I STRUCTURE AND COMPOSITION SOP 4 Training of LNU-REC Members and Staff	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

A continuing education and training will ensure that LNU-REC members and staff have kept abreast with the applicable international, national, and institutional guidelines. All LNU-REC members and staff have to undergo training during the course of their appointment to continuously update themselves with relevant knowledge and skills.

The REP Chairperson shall enjoin all members and staff to attend training/seminars/workshops, as needed, and the university, through the REO, shall ensure that adequate resources are provided for continuing professional development. Hence, the university has to allocate an annual budget for specific training and other educational activities of LNU-REC members and staff.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This SOP provides the guidelines and procedures, templates, and forms related to the training of LNU-REC members and staff to ensure that training needs and requirements set by accrediting bodies are met.

3. SCOPE

This SOP applies specifically to the process of providing training to the LNU-REC members and staff. This SOP begins with the identification of training requirements and ends with the filling of training records of LNU-REC members in the membership file.

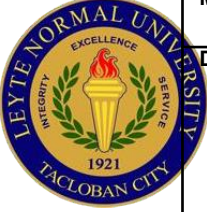
4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Identification of the training requirements	REO Director
Step 2: Signing up for training/seminars/lectures/workshops	REO Secretary, LNU-REC Members and Staff
Step 3: Attendance to training/seminars/lectures/workshops	LNU-REC Members and Staff
Step 4: Filing of updated training record	REO/REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Identification of the training requirements

The REO conducts periodic reviews on compliance with training requirements of LNU-REC members and staff. The following are some of the required courses and relevant training needed:

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	Training of LNU-REC Members and Staff	

- a) Basic and Advanced Research Ethics Training
- b) Training Requests, Training Logs, and other Secretarial Trainings
- c) Continuing Ethics Education
- d) SOP Writing
- e) Basic Research Ethics and Good Clinical Practice (for health research)
- f) Ethical Guidelines and Relevant Laws and Regulations in Research Ethics

Step 2. Signing up for training/seminars/lectures/ workshops

The REO or the REP Chairperson announces upcoming training courses, workshops, conferences, and lectures to the different REPs. The REP Chairperson/member/staff signifies intention to attend by filing a request for possible participation and to request for funds to cover the registration fees and travel allowances.

The Training Referral Request Form (*Form 1.4.2*) is accomplished and submitted with supporting documents, including but not limited to the Registration Form and Program at least one (1) month before the training date to the REO. The REO recommends and endorses the request to the Research Council and to the University President for the issuance of a Special Order/Travel Order.

Step 3. Attendance to training/seminars/lectures/ workshops

The member or staff attends the training and submits proof of attendance to the REO/REP Secretary, such as a Certificate of Attendance or Participation. All attendees have to follow the liquidation process imposed by the university and are encouraged to echo their experiences and learning realizations to the LNU-REC.

Step 4. Filing of updated training record

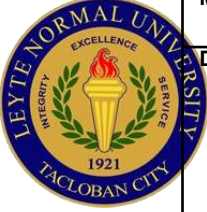
The REO/REP Secretary updates the Training Record of the LNU-REC Member (*Form 1.4.1*) to document the training attended in chronological order. A copy of the Certificate of Attendance/Participation is filed in the LNU-REC membership file. The Secretariat updates the training record annually. (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files- Administrative and Study Files)

6. FORMS

Form 1.4.1 Training Record of an LNU-REC Member
Form 1.4.2 Training Referral Request Form

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change

DOCUMENT NO. REM 4.04	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME CHAPTER I	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1	07/26/2023	Leenard Niño O. Mateo Leoncio P. Olobia Maricar C. Tegero Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version
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8. REFERENCES

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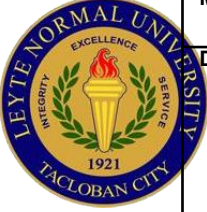
EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

CIOMS (2016). International Ethical Guidelines for Health-related Research Involving Humans.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2022). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

WHO (2011). Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participants.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 4.05	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME CHAPTER I STRUCTURE AND COMPOSITION SOP 5 Incentives of LNU-REC Members and Consultants	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC recognizes the significant contributions of members and consultants in upholding the protection of the rights, safety, and well-being of human subjects involved in the conduct of research. The honorarium for LNU-REC members and consultants are intended to provide as an incentive for the work completed rather than as compensation.

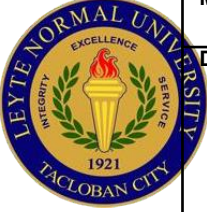
Given the significance of the ethics review procedure, the Department of Health included a clause allowing the payment of honoraria to REC members under Department Order No. 2017-0265, dated July 1, 2017. It stipulated that *all REC members shall be compensated based on their attendance to REC meetings. The allowable honorarium for members per meeting is Php 1,000-Php 3,000, and Php 3,000-5,000 for the Chair. REC members who are staff of the institution may receive honorarium provided that the meetings are undertaken after office hours.*

Considering the volume of submissions for ethical review, the number full board meetings and expedited review meetings to expeditiously accommodate all studies, and the financial capability of the researchers, a minimal honorarium will be given to the LNU-REC members monthly to cover Full Board Review Meetings, Site Visits, and any other Special, Emergency, Clarificatory, or Administrative Meetings that the REP Chairpersons or the REO may request. A separate honorarium will be given to the Primary Reviewers for the Expedited Review meetings.

Honorarium Rates of LNU-REC Members and Consultants

Position	Honorarium
REP Chairperson	Php 3,000/monthly
REP Member-Secretary	Php 2,500/monthly
Institutional/Affiliated Scientist-Members	Php 2,000/monthly
Non-Institutional/Non-Affiliated/Non-scientist Members	Php 2,000/monthly
Independent Consultant (Affiliated)	Php 1,000/invitation
Independent Consultant (Non-Affiliated)	Php 1,000/invitation
Attendance in SJREB	Php 1,000/invitation
Expedited Review	Php 500/protocol

2. OBJECTIVE/S

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This SOP will outline the steps in granting honoraria to consultants and LNU-REC members.

3. SCOPE

This SOP determines how LNU-REC members and consultants may be granted incentives for their work and ends with the process on dispensing the honorarium.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Examination of administrative mechanisms and precedents in providing incentives for LNU-REC	REO Director, REP Chairperson
Step 2: Preparation of recommendation and endorsement request to the University President	REO Director, Research Council
Step 3: Approval or disapproval of request	University President, LNU-BOR
Step 4: Communication of honorarium/incentive information to members and consultants	REO Director
Step 5: Release of incentive	LNU Cashier

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

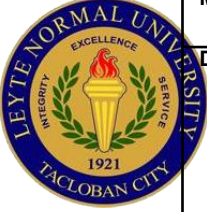
Step 1. Examination of administrative mechanisms and precedents in providing incentives for LNU-REC:

The REO Director and REP Chairpersons examine potential legal, financial, and administrative frameworks and precedents for paying honoraria for REC work.

Step 2. Preparation of recommendation and endorsement request to the University President:

The REO Director prepares a recommendation for an honorarium or its adjustment in the Annual Operational Plan of the REO and submits it, with the concurrence of the Research Council, to the University President for approval.

Step 3. Approval or disapproval of request:

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The recommended honorarium amount is subject to approval or disapproval by the University President and the LNU-BOR.

Step 4. Communication of honorarium/incentive information to members and consultants:

If the request for honoraria is granted, members and consultants will be informed during a regular meeting. The REO Secretary then creates and submits the voucher for the incentive/honoraria based on the Attendance (*Form 4.25.2*) along with any necessary supporting documentation such as the Minutes of Meeting (*Form 4.27.1*). The REO Secretary also keeps track and ensures that the aforementioned request is being properly processed.

Step 5. Release of incentive:

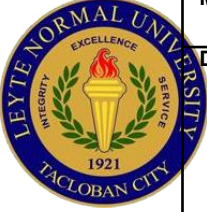
The REO Secretary notifies the members and consultants of the availability of the honorarium for pick up at the LNU Cashier.

6. FORMS

Form 4.25.2 Attendance
Sheet Form 4.27.1 Minutes
of Meeting

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Leenard Niño O. Mateo Leoncio P. Olobia Maricar C. Tegero Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

DOCUMENT NO. REM 4.05	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
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		PAGE NO. 22 of 142

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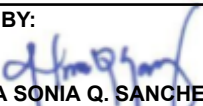
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CIOMS (2016). International Ethical Guidelines for Health-related Research Involving Humans.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2022). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

WHO (2011). Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participants.

PREPARED BY:  ATTY. ALMA SONIA Q. SANCHEZ-DANDAY, PhD Director, Research Ethics Office	APPROVED BY:  EVELYN B. AGUIRRE, DA University President		
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DOCUMENT NO. REM 5.01	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter II INITIAL REVIEW PROCEDURES	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 6 Management of Initial Submissions	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The application for research ethics clearance is standardized, systematic, and is accepted only when documents are complete after proper screening by the REP Secretary. The LNU-REC sets a deadline for the acceptance of protocols for review every 4th Monday of the month. The conduct of LNU-REC Board Meeting and Full Board Review of submitted protocols occurs every Saturday of the following month, following a specific schedule for each REP.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity ensures that the applications for research ethics clearance and/or exemption thereof are properly received, recorded, classified, and assigned to reviewers promptly and efficiently.

3. SCOPE

The procedures are applicable only to the types of research protocols reviewable by the LNU-REC under its mandate. The LNU-REC reviews and monitors the following:

- a) studies which involve LNU stakeholders and those done within LNU or with the use of university facilities, including those initiated by LNU students, faculty and personnel, and of the university itself;
- b) sponsored research studies using LNU facilities and those done in cooperation with the university;
- c) external research studies such as:
 - ☐ research studies from other academic institutions and organizations;
 - ☐ research studies referred by PHREB, industry organizations, and other institutions on the condition that the host institution where the study will be done accepts the review of LNU- REC and agrees to abide by the rules and regulations that the LNU-REC imposes; and
 - ☐ protocols referred by the Single Joint Review Ethics Board (SJREB) submitted by Sponsor/ Principal Investigator or its representative where Region 8 is one of the sites of a multicenter research (See SOP No. 10 on Single Joint Research Ethics Board Review Process).

This SOP describes the procedure for managing the submission of the initial protocol package for review from the time of receipt to filing of the initial protocol package in the Active File storage cabinet.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt of study documents for initial review and checking for completeness of the documents submitted	REP Secretary
Step 2: Assignment of permanent code to the package	REP Secretary
Step 3: Logging of received protocol in the LNU-REC database	REP Secretary

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Step 4: Determination of type of action/ type of review a. Exemption from Review (SOP 7) b. Expedited Review (SOP 8) c. Full Board Review (SOP 9)	REP Chairperson
Step 5: Preparation and distribution of the protocol review package to the primary reviewers	REP Secretary
Step 6: Filing of the original package in a properly labeled protocol file folder and storing it in the active study file cabinet	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt of study documents for initial review and determination of completeness of submission:

The LNU-REC shall set the deadline for submission of complete protocol package at 5 PM every 4th Monday of the month. The LNU-REC office is open from 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM during which time the Secretary accepts the completed protocols to be scheduled for review in the next month as well as the Application for Protocol Review (*Form 2.6.2*), Protocol Summary Sheet (*Form 2.6.4*), and Non-Disclosure Agreement (*Form 2.6.6*). The Secretary checks the completeness of the documents based on the Protocol Package Checklist (*Form 2.6.1*). If incomplete, the REP Secretary informs the proponent of the missing documents.

Important Reminder:

All study protocols need technical approval prior to ethical review. A Technical Review Certificate (*Form 2.6.5*) shall be signed by the Chairperson of the Technical Review Committee/Panel of Examiners for undergraduate and graduate school theses and dissertations or by the Executive Director of the Office of Research and Innovation for all other research studies initiated by the students, faculty, and of the university involving human participants. The same Technical Review Certificate (*Form 2.6.5*) or its equivalent will also be required for non-LNU initiated protocols submitted for review.

Step 2. Assignment of permanent code to the protocol package:

If the documents are determined to be complete, the REP Secretary assigns a protocol code. This code is the ID number of the protocol and cannot be assigned to any other protocol. When referring to the protocol in communications or presentations, the code will always be indicated for easier referencing.

For efficient file management, it is necessary to use the Protocol Code Number which is a unique identifier referring to the file. Each REP has been assigned to the following code/number:

- 1- GS/F
- 2- COE

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3- CAS

4- CME

All codes will follow the format REP-YEAR-nth Protocol. For example, the 5th protocol submission in Year 2023 lodged at the COE REP will use the protocol code 2-2023-005.

Step 3. Entry in the logbook and electronic database:

The REP logbook is an official document recording the receipt of particular documents on a specific date and time. It includes information on (1) date of submission (2) protocol code (3) title of the study (4) principal investigator (5) institution (6) the name and signature of the person who submitted and (7) the name and signature of the person who received the document. The name and signature of the individual who personally submitted the documents in lieu of the principal investigator is needed. The electronic database for all REP study protocols has to be regularly updated.

Step 4. Determination of type of review/action:

The REP Secretary submits all received complete protocol package to the REP Chairperson for the conduct of preliminary review using the Protocol Evaluation Form (*Form 2.6.3*) to determine the type of review needed i.e., Exempt, Expedited, or Full Board Review and for the assignment of Primary Reviewers.

If the REP Chairperson decides that the protocol is exempted from review, s/he directs the REP Secretary to follow the procedure in communicating the decision to the principal investigator (See SOP 28 on Communicating REC Decisions). If the REP Chairperson determines that the protocol should undergo either Full Board or Expedited Review, the REP Secretary proceeds to follow either the provisions under SOP 8 on Expedited Review or SOP 9 on Full Board Review.

The LNU-REC adheres to the following guidelines in classifying protocols as to the level of review required:

1. Exempt – Study protocols may be exempted from ethical review based on the criteria listed in the 2022 National Ethical Guidelines for Health and Health-related Research under the chapter *The Research Ethics Review Process* (See SOP 07 on Exemption from Review).

1.1 The decision to exempt from review rests on the REP Chairperson for efficiency and in the interest of time. Study protocols that may be exempted are:

- 1) Protocols that neither involve human participants nor identifiable human tissue, biological samples and data (e.g., meta-analysis protocols)
- 2) Protocols that do not involve more than minimal risks or harms, such as:
 - Protocols for institutional quality assurance purposes, evaluation of public service programs,

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public health surveillance, educational evaluation activities, and consumer acceptability tests;

- Research that only includes interactions involving survey procedures, interview procedures, or observation of public behavior (including visual or auditory recording) if the following criteria are met: (a) There will be no disclosure of the human participants' responses outside the research;
 - (b) The information obtained is recorded by the investigator in such a manner that the identity of the human participant cannot readily be ascertained, directly or through identifiers linked to the participant; and (c) Protocols that involve the use of publicly available data or information; and
 - Protocols where there is no disclosure of the human participants' responses outside the research that could reasonably place the participants at risk for criminal or civil liability or be damaging to their financial standing, employability, or reputation.
2. Expedited – An expedited review shall be conducted for study protocols that meet the following criteria (See SOP 8 on Expedited Review):
- 1) do not entail more than minimal risk to the study participants;
 - 2) do not have study participants belonging to a vulnerable group;
 - 3) the study procedures do not generate vulnerability;
 - 4) the study does not involve the collection of stigmatizing information; and
 - 5) the study uses anonymized or archived samples.
3. Full Board– A Full Board Review shall be conducted when (See SOP 9 on Full Board Review):
- 1) a proposed study entails more than minimal risk to study participants;
 - 2) when study participants belong to vulnerable groups; or
 - 3) when a study generates vulnerability from the participants.

Step 5. Preparation and distribution of the protocol review package to the primary reviewers:

The protocol materials are placed in a protocol folder that is labeled appropriately by the REP Secretary. In addition, the REP Secretary prepares enough copies of the whole set of protocol documents for distribution to the Primary Reviewers or sends the protocol folder through email at the Primary Reviewers' preference.

Step 6. Filing in a properly labeled protocol file folder and in the active study file cabinet:

The complete protocol folder is filed for safekeeping in the active study file cabinet. The electronic database is likewise updated to include the recent protocol submission (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files- Administrative and Study Files).

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6. FORMS

Form 2.6.1 Protocol Package
 Checklist Form 2.6.1a Assessment of Fees
 Form 2.6.2 Application for Protocol Review
 Form 2.6.3 Protocol Evaluation Form
 Form 2.6.4 Protocol Summary Sheet
 Form 2.6.5 Technical Review
 Form 2.6.6 Certificate
 Form 2.12.2 Non-Disclosure Agreement
 Form 2.12.2a Informed Consent Assessment
 Form 2.12.1a Study Protocol Self- Assessment
 Form 2.12.2a Informed Consent Self-Assessment

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Sheela M. Dela Cruz Tyrone O. Gil, Jr. Ariel B. Lunzaga Ethel P. Marcellano Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.
 EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.
 PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.
 PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedure.

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1. POLICY STATEMENT

Research protocols which pose no more than a minimal risk or harm are exempt from either a full board or an expedited review. In the LNU-REC, the decision to exempt a protocol from review rests on the REP Chairperson.

Study protocols may be exempted from ethical review based on the criteria listed in the 2022 National Ethical Guidelines for Health and Health-related Research. Study protocols that may be exempted are:

- 1) Protocols that don't use identifiable human tissue, biological samples, or data, or involve human participants (e.g., meta-analysis protocols);
- 2) Protocols for institutional quality assurance purposes, evaluation of public service programs, public health surveillance, educational evaluation activities, and consumer acceptability tests; and
- 3) Research that only includes interactions involving survey procedures, interview procedures, or observation of public behavior (including visual or auditory recording) if the following criteria are met:
 - a) There will be no disclosure of the human participants' responses outside the research that could reasonably place the participants at risk of criminal or civil liability or be damaging to their financial standing employability, or reputation,
 - b) The information obtained is recorded by the investigator in such a manner that the identity of the human participant cannot readily be ascertained, directly or through identifiers linked to the participant, and
 - c) Protocols that involve the use of publicly available data or information (NEGHHR 2022, p.48-49).

The decision to exempt must be recorded and communicated to the entire board. Protocols that meet the requirements for exemption are automatically archived and classified as INACTIVE with their data kept for three (3) years after the exemption date. Not later than one (1) month after the end of study, a copy of the final report must be given to the REP.

Study protocols that have been exempted are also exempt from progress and continuing reviews. If changes are made that materially alter the prior risk-benefit analysis or exempt status, the REP must be notified. In that instance, the protocol may be treated as a new protocol which has to be presented for first review.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity describes the LNU-REC procedure when protocols qualify for exemption from review.

3. SCOPE

This SOP begins with the submission of the entire protocol package to the REP Chairperson for

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determination of the type of ethics review and it concludes with the filing of protocols that have been exempted from review.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Submission of research protocol	Principal investigator
Step 2: Determination of type of action/ type of review - Exemption from Review (SOP 7) - Expedited Review (SOP 8) - Full Board Review (SOP 9)	REP Chairperson
Step 3: Evaluation of protocol based on exemption criteria	REP Chairperson
Step 4: Communication of decision to exempt study protocol from ethics review	REP Secretary
Step 5: Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database	REP Secretary
Step 6: Presentation of protocols exempted from review during Full Board Review	REP Chairperson

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Submission of the complete protocol package:

The LNU-REP Chairperson receives the whole protocol packet from the REP Secretary. Only protocols submitted within the deadline set by the LNU-REC every 4th Monday of the month will be considered for review in the succeeding month.

Step 2. Determination of type of review:

The REP Chairperson conducts an initial review of the protocol to determine the level of review i.e. Exempt, Expedited, or Full Board. (*Form 2.6.3*).

Step 3. Evaluation of protocol based on exemption criteria:

If the REP Chairperson decides that the protocol is exempted from review, s/he accomplishes and signs the Checklist for Exemption from Ethical Review (*Form 2.7.1*). In the event that the procedure does not satisfy the exemption criteria, it is reclassified and subjected to either full board or expedited review.

Step 4. Communication of decision to exempt study protocol from ethics review:

If the REP Chairperson determines that the protocol is exempt from review, s/he instructs the REP

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Secretary to adhere to the procedure in communicating the decision to the principal investigator. The REP Secretary prepares the Letter of Exemption from Ethical Review (*Form 4.28.3c*) and the Certificate of Exemption from Ethical Review (*Form 2.7.2*). Once signed by the REP Chairperson, these are released to the Principal Investigator within five (5) days from determination of protocol exemption.

Step 5. Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database:

Protocols that meet the requirements for exemption are automatically archived and classified as INACTIVE in the protocol database. The data shall be kept for three (3) years after the exemption date. However, a copy of the final report must be given to the REP not later than one (1) month after the end of study (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files- Administrative and Study Files).

Step 6. Presentation of protocols exempted from review during Full Board Review Meeting:

At the Full Board Review, protocols that are exempt from review shall be presented by the REP Chairperson to the panel.

TIMELINE FOR PROTOCOLS EXEMPT FROM REVIEW

TIMELINE	PERSONS INVOLVED	ACTIVITY
4 days	REP Chairperson	Determination of the type of review
5 days	REP Secretary	Preparation of the documents and certificate for exemption and communication of the REP Decision to the Principal Investigator

6. FORMS

Form 2.6.3 Protocol Evaluation Form
Form 2.7.1 Checklist for Exemption from Ethical Review
Form 2.7.2 Certificate of Exemption from Ethical Review
Form 4.28.3c Letter of Exemption from Ethical Review

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHOR S	MAIN CHANG E
1	07/26/2023	Sheela M. Dela Cruz Tyrone O. Gil,Jr.	Initial Version

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		Ariel B. Lonzaga Ethel P. Marcellano Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	
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8. REFERENCES

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DOCUMENT NO. REM 5.03	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE	VERSION NO. 1
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

An expedited review shall be conducted for study protocols that (1) do not entail more than minimal risk to the study participants, (2) do not have study participants belonging to a vulnerable group, and (3) the study procedures do not generate vulnerability. Approved protocol that underwent expedited review shall be reported in the subsequent Full Board Review.

The criteria for protocols to be initially classified as subject to Expedited Review are as follows:

1. The study does not entail more than minimal risk to the study participants such as:
 - a) Protocols that will not likely harm the status or interests of the study participants and not likely to offend the sensibilities nor cause psychological stress of the people involved;
 - b) Protocols that involve collection of anonymized personal data, anonymized biological specimens for research purposes by non-invasive means; and
 - c) Protocol that deals with data or documents involving anonymized human data, biological specimens that have been already collected or will be collected for ongoing medical treatments or diagnosis.
2. The study do not have participants belonging to a vulnerable group such as:
 - a) Protocols that will not deal with patients with incurable diseases, persons in nursing homes, unemployed or impoverished persons, patients in emergency situations, ethnic minority groups, homeless persons, nomads, refugees, minors and those incapable of giving consent.
3. The study procedures do not generate vulnerability such as:
 - a) Protocols that are non-confidential in nature defined as those
 - o Not dealing with private character such as sexual preference etc.
 - o Not dealing with sensitive issues that may cause social stigma.
4. Protocols referred by the SJREB classified for Expedited Review by the REP Chairperson (See SOP 10 on Single Joint Research Ethics Board Review Process).

After initial approval, study protocols subjected to Expedited Review follow these procedures:

1. Protocols initially classified for Expedited Review, even if with major modifications recommended, will still undergo expedited review upon resubmission as long as minimal risk is not elevated.
2. All post-approval amendments, deviations, violations, off-site SAE/SUSARS Reports shall be subject to Expedited Review, regardless of initial review classification if the study protocols satisfy any of the following criteria:
 - b) Administrative revisions, such as correction of typographical error

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- c) Addition or deletion of non-procedural items, such as the addition of study personnel names, laboratories, etc.
 - d) Minor protocol amendments, deviations, violations on the study and related documents that do not impact on the potential risk/benefits to the participant and with no substantial change in the study population, methodology, and consent that will impact on the integrity of the research.
3. Progress Reports and Continuing Review Applications will be subject to Expedited Review if initial classification of study protocol was likewise expedited.
 4. All Final Reports, regardless of type of initial classification of review, will be subject to Expedited Review. However, in the event that a Principal Investigator decides not to continue the application for ethics review, the Principal Investigator must write a letter requesting for withdrawal of study protocol from the REP. All requests for withdrawal will be discussed during the Full Board Review Meetings regardless of initial review classification.

It is the responsibility of the REP Chairperson to assign the Primary Reviewers who will assess the protocol that qualifies for the expedited review process. The same assessment forms used for Full Board Review shall be used to evaluate the scientific and ethical merits of the protocol.

Only complete protocols submitted on or before 5 PM of the 4th Monday of the month shall be included in the agenda for Expedited Review meeting scheduled on a Wednesday of the following week beyond office hours. In case quorum will not obtained or if there are remaining protocols to be discussed, another meeting for Expedited Review may be called by the REP Chairperson on a Wednesday of the succeeding weeks or at any other day convenient for all reviewers involved prior to the scheduled Full Board Review.

The LNU-REC may adopt online, face-to-face, or hybrid meetings. The REP Chairperson will decide on the type of platform to be used in the conduct of Expedited Review (See SOP 25 on the Conduct of Meetings).

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity aims to demonstrate due diligence and high standards in the conduct of research ethics review for the protection of human participants.

3. SCOPE

This SOP begins with the assignment of reviewers and ends with the inclusion of the review in the agenda for the next Expedited Review meeting.

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4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt of the protocol package from the REP Secretary	Primary Reviewers
Step 2: Conduct of the initial review of the protocol	Primary Reviewers
Step 3: Accomplishment of assessment forms	Primary Reviewers
Step 4: Presentation of review findings and recommendations during the Expedited Review meeting.	Primary Reviewers
Step 5: Communication of review results to the principal investigator.	REP Chairperson, Member-Secretary y REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt of the protocol package from the REP Secretary:

The Primary Reviewers will receive the protocol package from the REP Secretary forthwith upon determination of the type of review and assignment by the REP Chairperson.

Step 2. Conduct of the initial review:

The assigned Primary Reviewers shall carry out the Expedited Review on the protocol and related documents. This process must be completed within a minimum of three (3) working days after the receipt of the protocol package. This should also be done at least one (1) day before the scheduled REP Expedited Review meeting.

Step 3. Accomplishment of assessment forms:

Assessment forms may be submitted in hard copies, duly signed and dated, by the Primary Reviewers on or before the scheduled Expedited Review Meeting. Electronic copy of the assessment forms may likewise be submitted bearing the e-signature of the Primary Reviewers. The REP Secretary shall check for completeness of entries in the form before filing.

Step 4. Presentation of review findings and recommendations during the meeting:

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The Primary Reviewers submit their assessment forms to the REP Secretary on or before the scheduled Expedited Review Meeting and present the findings and recommendation during the actual meeting. If a Primary Reviewer cannot attend the meeting, the REP Chairperson exercises his/her prerogative to take over the role of the Primary Reviewer.

In case of differing opinions, the REP Chairperson may mediate to reach an agreement and may have the final say. In case of considerable difference where consensus cannot be reached, the REP Chairperson may refer the protocol to the REP (See SOP 9 on Full Board Review).

If deemed necessary, the Primary Reviewers may call for a clarificatory meeting or dialogue with the Principal Investigator to request for additional information. The Primary Reviewers have to echo the result of the dialogue and anything that transpired in the interim during the Expedited Review, and even during Full Board Review, if deemed necessary. All study protocols approved under Expedited Review will be presented by one of the Primary Reviewers during the scheduled Full Board Review meeting.

Step 5. Communication of review results to the principal investigator:

As soon as the decision of Primary Reviewers is reached, the decision is communicated to the Principal Investigators within seven (7) days from scheduled REP Expedited Review meeting. The reviewers recommend approval if there are no issues. The Notification of REP Decision (*Form 4.28.3a*) and Approval Letter (*Form 4.28.2*) are issued to the Principal Investigator.

If the review results for the protocol package will be major and minor modifications, the Primary Reviewer will report to the REP Secretary the need for the Principal Investigator to comply within ninety (90) days from receipt of decision. Then, the Principal Investigator will resubmit the protocol package with no resubmission fee for the 1st resubmission. However, a resubmission fee of Five Hundred Pesos (Php 500.00) will be charged for the 2nd and each of the subsequent resubmissions if the Principal Investigator still fails to comply with explicit recommendations of the REP during its initial review.

Forms such as the Notification of REP Decision (*Form 4.28.3a*) and Letter for Modification (*Form 4.28.3b*) are issued to the Principal Investigator. Recommended revisions may be classified as follows:

- Minor modification- a recommended revision applying to protocols found to have particular aspect/s on its study or related document that do not impact on potential risks/harm to participants and on the integrity of the research (e.g., incomplete documentation, informed consent elements, unsatisfactory informed consent format). To wit:
 1. Administrative corrections like typographical errors or grammar
 2. Minor changes on items not directly related on procedure to be done
 3. Revisions which will not impact the risk-benefit analysis e.g. additional related literature requested
- Major modification - a recommended revision applying to protocols found to have significant aspect/s of the study (e.g. study objectives, recruitment of participants, exclusion/inclusion criteria, collection

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of data, statistical analysis, mitigation of risk, protection of vulnerability, etc.) that impact on potential risks/harm to participants and on the integrity of the research. To wit:

1. If there will be major revisions on either the protocol or informed consent form, such as inclusion/exclusion criteria, safety issues, or methodology that may impact on the scientific validity of the protocol
2. Revision will have impact on the risk-benefit ratio.

No protocol may be disapproved during an Expedited Review. Only the full board (REP) has the power to disapprove a study protocol. If the Primary Reviewer recommends for disapproval, the protocol must be elevated to a Full Board Review for final decision.

TIMELINE FOR EXPEDITED REVIEW

TIMELINE	PERSONS INVOLVED	ACTIVITY
4 days	REP Chairperson	Determination of the type of review and assignment of Primary Reviewers
1 day	REP Secretary	Sending of protocol package to the Primary Reviewers
3 days	Primary Reviewers	Review of research protocol
1 day	Primary Reviewers	Expedited Review meeting and submission of signed assessment forms to the REP Secretary
7 days	REP Chairperson, Member-Secretary, REP Secretary	Preparation of the minutes of meeting and communication of REP Decision to Principal Investigator

6. FORMS

Form 4.28.3a Notification of REP
Decision Form 4.28.3b Letter for
Modification
Form 4.28.2 Approval Letter

7. HISTORY OF SOP

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1	07/26/2023	Sheela Dela M. Cruz Tyrone O. Gil,Jr Ariel B. Lunzaga Ethel P. Marcellano Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version
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8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7. EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review

Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants. PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

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1. POLICY STATEMENT

A full review shall be conducted when a proposed study entails more than minimal risk to study participants, when study participants belong to vulnerable groups, or when a study generates vulnerability to participants.

Only complete protocols submitted on or before the 4th Monday of the preceding month shall be included in the agenda for Full Board Meeting on a particular Saturday of the succeeding month. Full review shall be conducted by the relevant Research Ethics Panel. If necessary, the Principal Investigator shall be invited during the meeting to clarify certain issues. The decision shall be communicated to the proponent(s) within seven (7) working days after the adjournment of the most recent protocol review meeting.

The criteria for protocols to be classified as subject to Full Board Review under the NEGRIHP 2022 are as follows:

- 1.1 Intervention research involving drugs, biologics or device;
- 1.2 Protocols including questionnaires and social interventions that are confidential in nature (about private behavior, e.g., related to sexual preferences etc.; or about sensitive issues that may cause social stigma, psychological, legal, economic and other forms of social harm;
- 1.3 Intervention protocols involving vulnerable subjects (patients with incurable diseases, persons in nursing homes, patients in emergency situations, ethnic minority groups, homeless persons, refugees, minors and those incapable of giving consent) that require additional protection from the REC during review;
- 1.4 Protocols that involve collection of identifiable biological specimens from vulnerable groups, etc.;
- 1.5 Resubmitted protocols reviewed in a previous full review with major modifications;
- 1.6 Protocol amendments that involve major changes;
- 1.7 Progress reports of ongoing studies that involve medium to high-risk procedures to human participants;
- 1.8 Final Reports previously reviewed in a Full Board Review;
- 1.9 Study Protocol Noncompliance;
- 1.10 Expedited review results which decision was not attained or which requires major modification;
- 1.11 Reportable Negative Event (RNE) and Early Termination Application are all subject to Full Board Review regardless of initial review classification; and
- 1.12 Progress Reports and Continuing Review Applications will be subject to Full Board Review if the initial classification of the study protocol was likewise full review.

Notwithstanding the list of criteria, the LNU-REC shall only review protocols under its mandate excluding all invasive and all other health studies outside of its expertise. In such cases, the LNU-REC will direct the Principal Investigator to apply for ethical review at the Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee (EVHRDC-ERC).

The LNU-REC may adopt online, face-to-face, or hybrid meetings. The REP Chairperson will decide on the type of platform to be used in the conduct of Full Board Review (See SOP 25 on the Conduct of Meetings).

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2. OBJECTIVE/S

The activity aims to ensure compliance with technical and ethical standards in the conduct of researches involving human participants and identifiable human data and materials.

3. SCOPE

This SOP guides the officers, members, and other persons who may be involved in the conduct of Full Board Review on submitted protocols. This SOP starts from the distribution of the protocol package to the Primary Reviewers and ends with the updating of the protocol file folder/database.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt of the protocol package from the REP Secretary	Primary Reviewers
Step 2: Conduct of the actual review of the protocol	Primary Reviewers
Step 3: Accomplishment of the relevant assessment forms	Primary Reviewers
Step 4: Presentation of review findings and recommendations during the REP Full Board Review	Primary Reviewers
Step 5: Summary of major points for decision/ action or recommendation	REP Chairperson
Step 6: Communication of committee action to the Principal Investigator	REP Member-Secretary, REP Secretary
Step 7: Filing of protocol-related documents and Updating of the Protocol Database	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt of the protocol package from the LNU-REC Secretary:

After the Chairperson of the concerned REP has decided on the classification of the protocol (whether exempt, expedited, or full board review), the REP Secretary will prepare the hard and soft copies of the protocol for distribution to identified Primary Reviewers.

Step 2. Conduct of the actual review of the protocol and accomplishment of relevant forms:

Once received, the protocol will be reviewed by the Primary Reviewers on its ethical aspect. The reviewers are given at least six (6) days to review and accomplish relevant forms.

Step 3. Accomplishment of the relevant assessment forms:

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The assigned Primary Reviewer will review the protocols and accomplish the Study Protocol Assessment (*Form 2.12.1*) and the Informed Consent Assessment (*Form 2.12.2*).

Step 4. Presentation of review findings and recommendations during the REP Full Board Review meeting:

The Primary Reviewers present their findings and recommendations to the REP during the Full Board Review meeting. If the Primary Reviewers cannot attend the meeting, the REP Chairperson exercises his/her prerogative to take over the role of the Primary Reviewer.

Assessment forms may be submitted in hard copies, duly signed and dated, by the Primary Reviewers and the REP members. Electronic copy of the assessment forms may likewise be submitted provided they bear the e-signature of the Primary Reviewers and the REP members.

If deemed necessary, the Primary Reviewers may call for a clarificatory meeting or dialogue with the Principal Investigator to request for additional information. The Primary Reviewers may echo the result of the dialogue during the Full Board Review.

The Primary Reviewers lead the discussion of the technical and ethical issues using the Study Protocol Assessment (*Form 2.12.1*) and the Informed Consent Assessment (*Form 2.12.2*) for an orderly exchange of ideas. Some major points to be considered during the discussion are the following:

- The protocol manifests scientific validity and contains all the standard sections to ensure scientific soundness. This would include statistical design, sample size, methodology, etc.;
- In assessing the degree of risk against the benefit, determine whether the risks are reasonable in relation to anticipated benefits, and/or if the risk can be minimized;
- Study participants are selected equitably especially if randomization is not to be used;
- Study participant's information sheet should be clear, complete and written in understandable language;
- There is voluntary, non-coercive recruitment of study participants;
- The informed consent is adequate, easy to understand and properly documented;
- There should be a translation of the Informed Consent document into the local dialect which should be comprehensible by the general public, if needed;
- The procedure for getting the informed consent is clear and unbiased;
- The persons who are responsible for getting the informed consent are named and they introduce themselves to the study participants;
- The research plan makes adequate provision for monitoring data collection to ensure the safety of study participants, where appropriate;
- There are adequate provisions to protect the privacy of study participants and to maintain the confidentiality of data, where appropriate;
- There is provision for compensation to study participants. There should be reasonable provision for medical/psychosocial support; treatment for study related injuries, as well as compensation for participation to cover expenses like transport and lost wages because of participation;

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- There are appropriate safeguards included to protect vulnerable study participants;
- Contact persons with address and phone numbers are included in the informed consent;
- There are appropriate contract or memoranda of understanding especially in collaborative studies;
- Examine community involvement and impact/benefit of the study to the community and/or the institution. If relevant, the reviewer looks for the following in the protocol;
- Community consultation should be described and planned with community leaders;
- Involvement of local researchers and institutions in the protocol design, analysis and publication of the results;
- Contribution to development of local capacity for research; and
- Sharing of study results with the participants/community should be described and discussed.

Step 5. Summary of the LNU-REP Chairperson and discussion on committee action and recommendation:

The REP Chairperson emphasizes the points discussed by all members in a summary, recommends action for compliance, and proposes the action. The REP's decision may be either of the following:

- Approved
- For Modification
- Disapproved

The decision of the board is arrived at through a majority vote. If there is a strong objection, the deliberation continues until the strong objector is convinced. A clarificatory interview with the Principal Investigator may be requested.

Step 6. Communication of REP Action to the investigator:

As soon as a REP decision is reached, the decision is communicated to the Principal Investigators within one (1) week from scheduled REP Full Board Review meeting (Refer to SOP 28 on Communicating REC Decisions).

The reviewers recommend approval if there are no issues. Forms such as the Notification of REP Decision (*Form 4.28.3a*) and Approval Letter (*Form 4.28.2*) are issued to the Principal Investigator.

If with modifications required, a Notification of REC Decision (*Form 4.28.3A*) and Letter for Modification (*Form 4.28.3b*) are issued to the Principal Investigator (See SOP 13 on Management of Resubmissions). Recommended revisions may be classified as follows:

- Minor modification- a recommended revision applying to protocols found to have particular aspect/s on its study or related document that do not impact on potential risks/harm to participants and on the integrity of the research (e.g., incomplete documentation, informed consent elements, unsatisfactory informed consent format). To wit:
 1. Administrative corrections like typographical errors or grammar
 2. Minor changes on items not directly related on procedure to be done

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3. Revisions which will not impact the risk-benefit analysis e.g. additional related literature requested

- Major modification - a recommended revision applying to protocols found to have significant aspect/s of the study (e.g. study objectives, recruitment of participants, exclusion/inclusion criteria, collection of data, statistical analysis, mitigation of risk, protection of vulnerability, etc.) that impact on potential risks/harm to participants and on the integrity of the research. To wit:
 1. If there will be major revisions on either the protocol or informed consent form, such as inclusion/exclusion criteria, safety issues, or methodology that may impact on the scientific validity of the protocol
 2. Revision will have impact on the risk-benefit ratio.

In the case of disapproval, a Notification of REC Decision (*Form 4.28.3A*) will be sent to the Principal Investigator who may appeal the decision to the REP (See SOP 20 on Management of Appeals).

Step 10. Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database:

The complete protocol folder is filed for safekeeping in the active study file cabinet. The electronic database is likewise updated to include the recent protocol submission (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files- Administrative and Study Files).

TIMELINE FOR FULL BOARD REVIEW

TIMELINE	PERSONS INVOLVED	ACTIVITY
4 days	REP Chairperson	Determination of the type of review and assignment of Primary Reviewers
1 day	REP Secretary	Sending of protocol package to the Primary Reviewers
6 days	Primary Reviewers	Review of research protocol and accomplishment of assessment forms
1 day	REP Members, REP Secretary	Full Board Review meeting
7 days	Member-Secretary, REP Secretary	Preparation of the minutes of meeting and communication of REP Decision to Principal Investigator
LNU-REC Monthly Full Board Review Schedule		
1 st Saturday	GS/F REP	Full Board Review for protocols coming from graduate school students and faculty/staff
2 nd Saturday	COE REP	Full Board Review for protocols coming from the College of Education
3 rd Saturday	CAS REP	Full Board Review for protocols coming from the College of Arts and Sciences

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4 th Saturday	CME REP	Full Board Review for protocols coming from the College of Management and Entrepreneurship
<i>N.B. If there are five (5) Saturdays in a month, adjustments will be made to make time for initial review.</i>		

6. FORMS

Form 2.12.1 Study Protocol Assessment
Form 2.12.2 Inform Consent Assessment
Form 4.28.3a Notification of LNU-REP
Decision Form 4.28.3b Letter for Modification
Form 4.28.2 Approval Letter

7. HISTORY OF SOP

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1	07/26/2023	Mary Ann S. Dalan Sheela M. Dela Cruz Tyrone Jr. O. Gil, Jr Ariel B. Lunzaga Ethel P. Marcellano Fabiana P. Peñeda Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez- Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.
EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.
CIOMS (2016). International Ethical Guidelines for Health-related Research Involving Humans.
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

LNU-REC shall participate in a Single Joint Review of a research project/proposal in which Region VIII is one of the chosen sites. The LNU-REC will accept invitations for Single Joint Review except those with strong ethical issues that need to be addressed or those outside the expertise of the REC members.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity guides the LNU-REC as to the process and its responsibility once it accepts an invitation from SJREB to join a Single Joint Review for a multi-site study.

3. SCOPE

This SOP starts from the receipt of invitation from SJREB to join a Single Joint Review to the filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt of invitation to join SJREB review	REO Secretary
Step 2: Request by SJREB for reviewers	SJREB Secretary
Step 3: Appointment of Primary Reviewers	REP Chairperson
Step 4: Participation in the SJREB Full Board Review	Primary Reviewers
Step 5: Communication of decision to the Principal Investigator	SJREB Secretary, REP Secretary
Step 6: Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt of invitation to join SJREB review:

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The REO Secretary receives an invitation from SJREB to participate in the review of a specific protocol and hands it to the assigned REP upon consultation with the REO Director. The REP Chairperson assigned to the protocol signs and submits the letter of intent to participate back to the SJREB Secretary. Upon acceptance of the intent to participate, the REP Secretary requests copies of the research protocol and other relevant documents.

Step 2. Request by SJREB for reviewers:

The SJREB requests Primary Reviewers for study protocols under SJREB review.

Step 3. Appointment of Primary Reviewers:

The REP Chairperson assigns Primary Reviewers from the members (usually, the Chairperson and Vice- Chairperson and the Non-Scientist Member). If not available, any Scientist-Member and Non-Scientist Member with no conflict of interest (COI) may be assigned. The Primary Reviewers do the preliminary review of the protocol and fill up the Protocol Assessment and the Informed Consent Assessment forms. The REP Secretary forwards the scanned forms to the SJREB Secretary.

Step 4. Participation in the SJREB Full Board Review:

The assigned Primary Reviewers attend the SJREB meeting and presents the assessment results. The REP accepts the decision of SJREB.

Step 5. Communication of decision to the Principal Investigator:

If the study has been approved during the SJREB meeting, copies of the minutes of the meeting and endorsements for approval are forwarded to the REP by the SJREB Staff Secretary. For protocols with strong ethical issues that still need to be addressed, the REP has the responsibility to inform the site Principal Investigator of the outcome of the SJREB review as well as the outcome of the local REP review. The REP accepts the joint review decision and includes it in the agenda of the next full board meeting.

Step 6. Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database:

The REP Secretary files the research protocol reviewed in an SJREB review, together with the duplicate copies of the approval letter, decision form, and accomplished SJREB evaluation forms in the protocol file folder. The REP Secretary logs the documents in the protocol file index and updates the protocol database for SJREB reviewed protocols.

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6. FORMS

SJREB Forms

7. HISTORY OF SOP

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1	07/26/2023	Mary Ann S. Dalan Sheela M. Dela Cruz Tyrone Jr. O. Gil, Jr Ariel B. Lunzaga Ethel P. Marcellano Fabiana P. Peñeda Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.

EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

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	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter II INITIAL REVIEW PROCEDURES	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 11 Research Involving Indigenous People	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. STATEMENT OF POLICY

The LNU-REC adheres to policies and regulations regarding research involving Indigenous People (IP). Research involving IPs must undergo ethical review for endorsement to the National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP). This is to ensure protection of the rights and benefits of the IPs as stipulated in the "Policies and Regulations regarding Research Involving Indigenous Peoples/Indigenous Cultural Communities" under PHREB Memorandum No. 2017-001

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This SOP aims to implement the legal procedures for the review of protocol involving Indigenous People.

3. SCOPE

This applies to research studies involving IPs submitted for review in the LNU-REC. The SOP starts from the submission of protocol to the filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Submission of research protocol	Principal Investigator
Step 2: Acknowledgement of receipt	REP Secretary
Step 3: Determination of type of review and actual review of protocol	REP Chairperson, Primary Reviewers
Step 4: Issuance of endorsement letter to NCIP	REP Chairperson
Step 5: Application for NCIP review and approval	Principal Investigator
Step 6: Submission of protocol with an attached NCIP approval to the REP	Principal Investigator
Step 7: Issuance of Letter of Approval to the Principal Investigator	REP Chairperson
Step 8: Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database	LNU-REC Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Submission of research protocol:

The Principal Investigator must accomplish the application forms and attach three (3) copies of the

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research protocol together with an e-copy sent to the LNU-REC email. The documents are submitted to the REP Secretary during regular office hours, Mondays to Fridays (See SOP 6 on Management of Initial Submissions).

Step 2. Acknowledgement of protocol received:

The documents are stamped received, dated and signed by the REP Secretary. A code will be assigned and the protocol information is entered in the Submission Log (*Form 4.29.1*) and Study Protocol Database (*Form 4.29.2*).

Step 3. Determination of the type of review and actual review of protocol:

The protocol is endorsed to the REP Chairperson to determine the type of review applicable to the research protocol (*Form 2.6.3*) and for the assignment of Primary Reviewers (See SOP 6 on Management of Initial Submissions). The Primary Reviewers assess the protocol using the Study Protocol Assessment (*Form 2.12.1*) and the Informed Consent Assessment (*Form 2.12.2*).

Step 4. Issuance of endorsement letter to NCIP:

If the protocol is technically and ethically sound, the REP Chairperson issues to the Principal Investigator an endorsement letter to the NCIP.

Step 5. Application for NCIP review and approval:

The Principal Investigator applies for NCIP approval with the endorsement letter from the REP. The NCIP may have recommendations to the protocol that the Principal Investigator should comply.

Step 6. Submission of protocol with an attached NCIP approval to the REP:

The Principal Investigator resubmits the protocol with NCIP approval to the REP.

Step 7. Issuance of Approval Letter to the Principal Investigator:

The REP shall take note of the changes in the protocol based on the NCIP review, if any. If the changes are not acceptable to the REP, the REP will initiate a dialogue with the NCIP. The NCIP has the final say with regard to socio-cultural and traditional aspects of the study. The REP then issues an ethical clearance to the Principal Investigator (*Form 4.28.2*).

Step 8. Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database:

The protocol documents are filed in the protocol folder and will be logged in the protocol database.

6. FORMS

Form 2.6.3. Protocol Evaluation Form
Form 2.12.1. Study Protocol
Assessment Form 2.12.2. Informed
Consent Assessment

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Form 4.28.2 Letter of Approval
Form 4.29.1 Submission Log
and
Form 4.29.2 Study Protocol Database.
Endorsement Letter to NCIP
Approval from NCIP Authority

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHOR S	MAIN CHANG E
1	07/26/2023	Sheela M. Dela Cruz Tyrone O. Gil, Jr. Ariel B. Lunzaga Ethel P. Marcellano Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures. PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB Memorandum No. 2017-001. Policies and Regulations regarding Research Involving Indigenous Peoples/Indigenous Cultural Communities.

WHO (2011). Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participants

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	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter II INITIAL REVIEW PROCEDURES SOP 12 Use of Study Assessment Forms	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

Comprehensive review of protocols submitted may be ensured through the use of a guided and detailed assessment forms to cover all aspects such as scientific design and ethical considerations in the conduct of the study and all essential elements in securing informed consent from human participants. In addition to the review elements described above, the Primary Reviewers should ensure the study protocol's compliance with existing international and national guidelines and policies.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

The assessment forms are designed to standardize the review process and to facilitate the reporting of the findings and recommendations pertaining to the protocol as well as related documents.

3. SCOPE

This SOP covers the use of the Study Protocol Assessment Form (*Form No. 2.12.1*) and Informed Consent Assessment Form (*Form No. 2.12.2*) in the review and assessment of protocols and related documents submitted to LNU-REC for initial review and approval. This SOP begins with the review exercise and accomplishment of the assessment forms and ends with the filing of the accomplished forms in the respective protocol folders.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Accomplishment of Study Protocol and Informed Consent Assessment Forms	Primary Reviewers
Step 2: Submission of assessment forms to REP Secretary	Primary Reviewers
Step 3: Inclusion in Meeting Agenda or preparation of Notice of Decision	REP Secretary
Step 4: Collation of all assessment forms for signature of REP Chairperson and consolidation of findings	REP Secretary
Step 5: Filing of Study Protocol Assessment Form and Informed Consent Assessment Form	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Accomplishment of Study Protocol and Informed Consent Assessment Forms:

The assigned Primary Reviewers and, in case of Full Board Review, all other REP members, accomplish completely and comprehensively the Study Protocol Assessment (*Form No. 2.12.*) and Informed Consent Assessment (*Form No. 2.12.2*) after the initial review of the study protocol.

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Step 2. Submission of assessment forms to REP Secretary:

The Primary Reviewers in an Expedited Review, or all present REP members during the deliberation in a Full Board Review, accomplish and submits the assessment forms to the REP Secretary on or before the actual meeting. All blocks in the forms including the Summary Sheet portion must be completely filled out and duly signed by the reviewers before submission to the REP Secretary (wet signature if hard copy, e-signature for online submission). Submission may be through physical submission at the REO or through online platform provided that the assessment forms contain the e-signature of the Primary Reviewer/REP members.

Step 3. Inclusion in Meeting Agenda or Preparation of Notice of Decision:

The REP Secretary, after collection of all filled-out assessment forms, performs the following functions:

- a. For protocols under Expedited Review, assessment is presented first during the Expedited Review meeting before informing the Principal Investigator. If approved, the protocol is presented in the Full Board Review. The REP Secretary prepares the Approval Letter (*Form 4.28.2*) signed by the Chairperson and sends it to the Principal Investigator. If there are revisions required, these are communicated to the Principal Investigator who has to resubmit the revised protocol and related documents before approval is given.
- b. For study protocols under Full Board Review, the Member-Secretary includes the protocol in the agenda of the next REP full board meeting for discussion and action. The Primary Reviewers present the protocol to the members with their comments during the monthly board meeting. An Independent Consultant may be asked to elucidate on the validity and ethics of the study procedure. An Approval Letter (*Form 4.28.2*) is prepared, signed by the Chairperson, and sent to the Principal Investigator once a protocol is approved. If there are revisions required, they are communicated to the Principal Investigator who has to resubmit the revised protocol and related documents before approval is given.

The REP Chairperson summarizes the important ethical issues and revisions required during the Full Board Review. The Member-Secretary includes all comments of reviewers in the Minutes of Meeting. Decisions of the REP are put to a collegial vote and a majority vote is needed to decide on a specific action. The REP Secretary, thereafter, notifies the Principal Investigator of the decision (*Form No.4.28.3a*).

Step 4. Collation of all assessment forms for signature of REP Chairperson and consolidation of findings:

The REP Secretary ensures that all concerned Primary Reviewers and in case of Full Board Review, all REP members, submit and sign duly accomplished assessment forms before securing the signature of the REP Chairperson on all forms.

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Step 5. Filing of Study Protocol Assessment Form and Informed Consent Assessment Form:

All forms duly signed by the reviewers and the REP Chairperson are filed in the corresponding protocol folder.

6. FORMS

Form No. 2.12.1 Study Protocol Assessment
Form No. 2.12.1a Study Protocol
Self-Assessment Form No. 2.12.2
Informed Consent Assessment
Form No. 2.12.2a Informed Consent
Self-Assessment Form No. 4.28.2 Approval
Letter
Form No.4.28.3a Notification of REP Decision

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Mary Ann S. Dalan Sheela M. Dela Cruz Tyrone O. Gil, Jr. Ariel B. Lunzaga Ethel P. Marcellano Fabiana P. Peñeda Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

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	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter II INITIAL REVIEW PROCEDURES	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC shall require resubmission of a protocol that requires either minor or major modification/s for a period not exceeding ninety (90) days after receipt of the decision. Failure to respond within the specified date will inactivate the application and study protocol will be archived. Resubmissions after ninety (90) days will be processed as initial review with a corresponding application fee. Within the given time frame, the Principal Investigator will resubmit the protocol package incorporating the REC recommendations. In case the Principal Investigator still fails to comply with explicit recommendations given by the REC during the initial review, a resubmission fee of Five Hundred Pesos (Php 500.00) for the 2nd and each of the subsequent resubmissions will be charged.

Protocols initially classified for Expedited Review but with minor or major revisions shall still undergo Expedited Review upon resubmission for as long as minimal risk is not elevated. Protocols initially classified for full review shall be subject to Expedited Review if with minor revisions and to Full Board Review if with major revisions upon resubmission.

Protocol resubmissions approved through Expedited Review will be reported during the Full Board Review meeting. Study protocols initially classified for major revisions will be included in the agenda of the nearest Full Board Review meeting for discussion and action.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

The management of resubmission ensures that the investigator and the REP will be guided as to the process when a protocol or related documents require either minor or major modification/s.

3. SCOPE

This SOP applies to protocols and related documents that require minor or major modifications as decided by the REP. The procedure begins with receipt of the revised protocol package and filing of these documents in the protocol folder/database.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt and coding of resubmitted protocol in the logbook	REP Secretary
Step 2: Notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers	REP Secretary
Step 3: Review of original recommendations and determination of type of review	REP Chairperson
Step 4: Review of the resubmission	Primary Reviewers

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Step 5: Communication of REP action	REP Secretary
Step 6: Filing of documents in the protocol folder and updating of database	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt and coding of resubmitted protocol in the logbook:

The REP Secretary receives the resubmitted documents, filled out Review of Resubmitted Study Protocol Form (*Form 2.13.1*), and official receipt of the application fee from the Principal Investigator for 2nd and subsequent resubmissions. The REP Secretary also takes note of the date, version code, completeness of the documents and ensures entry in the logbook.

Step 2. Notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers:

The REP Secretary retrieves the Letter for Modification (*Form 4.28.3b*) that pertains to the original protocol and informs the REP Chairperson and the assigned Primary Reviewers about the resubmission.

Step 3. Review of original recommendations and determination of type of review:

The REP Chairperson reviews the original recommendations of the Primary Reviewers and decides whether the protocol is for Expedited Review or Full Board Review, as per guidelines.

Step 4. Review of the resubmission:

The assigned Primary Reviewers conduct review by referring to the resubmission form noting the different recommendations made by the REP and evaluating whether these were satisfactorily addressed in the resubmitted protocol (*Form 2.13.1*).

The Primary Reviewers in case of an Expedited Review, or the REP members in case of a Full Board Review, discuss the issues related to the modifications to arrive at a decision.

Step 5. Communication of REP action:

For approved resubmissions, an Approval Letter (*Form 4.28.2*) signed by the REP Chairperson is issued to the Principal Investigators by the REP Secretary.

Step 6. Filing of documents in the protocol folder and updating of database:

The Secretary gathers all the pertinent documents related to the resubmission (revised protocol, assessment forms, excerpts of minutes, Approval Letter (*Form 4.28.2*)) and enters the relevant information on resubmission in the appropriate protocol folder/database.

6. FORMS

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Form 4.28.2 Approval Letter
Form 4.28.3b Letter for Modification
Form 2.13.1 Review of Resubmitted Study Protocol Form

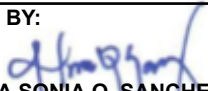
7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Mary Ann S. Dalan Sheela M. Dela Cruz Tyrone O. Gil, Jr. Ariel B. Lunzaga Ethel P. Marcellano Fabiana P. Peñeda Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

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Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.
PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants. PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

PREPARED BY:  ATTY. ALMA SONIA Q. SANCHEZ-DANDAY, PhD Director, Research Ethics Office	APPROVED BY:  EVELYN B. AGUIRRE, DA University President		
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DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.01	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 14 Review of Amendments	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC shall require the submission of proposed amendments for review and approval before the protocol's implementation. This requirement shall be explicitly stated in the Approval Letter (*Form 4.28.2*).

As a general rule, regardless of initial protocol review classification, minor amendments are subject to expedited review of the original Primary Reviewers for as long as minimal risks are not elevated while major amendments require Full Board Review.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity aims to ensure that the conduct of the study is in compliance with the approved protocol and that any change such as amendments do not impact on the safety and welfare of the study participants. It describes the REC review procedures for amendments of the protocol and related documents.

3. SCOPE

This SOP applies to the management and review of protocol amendments submitted by the proponent while the study is on-going. It applies to previously approved study protocols and related documents that are being amended later and submitted for approval by the LNU-REC. Any amendment of the study-related documents may not be implemented until reviewed and approved by the LNU-REC.

This SOP begins with the receipt and entry of the submission of amendment in the logbook of incoming documents and protocol database and ends with the filing of the amendment documents and REP decision in the protocol file.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1. Receipt and entry in logbook of the documents pertaining to request for amendment/s	REP Secretary
Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file	REP Secretary
Step 3. Notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers	REP Secretary
Step 4. Determination of type of amendment and review	REP Chairperson; Primary Reviewers
Step 5. Communication of REP action	REP Secretary, REP Chairperson

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Step 6. Filing of amendment documents and update of protocol folder and database	REP Secretary
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5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt and entry in logbook:

The REP Secretary receives the amended protocol package and a filled-out Protocol Amendment Review Form (*Form 3.14.1*) from the Principal Investigator specifying the list of amendments and reasons thereof and enters the date and pertinent information in the logbook of incoming documents.

Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file:

The REP Secretary retrieves the corresponding protocol file for reference and guidance of the Chairperson and Primary Reviewers.

Step 3. Notification of Chairperson and Primary Reviewers:

The REP Secretary notifies and sends the pertinent protocol file within five (5) days after receipt of the request to the REP Chairperson and the previously assigned Primary Reviewers.

Step 4. Determination of type of review: expedited or full review; major or minor amendments:

The Primary Reviewers review the requested amendments through Protocol Amendment Review Form (*Form 3.14.1*) initially accomplished by the Principal Investigator and recommend the type of review to the REP Chairperson who determines with finality the type of review applicable to the amendment requested. The amendments will be classified as Major or Minor with the following criteria:

- Minor amendments - recommended amendments applying to protocols found to have particular aspect/s on its study or related document that do not impact on potential risks/benefits to participants and on the integrity of the research; no substantial change in study population, methodology and consent.
- Major amendments - recommended amendments on protocols (e.g., study objectives, recruitment of participants, exclusion/inclusion criteria, collection of data, statistical analysis, mitigation of risk, protection of vulnerability, etc.) that increase risks/harms to participants and on the integrity of the research. Major amendments may include but are not limited to:
 1. Change in study design;
 2. Additional treatments or the deletion of treatments;
 3. Any changes in inclusion/exclusion criteria;
 4. Change in method; and
 5. Significant change in number of subjects.

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- Minor study protocol amendments that do not change the risk profile of study participants are classified for expedited review by the original Primary Reviewers. These are presented and discussed during the Expedited Review. Approved amendments are reported during the Full Board Review Meeting.
- Proposed major study protocol amendment that increases risk to study participants, as assessed by the REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers are classified for Full Board Review. These are included in the Agenda of the Full Board Review Meeting for discussion and decision.

Step 5: Communication of REP decision:

The REP Secretary communicates the committee action which could either be Approved, Minor Revisions Required, Major Revisions Required, More Information Required, or Disapproved through a formal Notification of REP Decision (*Form 4.28.3a*) signed by the REP Chairperson within seven (7) days after the deliberation.

Step 6. Filing of amendment documents and update of protocol folder and database:

The REP Secretary files the amendment documents and a copy of the committee decision in the appropriate protocol folder then proceeds to update the pertinent protocol database.

TIMELINE FOR REVIEW OF AMENDMENTS

TIMELINE	PERSONS INVOLVED	ACTIVITY
5 days	REP Secretary	Receipt of request, retrieval of file, and notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers
1 day	Primary Reviewers, REP Chairperson	Determination of the type of amendment and review
2 days	Primary Reviewers	Review of amendments
1 day	Primary Reviewers/ REP Members	Expedited Review/Full Board Review meeting and submission of signed assessment form to the REP Secretary
7 days	Member-Secretary, REP Secretary REP Chairperson	Preparation of the minutes of meeting and communication of REP Decision to Principal Investigator

6. FORMS

Form 3.14.1 Protocol Amendment Review

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Form 4.28.3a Notification of REP Decision

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Rulf J. Alcober Niceforo P. Casaus Mari Lina Georgia Cipriano Rufo A. Labarrete Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.

EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.02	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023 EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 15 Review of Progress Reports	PAGE NO. 60 of 142

1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC shall require the submission of progress reports every six (6) months or at intervals appropriate for the degree of risk and duration of the study protocol explicitly stated in the Approval Letter (*Form 4.28.2*). The REP Secretary sends a Reminder Letter for Continuing Review/Progress Report/Final Report (*Form 4.28.3d*) to the Principal Investigator at least two (2) weeks before due date. Failure to submit progress reports should be reported as Protocol Deviation.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity aims to ensure that the conduct of the study is in compliance with the approved protocol and that the safety and welfare of study participants are promoted.

3. SCOPE

This SOP begins with the receipt of progress reports and ends with the filing of the report and committee decision in the protocol folder and database.

As a general rule, progress reports which underwent Expedited Review will undergo the same type of review while progress reports reviewed at full board will go through Full Board Review.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1. Receipt and entry in the logbook of the progress report	REP Secretary
Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file	REP Secretary
Step 3. Notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers	REP Secretary
Step 4. Determination of type of review and actual conduct of review	REP Chairperson, Primary Reviewers/ REP Members
Step 5. Communication of REP action	REP Chairperson, REP Secretary
Step 6. Filing of progress report and related documents and updating of the database	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt of progress report and entry in the logbook:

The REP Secretary receives the Progress Report (*Form 3.15.1*) and enters the date and pertinent information in the logbook of incoming documents.

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Only Progress Reports (*Form 3.15.1*) submitted on or before 5 PM of the 4th Monday of the preceding month shall be included in the agenda for Expedited Review or Full Board Review for the ensuing month.

Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file:

The REP Secretary retrieves the corresponding protocol file for reference and guidance of the REP Chairperson and the Primary Reviewers.

Step 3. Notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers:

The REP Secretary notifies within five (5) days after receipt of the progress report and sends the pertinent protocol file to the REP Chairperson and the previously assigned Primary Reviewers.

Step 4. Determination of type of review and actual conduct of review:

The REP Chairperson shall determine the type of review based on the policy that progress reports of protocols that underwent Full Board Review in its initial submission shall undergo full review. Similarly, progress reports of protocols which underwent Expedited Review shall undergo the same (See SOP 8 on Expedited Review and SOP 9 on Full Board Review).

The Primary Reviewers/ REP members recommend approval of the progress report if there is no deviation or violation of REP approval. If there is any deviation or violation of approval given by the REP, the Primary Reviewers/ REP members recommend that appropriate action be taken by the Principal Investigator e.g., amendment of the protocol or consent form or explanation of deviation or violation (See SOP 16 on Management of Protocol Deviation and Violations Report).

Approval of progress reports reviewed by the Primary Reviewers by expedited procedure is reported during the Full Board meeting. For protocols subject to full review, these are included in the agenda of the next Full Board Review Meeting for discussion and decision. If amendments are recommended, the Principal Investigator has to submit an amendment report (*Form 3.14.1*). Amendments may either be Minor or Major (See SOP 14 on Review of Amendments).

If further action is recommended, the REP will issue a form for Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action (*Form 4.28.4*).

Step 5. Communication of REP action:

The REP Secretary communicates the committee action through a Notification of REP Decision (*Form 4.28.3a*) signed by the REP Chairperson within seven (7) days after the deliberation.

Step 6. Filing of progress report and related documents and updating of the database:

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	MANUAL TITLE	VERSION NO. 1
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The REP Secretary files the progress report, REP decision, and other related documents in the appropriate protocol folder and updates the protocol database.

TIMELINE FOR REVIEW OF PROGRESS REPORTS

TIMELINE	PERSONS INVOLVED	ACTIVITY
5 days	REP Secretary	Receipt of report, retrieval of file, and notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers
1 day	REP Chairperson	Determination of the type of review
2 days	Primary Reviewers	Review of report
1 day	Primary Reviewers/ REP Members	Expedited Review/Full Board Review meeting and submission of signed form to the REP Secretary
7 days	Member-Secretary , REP Secretary REP Chairperson	Preparation of the minutes of meeting and communication of REP Decision to Principal Investigator

6. FORMS

Form 3.15.1 Progress Report

Form 4.28.3d Reminder Letter for Progress Report / Continuing Review / Final

Report Form 4.28.4 Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action

Form 4.28.3a Notification of REP Decision

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Rulf J. Alcober Niceforo P. Casaus Mari Lina Georgia Cipriano Rufo A. Labarrete Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.02	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
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DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.03	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES SOP 16 Management of Protocol Deviation and Violations Report	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

Researchers shall report protocol deviations and violations in the conduct of approved researches. Protocol deviations are protocol non-compliance without significant consequences. Protocol violation reduces the completeness or quality of the data, or impacts the subject's safety, rights or welfare. Deviations and violations are classified on scientific and ethical levels so that the LNU-REC can adopt appropriate action (i.e., no action, site visit, training, withdrawal of participants, etc.).

Major protocol deviations and violations shall undergo a Full Board Review while minor protocol deviations and violations shall undergo Expedited Review by the original Primary Reviewers.

- a. The Principal Investigator shall document, explain, and report to the assigned REP any non-compliance from the approved protocol, whether minor or major, at the soonest possible time but not later than one month (1) from deviation/violation.
- b. The Principal Investigator may implement a deviation from the protocol to eliminate an immediate hazard to study subjects without prior LNU-REC approval, but must submit as soon as possible but not later than one month (1) from event, a report of deviation or change, the reasons for it, and, if appropriate, an appropriate study protocol amendment/s.
- c. Reporting of study protocol noncompliance is facilitated through the submission of Deviation/Non-Compliance/Violation Report (*Form 3.16.1*), together with documents deemed necessary by the Principal Investigator to clarify information indicated in the report. This comprises the study protocol non-compliance report package.
- d. Study protocol non-compliance report packages subject to Full Board Review received within the cut-off period every 4th Monday of the preceding month are sent to Primary Reviewers. These are included in the Agenda of the Full Board Review for discussion and decision.
- e. Study protocol non-compliance under expedited review is presented and discussed during the Expedited Review. Resolution is reported during the Full Board Review.
- f. The Primary Reviewers accomplish and return the signed Deviation/Non-Compliance/Violation Report (*Form 3.16.1*) to the REP Secretary on the day of the REP meeting together with the study protocol non-compliance report package.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

The purpose of this activity is to describe the LNU-REC review procedures for protocol violation/deviation. Review of protocol deviations and violations aims to ensure that the safety and welfare of human participants in the study are safeguarded and that the credibility and integrity of data are maintained.

3. SCOPE

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This SOP applies to the review of reports of protocol deviations or violations in the conduct of previously approved studies. This begins with the receipt and documentation of the report of protocol violations and deviations in the logbook and ends with the filing of all related documents and updating of the database.

This SOP provides instructions for taking action and maintaining records of various types of protocol deviation or violations which include any of the following:

- a. Failure of the investigators to comply with the procedures in the approved protocol.
- b. Failure of investigators to comply with national/ international guidelines for the conduct of human research, including those who fail to respond to the LNU-REC requests.
- c. It also covers action taken by the LNU-REC related to protocol violation/deviation reports submitted by the Principal Investigator related to any event at the site that is not in compliance with the previously approved protocol documents.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Submission of report on protocol deviation or violation	Principal Investigator
Step 2: Retrieval of the approved protocol file	REP Secretary
Step 3: Determination of the type of review	REP Chairperson, Primary Reviewers
Step 4: Inclusion of protocol deviation and violation report in the next agenda	REP Chairperson, REP Secretary
Step 5: Communication of REP action	REP Secretary, REP Chairperson, REP Member-Secretary
Step 6: Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database	REP Secretary

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5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Submission of protocol deviation or violation report:

The Principal Investigator submits Deviation/Non-Compliance/Violation Report (*Form 3.16.1*) to the REP Secretary together with the document deemed relevant by the investigator to clarify information in relation to the research protocol.

Step 2. Retrieval of the approved protocol file and notification of REP Chair and Primary Reviewers:

The REP Secretary checks the completeness of the documents and retrieves the original protocol file. S/he then notifies and sends the protocol deviation or violation report together with the retrieved pertinent documents to the REP Chairperson and the Primary Reviewers.

Step 3. Determination of the type of review:

The protocol deviations/violations will be initially classified as Major or Minor by the REP Chairperson based on the following:

- Minor Deviation/Violation are nonsystematic protocol noncompliance with minor consequence to the participant's rights, safety or welfare or integrity of study data; includes deviations that are administrative in nature.
- Major Deviation/Violation are persistent protocol noncompliance with potentially serious consequences that could critically affect the data analysis or put the participant's safety at risk.
- Minor deviations require an Expedited Review by the previous Primary Reviewers.
- Major violations require a Full Board Review.
(See SOP 8 on Expedited Review and SOP 9 on Full Board Review.)

Step 4. Inclusion of the protocol deviation and violation report in the next agenda:

The REP Chairperson includes the report on protocol deviation and violation in the agenda of the next meeting if it is for Full Board Review or the decision report if Expedited Review. Expedited Reviews are done by the Primary Reviewers, discussed and presented during the Expedited Review meeting, and reported during the Full Board Review.

In the Full Board Review, the Primary Reviewers present the documents to the REP members when study protocol deviation and violation reports are deliberated on. The members deliberate on both the type and degree of non-compliance and take the appropriate action.

The REP can recommend any of the following:

- submission of additional information
- submission of corrective action
 - o invitation to a clarificatory interview
 - o requirement for an amendment

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- o requirement for a site visit
- o suspension of recruitment or study until the following are met:
 - Additional information is made available
 - REP recommendations are implemented by the Principal Investigator and considered satisfactory by the REP
- o withdrawal of ethical clearance due to repeated violation
- o termination of the study on the basis of one or more of the following:
 - SAE reports indicate harm to participants
 - breach of a previously approved conduct of research
 - major changes, deviations or amendments of the approved protocol without approval by the REP
 - revision in the Informed Consent form without approval by the REP.
 - Repeated violation
 - Fraud

Step 5. Communication of REP action:

The REP Member-Secretary prepares the draft decision based on the report of the Expedited Review or Minutes of the Meeting in the Full Board Review. The REP Secretary collates and files the retrieved protocol documents, the report on protocol deviation and violation, and the decision letter signed by the REP Chair in the appropriate protocol file and updates the protocol database with the relevant information (See SOP No. 28 Communicating REC Decisions and SOP 30 Management of Active Files (Administrative and Study Files)).

- The Principal Investigator is notified of the REP decision on the study protocol noncompliance report. The REP may also issue the Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action (*Form 4.28.4*) or may send a Letter for Clarificatory Interview (*Form 4.25.1*), if needed.
- For submissions under Full Board Review and Expedited Review, the REP decision will be sent to the Principal Investigator within seven (7) days after the meeting.
- The Principal Investigator may be requested to provide additional information, submit additional documents, or implement corrective action.
- The Principal Investigator may file an appeal within thirty (30) days after the official decision letter of the REP is sent.

Step 6. Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database:

The REP Secretary stores the signed study protocol deviation and violations report package in the study protocol file folder. Files are managed in accordance with SOP 30 on Management of Active Files (Administrative and Study Files).

TIMELINE FOR REVIEW OF PROTOCOL DEVIATION/VIOLATIONS REPORT

TIMELINE	PERSONS INVOLVED	ACTIVITY
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5 days	REP Secretary	Receipt of report, retrieval of file, and notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers
1 day	REP Chairperson	Determination of the type of deviation/violation and review
2 days	Primary Reviewers	Review of deviation/violation protocol package
1 day	Primary Reviewers/ REP Members	Expedited Review/Full Board Review meeting
7 days	Member-Secretary, REP Secretary REP Chairperson	Preparation of the minutes of meeting and communication of REP Decision to Principal Investigator

6. FORMS

Form 3.16.1 Deviation/Non-Compliance/Violation Report
Form 4.28.4 Receipt and Recommendation for Further
Action Form 4.25.1 Letter for Clarificatory Interview

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Rulf J. Alcober Niceforo P. Casaus Mari Lina Georgia Cipriano Rufo A. Labarrete Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.03	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
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8. REFERENCES

EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants. PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.04	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 17A Review of SAE and SUSAR Reports	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC shall require the submission of Reports of Serious Adverse Events (SAEs) and Suspected Unexpected Serious Adverse Reaction (SUSARs). For investigator-initiated laboratory trials, onsite SAEs and SUSARs shall be reported within 24 to 48 hours after the event has come to the attention of the Principal Investigator while sponsor-initiated laboratory trials' onsite SAEs and SUSARs are reported within seven (7) days after the event. The evaluation of the SAEs and SUSARs shall be conducted by the Primary Reviewers within three (3) days from receipt and recommendations and shall be submitted to the REP for final action during the special meeting.

Offsite SAEs and SUSARs are reported to the REP by the Principal Investigator fifteen (15) days to ninety (90) days after the event for inclusion in the next Full Board Review.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

Review of SAE and SUSAR reports aims to ensure that the safety and welfare of human participants in the study site are safeguarded and that information on SAEs and SUSARs are properly documented and evaluated.

3. SCOPE

This SOP applies to the review of SAE and SUSAR reports submitted by investigators and sponsors to the LNU-REC to comply with ICH GCP. The LNU-REC reviews such reports to determine appropriate action to protect the safety of participants in an approved study. ICH-GCP E6 defines a serious adverse event (SAE) or a serious adverse drug reaction (ADR) as any untoward medical occurrence that at any dose:

- results in death,
- is life threatening,
- requires hospitalization or prolongation of existing hospitalization,
- results in persistent or significant disability or incapacity, or
- results in a congenital anomaly or birth defect.

A suspected unexpected serious adverse reaction (SUSAR) is a serious event the nature and severity of which is not consistent with the applicable product information. In the case of an unapproved investigational product, the event is not consistent with the Investigator's Brochure (IB). In the case of a licensed product, the event is not consistent with the approved package insert or summary of product characteristics.

4. WORKFLOW

ONSITE SAE and SUSAR

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1. Documentation of SAE and SUSAR report submission	REP Secretary
Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file	REP Secretary
Step 3. Notification of REP Chairperson	REP Secretary
Step 4. Submission of report to Primary Reviewers	REP Secretary

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Step 5. Inclusion of report of the Primary Reviewers in REP meeting agenda	REP Chairperson, REP Secretary
Step 6. Conduct of Special Meeting	REP Members
Step 7. Communication of REP decision	REP Chairperson, REP Member-Secretary, REP Secretary
Step 8. Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database	REP Secretary

OFFSITE SAE and SUSAR

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1. Documentation of SAE and SUSAR report submission	REP Secretary
Step 2. Initial review of Primary Reviewers	Primary Reviewers
Step 3. Inclusion of report of the Primary Reviewers in REP meeting agenda	REP Chairperson, REP Secretary
Step 4. Discussion during the Full Board Meeting	REP Members
Step 5. Communication of REP decision	REP Chairperson, REP Member-Secretary, REP Secretary
Step 6. Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the Protocol Database	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

6.1 ONSITE: Serious Adverse Event/s (SAE) and Suspected, Unexpected, Serious Adverse Reaction (SUSAR) Reports

Step 1. Documentation of SAE and SUSAR report submission:

The Principal Investigator accomplishes the SAE and SUSAR Report (*Form 3.17.1*) and submits to the REP Secretary within 24 to 48 hours from awareness of event. The REP Secretary receives the accomplished SAE/SUSARs report forms and enters the submission into the logbook. S/he notes whether the submission is within the required timeline. The REP Secretary informs the REP Chairperson of the submission and forwards the SAE Report Package comprised of the following documents to the REP Chairperson and to the Primary Reviewers within 48 hours of receipt:

- SAE and SUSAR Report (*Form 3.17.1*)
- SAE and SUSAR Summary Report (*Form 3.17.2*)

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- Latest Investigator's Brochure
- Protocol Summary
- Other supporting documents, if any

Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file:

The REP Secretary retrieves the identity of the Primary Reviewers and a tabulation of earlier SAE/SUSAR reports. If the Primary Reviewers assess that the report/s need/s immediate action, s/he will forward the report/s and his/her recommendation to the REP Chairperson for further assessment.

Step 3. Notification of REP Chairperson:

The REP Secretary notifies and sends the report and the retrieved documents to the REP Chairperson. The REP Secretary includes the SAE report/s on the agenda of the next special meeting.

Step 4. Submission of report to Primary Reviewers:

The REP Chairperson forwards the report and pertinent documents to the Primary Reviewers for action which should not be later than three (3) days prior to the next special meeting. Copies of the SAE and SUSAR Report (*Form 3.17.1*) are distributed to each Primary Reviewers together with the agenda.

Step 5. Inclusion of report of the SAE Primary Reviewers in REP meeting agenda:

For Onsite SAE and SUSAR, a special meeting shall be called for by the REP Chairperson (See SOP 26 on Conduct of Special Meetings).

Step 6. Conduct of Special Meeting:

During the meeting, the REP Chairperson calls for a decision on the SAE report/s with respect to his/her recommendation/s or Primary Reviewers assigned to the concerned study.

The committee may require any of the following actions as Decision Points:

- No further action; documents for filing
- Modification of participant inclusion or exclusion criteria to mitigate the newly identified risks or informed consent documents to include a description of newly recognized risks;
- Recommend implementation of additional procedures for protecting/ safeguarding participants;
- Suspension of enrollment of new participants or research procedures among participants who are currently enrolled (check consistency);
- Request information.
- Recommend suspension of the entire study.

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Step 7. Communication of REP decision:

The decision of the committee is communicated to the researcher within seven (7) days after the final deliberation (See SOP 28 Communicating REC Decisions).

Step 8. Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database:

The REP Secretary then logs the date of decision and store the signed forms in the study protocol file folder (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files (Administrative and Study Files)).

6.2 OFFSITE: Serious Adverse Event/s (SAE) and Suspected, Unexpected, Serious Adverse Reaction (SUSAR) Reports

Step 1. Documentation of SAE and SUSAR report submission:

The Principal Investigator must submit the offsite SAE and SUSAR report fifteen (15) days to ninety (90 days) after the event. The REP Secretary forwards the SAE Report Package to the Primary Reviewers and the Chairperson which comprises of the following documents at least seven (7) days before the next full board meeting (See SOP 09 Full Board Review):

- SAE and SUSAR Report (*Form 3.17.1*)
- SAE and SUSAR Summary Report (*Form 3.17.2*)
- Latest Investigator's Brochure
- Protocol Summary
- Other supporting documents, if any

Step 2. Initial review of Primary Reviewers:

The Primary Reviewers assigned to the particular study review and return the signed and accomplished SAE and SUSAR Report (*Form 3.17.1*) to the REP Secretary together with the SAE report package. The REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers may recommend any of the following actions:

- notation with no further action required
- further information or action required or
- suspension of recruitment or suspension of the entire study

Step 3. Inclusion of report of the Primary Reviewers in REP meeting agenda:

The REP Chairperson submits the recommendations to the REP Secretary for inclusion in the agenda of the next full board meeting. The REP Secretary includes the SAE reports on the agenda. Copies of the SAE and SUSAR Summary Report (*Form 3.17.2*) are distributed to each REP member together with the agenda.

Step 4. Discussion during the Full Board Meeting:

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During the meeting, the REP Chairperson calls for a decision on the SAE report with respect to the recommendations of the Chairperson and the Primary Reviewers. The REP can recommend any of the following actions:

- No action required, study to continue;
- Modification of participant inclusion or exclusion criteria to mitigate the newly identified risks or informed consent documents to include a description of newly recognized risks;
- Recommend implementation of additional procedures for protecting/safeguarding participants;
- Suspension of enrolment of new participants or research procedures among participants who are currently enrolled (check consistency)

Protocols with reported Off-Site SAE/SUSARs and decision arrived at by expedited procedure are reported during the Full Board Review Meeting.

Step 5. Communication of REP decision:

The decision of the committee is communicated to the researcher within seven (7) days after the final deliberation (See SOP 28 Communicating REC Decisions).

Step 6. Filing of protocol-related documents and updating of the protocol database:

The REP Secretary then logs the date of decision and store the signed forms in the study protocol file folder (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files (Administrative and Study Files)).

6. FORMS

Form 3.17.1 SAE and SUSAR Report
Form 3.17.2 SAE and SUSAR Summary
Report Form 4.28.3a Notification of REP
Decision

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Rulf J. Alcober Niceforo P. Casaus Mari Lina Georgia Cipriano Rufo A. Labarrete Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

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Practice E6 (R2)

International Ethical Guidelines for Health-related involving Humans (CIOMS) 2016

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating

Procedures. PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving

Human Participants.

WHO Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human

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World Medical Association Declaration of Helsinki, 2013

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.05	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
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	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 17B	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
	Review of Reportable Negative Events (RNE) Reports	PAGE NO. 76 of 142

1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC shall require the submission of Reportable Negative Event (RNE) reports within three (3) days after the event has come to the attention of the researcher. A special meeting shall be considered depending on the level of risk involved.

RNE is an adverse event or incident that has the potential to be classified by the REC as an unanticipated problem posing risks to participants or others. An incident is determined to be reportable to the REC when it is probably or definitely related to participation in the research and it occurs during the implementation of a research that impact the safety, dignity and well-being of participants and/or the study team and the integrity of data. These events need to be reported by Principal Investigator or Safety Personnel to the REC to ensure a continued favorable balance of risks and benefits in the study.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

The review of RNE reports aims to ensure that the safety and welfare of human participants and the research team are safeguarded and that information on RNEs are properly documented and evaluated by the team.

3. SCOPE

This SOP applies to the review of RNE reports. The SOP begins with the receipt and documentation of submission of RNE report in the logbook/database and ends with the filing of all related documents and updating of the protocol database by the REP Secretary.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt and documentation of RNE report submission	REP Secretary
Step 2: Retrieval of pertinent protocol file	REP Secretary
Step 3: Notification of REP Chairperson	REP Secretary
Step 4: Call for a Special Meeting	REP Chairperson
Step 5: Conduct of the Special Meeting	REP Members
Step 6: Communication of REP action to the researcher and to the institutional authority	REP Chairperson, REP Member-Secretary, REP Secretary
Step 7: Filing of all related documents and updating of the protocol database	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

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Step 1. Receipt and documentation of RNE report submission:

The REP Secretary receives the accomplished Report of Negative Events (RNE) (*Form 3.17.3*) and enters the submission into the logbook. The Secretary notes whether the submission is within the required timeline.

Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file:

The REP Secretary retrieves the approved protocol file and checks the identity of the primary reviewers.

Step 3. Notification of REP Chairperson:

The REP Secretary notifies and sends the report and the retrieved documents to the REP Chairperson who may decide to call for a special meeting.

Step 4. Call for a Special Meeting:

The REP Secretary prepares for a special Full Board Review. The Principal Investigator and other members of the study team may be invited for a Clarificatory Meeting through a Letter for Clarificatory Interview (*Form 4.25.1*)

Step 5. Conduct of the Special Meeting:

The REP Chairperson leads the discussion of the special meeting, summarizes the RNE report and informs the REP members regarding the presence of the research team for clarificatory meeting. The safety issues are evaluated, i.e., identification of risks to the participants / research team, nature and effectivity of preliminary interventions with or without the help of community constituents/authority, impact on integrity of data and completion of the research. The research team is excused and the REP members deliberate on possible options, as follows:

- ❖ recommend suspension of the study until risk is resolved
- ❖ withdrawal of ethical clearance
- ❖ submission of a plan to mitigate risk/harm
- ❖ require an amendment to the protocol

Step 6. Communication of REP Action to the Researcher:

The decision of the committee is communicated to the researcher within seven (7) days after the final deliberation (See SOP 28 Communicating REC Decisions).

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	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 17B	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
	Review of Reportable Negative Events (RNE) Reports	PAGE NO. 78 of 142

Step 7. Filing of all related documents and update of the protocol database:

The REP Secretary then logs the date of decision and store the relevant forms in the study protocol file folder (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files (Administrative and Study Files)).

6. FORMS

Form 3.17.3 Report of Negative Events
(RNE) Form 4.24.1 Notice of Meeting
Form 4.28.4 Receipt and Recommendation Further
Action Form 4.25.1 Letter for Clarificatory Interview

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Rulf J. Alcober Niceforo P. Casaus Mari Lina Georgia Cipriano Rufo A. Labarrete Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7. EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4. PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants. PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.06	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES SOP 18 Early Study Termination Application	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
		EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

Researches may be terminated early or prematurely because of various reasons such as poor participant recruitment, frequent occurrence of adverse reactions, insufficient funding, etc. In these cases, early protocol termination may be recommended by the research panel, the research director, the sponsor, the Principal Investigator, the LNU-REC itself, and/or other authorized bodies. A plan for early termination shall include reason/s for termination and shall also strive to ensure the safety and privacy of already recruited participants. Applications for early termination shall undergo Full Board Review.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This SOP aims to guide the conduct of review regarding early termination reports and to decide on how to proceed with the termination plan with primary consideration on the safety and well-being of recruited study participants and with adherence to the principles of fairness for all parties concerned.

3. SCOPE

This policy applies to the review of early termination reports. This SOP begins with the receipt of the application or recommendation for early study termination and ends with the documentation of the final early termination report and the updating of protocol database.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt of application or recommendation for early termination and entry in the logbook	REP Secretary
Step 2: Retrieval of pertinent protocol file and notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewer	REP Secretary
Step 3: Review of the termination package for recommendations	Primary Reviewers
Step 4: Discussion during a Full Board Review meeting for appropriate decision:	REP Members
Step 5: Communication of REP Decision	REP Secretary
Step 6: Filing of final early termination report and updating of database:	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt of application or recommendation for early termination and entry in the logbook:

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	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
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Application or recommendation for early termination shall be received by the REP Secretary and documented in the logbook. The Principal Investigator is informed to prepare and submit a protocol termination package. After submission of the package by the Principal Investigator, it is checked for completeness by the REP Secretary. The package should include the following:

- Early Study Termination (*Form 3.18.1*)
- Progress Report up until application for early termination (*Form 3.15.1*)
- The request for termination memorandum should contain a brief written summary of the protocol, its results, and accrual data.

Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file and notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers:

The REP Secretary notifies the REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers of the approved protocol and forwards the documents to the Primary Reviewers to study its current status.

Step 3. Review of the termination package for recommendations:

The Primary Reviewers conduct a full review of the contents of the early termination protocol package and make recommendations on how study termination will be carried out. The safety of data coming from participants that have already been recruited shall be of paramount consideration, as well as a plan that includes steps and procedures on how the safety and well-being of these participants can be ensured moving forward.

Step 4. Discussion during a Full Board Review meeting for appropriate decision:

The Primary Reviewers present their findings during the Full Board Review Meeting. After taking into consideration all comments and recommendations of the REP members, the decision may be one of the following:

- Acceptance of the decision for termination without further question or action
- Request for additional information regarding the application for termination

The REP Member-Secretary prepares a draft of the full board decision based on the minutes of the meeting which will then be signed by the REP Chairperson.

Step 5. Communication of REP Decision:

After the board makes a decision on the early termination of the protocol, the decision of the committee is communicated to the researcher within seven (7) days after the final deliberation (See SOP 28 Communicating REC Decisions).

Step 6. Filing of final early termination report and updating of database:

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	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
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	SOP 18 Early Study Termination Application	PAGE NO. 81 of 142

The REP Secretary keeps copies of the finalized early termination report for documentation and updates the database accordingly.

6. FORMS

Form 3.18.1 Early Study Termination
Form 3.15.1 Progress Report
Form 4.28.4 Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action

7. HISTORY

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Rulf J. Alcober Niceforo P. Casaus Mari Lina Georgia Cipriano Rufo A. Labarrete Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7. EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.
PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures. PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.07	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES SOP 19 Management of Continuing Review Application	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC shall require the submission of a Continuing Review Application Form (*Form 3.19.1*) before the expiration of the ethical clearance of a protocol. Protocols that were previously classified for Full Board Review in its initial submission shall undergo Full Board Review in its Continuing Review Application. Similarly, protocols that were previously classified Expedited Review shall undergo Expedited Review in its application for Continuing Review.

Renewal of the ethical clearance must be secured one (1) month before its expiry. The REP Secretary sends a Reminder Letter for Continuing Review/Progress Report/Final Report (*Form 4.28.3d*) to the Principal Investigator if no such application has been received before the expiry of ethical clearance. Ethical clearance is given for one year from the date of approval of the protocol.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity primarily aims to ensure that the conduct of the study is in compliance with the properly approved protocol and that the safety and welfare of study participants are promoted and the integrity and validity of data protected beyond the period of initial ethical clearance and up to the end of the study.

3. SCOPE

This SOP applies to the management of Continuing Review Applications submitted by the proponent while the study is still on-going but whose ethical clearance is about to expire. This SOP begins with the receipt of the application for continuing review and ends with the entry in the logbook and updating of the protocol database.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt of the application for Continuing Review and entry in the logbook	REP Secretary
Step 2: Retrieval of pertinent protocol files	REP Secretary
Step 3: Notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers	REP Secretary
Step 4: Determination of type of review: Expedited or Full Board Review	REP Chairperson
Step 5: Communication of committee action	REP Secretary
Step 6: Filing of documents in the appropriate protocol folder and updating of the Protocol Database	REP Secretary

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5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt of the completely filled out application for continuing review form and entry in the logbook:

The REP Secretary receives the Continuing Review Application Form (*Form 3.19.1*), logs, and enters in the protocol database the information included in the application.

Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file:

The REP Secretary retrieves the approved protocol and prepares a summary of the progress reports, protocol deviation/violation reports, SAE/SUSAR reports, report of negative events (RNEs) and corresponding decisions including the type of initial review during the period of effectivity of the initial ethical clearance.

Step 3. Notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers:

The REP Secretary notifies the REP Chairperson and the Primary Reviewers regarding the submission and the summary of the reports submitted and decisions made during the period of effectivity of initial ethical clearance.

Step 4. Determination of type of review: Expedited or Full Board Review:

The REP Chairperson shall determine the type of review based on the policy that protocols that initially underwent Full Board Review in its initial submission shall undergo Full Board Review in its Continuing Review Application. Similarly, protocols which initially underwent Expedited Review shall undergo Expedited Review in its Continuing Review Application provided there is no elevation of risk (See SOP 8 on Expedited Review and SOP 9 on Full Board Review).

The Primary Reviewers/REP Members conduct review and recommend approval of the application for continuing review if there is no deviation or violation of REP approvals. If there is any deviation or violation of approvals given by the REP, the Primary Reviewers recommend that appropriate action to be taken by the Principal Investigator e.g., amendment of the protocol or consent form or explanation of deviation or violation. If amendments are recommended, the Primary Reviewers will recommend submission of amendment report. Amendments may either be minor or major (See SOP 14 on Review of Amendments).

Approval or other recommendations by the Primary Reviewers for protocols subject to Expedited Review is reported during the Full Board meeting. For protocols subject to Full Board Review, recommendations are discussed during the Full Board meeting.

Step 5. Communication of committee action:

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The REP Member-Secretary prepares the draft decision based on the report of the expedited review or the minutes of the meeting in the full board review. The REP Chairperson finalizes and signs the Notification of REP Decision (*Form 4.28.3a*) forwarded by the REP Secretary to the Principal Investigator. Possible decisions include the following: Approval, Additional information required, submission of an explanation for failure to submit required reports or disapproval.

Step 6. Filing of documents in the appropriate protocol folder:

The REP Secretary files the application for continuing review, the recommendations of the reviewers and decision letter in the appropriate protocol folder.

6. FORMS

Form 3.19.1 Continuing Review Application

Form 4.28.3a Notification of REP

Decision

Form 4.28.3d Reminder Letter for Progress Report / Continuing Review / Final

Report Form 4.28.4 Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Rulf J. Alcober Niceforo P. Casaus Mari Lina Georgia Cipriano Rufo A. Labarrete Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.07	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
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	SOP 19 Management of Continuing Review Application	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version

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Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating

Procedures. PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving

Human Participants.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.08	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES SOP 20 Management of Appeals	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC shall consider the perspective of the Principal Investigators regarding the feasibility and acceptability of REC recommendations and decisions. Appeal requests must be submitted to the concerned Research Ethics Panel (REP) in writing no later than thirty (30) calendar days after the REC has rendered the written decision letter. Appeals of researchers shall undergo Full Board Review and shall be resolved within thirty (30) calendar days upon receipt of the fully documented appeal.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity aims to give appropriate guidelines on the management of appeals to ensures fairness, transparency, and comprehensiveness of ethics review taking into consideration the perspective of the Principal Investigator. This also describes the reconsideration and appeal process of the LNU-REC for unfavorable decisions rendered.

3. SCOPE

The SOP on Management of Appeals covers procedures that begin with the receipt of the appeal and ends with the communication of the REP action to the Principal Investigator and the updating of the protocol database.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt of appeal	REP Secretary
Step 2: Retrieval of pertinent protocol file	REP Secretary
Step 3: Notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers	REP Secretary
Step 4: Inclusion in agenda of the next regular meeting	REP Chairperson REP Secretary
Step 5: Discussion/deliberation on the appeal	REP Chairperson REP Members
Step 6: Communication of committee action	REP Chairperson
Step 7: Filing of documents and updating of the protocol database	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt of appeal

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The REP Secretary receives the Letter of Appeal (*Form 3.20.1*) from the Principal Investigator and enters the pertinent information in the logbook.

Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file:

The REP Secretary retrieves the pertinent file for reference in the review. The file includes the initially submitted protocol, Informed Consent Form, research tools and other related documents.

Step 3. Notification of REP Chairperson and Primary reviewers:

The REP Secretary notifies the REP Chairperson and the Primary Reviewers about the letter of appeal and awaits further instructions. The REP Chairperson shall acknowledge the appeal request in writing no later than seven (7) days following receipt of the letter and will outline the appeal process and requirements.

Step 4. Inclusion in the agenda of the next regular meeting:

The REP Chairperson instructs the REP Secretary to include the appeal in the agenda of the next Full Board Review, to ensure that the retrieved protocol and related documents are available during the meeting, and to inform the Principal Investigator to be available on the scheduled meeting in case there is a need for further clarification.

Step 5. Discussion/Deliberation on the appeal:

The Primary Reviewers summarizes the protocol and the previous discussion of the issues in the protocol as background to the appeal. The REP Chairperson presents the contents of the appeal and leads the discussion. The Principal Investigator may be called in for further clarification of issues and will be asked to step out after the committee has taken up the issues for clarification. The committee then decides (by consensus) whether to accept any or all of the points raised in the appeal.

Step 6. Communication of committee action:

Based on the deliberations, the REP Chairperson summarizes the decision points and instructs the Member-Secretary to prepare the draft decision letter. The REP Chairperson finalizes and signs the Notification of REP Decision (*Form 4.28.3a*) forwarded by the REP Secretary to the Principal Investigator or the Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action (*Form 4.28.4*). The Principal Investigator shall satisfactorily address all the conditions and concerns raised by the appeal board upon receipt of formal appeal decision letter to receive ethics approval. The decision of the REP shall be final and no further appeals will be granted.

Step 8. Filing of documents and updating of protocol database:

The REP Secretary files all the documents into the appropriate folder and updates the protocol database accordingly.

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	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023 EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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6. FORMS

Form 3.20.1 Letter of Appeal
Form 4.28.3a Notification of REP Decision
Form 4.28.4 Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Rulf J. Alcober Niceforo P. Casaus Mari Lina Georgia Cipriano Rufo A. Labarrete Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.
EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.
PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.
PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.09	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES SOP 21 Site Visit	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
		EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The Research Ethics Panel shall designate a team to conduct visits of selected sites of approved protocols. Moreover, site visits are part of the LNU-REC OVERSIGHT functions in the following conditions: high risk studies, receipt of significant number of protocol violations, receipt of complaints from participants and families, non-receipt of required after-approval reports, and if with multiple studies conducted by a researcher.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

Site visits are mechanisms within which the LNU-REC monitors compliance with approved protocols, ICF process and continuing protection and promotion of participant's dignity, rights and well-being. Site visits may be initiated for an onsite evaluation of a study site for a routine audit.

3. SCOPE

This SOP includes the steps in conducting visits to study sites for reasons set by the LNU-REC. This begins with the selection of the site to be visited and ends with the draft of site visit report, presentation of report during the meeting, discussion of the recommendations, filing of Site-Visit Reports in the protocol folder and updating of the protocol database.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Selection of site to visit	REP Chairperson
Step 2: Notification of Principal Investigator	REP Secretary
Step 3: Creation of site visit team	REP Chairperson
Step 4: Conduct of site visit	Site Visit Team Members
Step 5: Preparation and presentation of report during the meeting and discussion of recommendations	Site Visit Team Members REP Members
Step 6: Transmittal of final report and recommendations to the Principal Investigator	REP Secretary
Step 7: Filing of site-visit reports in the protocol folder and updating of protocol database	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Selection of site to visit:

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The REP Chairperson designates members to perform on-site inspection of selected study sites of relevant projects. Once selected, the REP Secretary checks protocol files and prepares all relevant documents needed for adequate and comprehensive site visit by the team.

Moreover, the REP Chairperson may take into account the following criteria in deciding which research site to visit:

- high risk studies;
- consistent non-submission or failure to submit after-approval submission requirements;
- reports of major protocol noncompliance;
- significant number of serious adverse events; and
- reports of complaints from study participants.

Step 2. Notification of Principal Investigator:

The REP Chairperson, through the REP Secretary, informs the Principal Investigator at least two (2) weeks before the scheduled visit through a Notice of Site Visit to Principal Investigator (*Form 3.21.2*). The letter provides site visit schedule details and instructions on what the Principal Investigator needs to prepare that will be used for the site visit. The documents to be prepared include the complete protocol document, informed consent forms being used, informed consent process, and all post-approval documents.

Step 3. Creation of a site visit team:

A site visit team is created for each site visit. The REP Chairperson assigns members of the site visit team. The team should be composed of at least three (3) people: two (2) Primary Reviewers of the protocol and the REP Chairperson/Vice-Chairperson or Member-Secretary or one (1) Primary Reviewer and two (2) Member-Officers. The site visit team members are informed of their assignment through the issuance of a Letter of Invitation to Members of Site Visit Team (*Form 3.21.1*).

The Secretariat prepares a Study Visit Package for each member of the Site Visit Team, inclusive of the Site Visit Report (*Form 3.21.3*) and a copy of the approved study protocol and related documents.

Step 4. Conduct of Site Visit:

During the visit, the designated site visit team shall:

- Review the study protocol;
- Review the informed consent documents and verify if the site is using the most recently approved version;
- Ask the Principal Investigator or any member of the team to explain the informed consent process;
- Review the post-approval documents and verify if the site is using the most recently approved version;
- Ensure that the documents are being filed properly, securely, and with confidentiality at the study site;

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- f. Make an overall resolution of the protection of the rights, safety, and welfare of human participants in the study; and
- g. At the end of the visit, the Site Visit Team will discuss the findings with the research team and solicit feedback.

Step 5. Preparation and presentation of report during the meeting and discussion of recommendations:

The site visit team completes the Site Visit Report (*Form 3.21.3*) and submits it to REP Secretary not later than seven (7) calendar days after the Site Visit.

The REP Secretary logs the date of submission in the Submissions Log (*Form 4.29.1*).

The REP Secretary files a copy of the report in the study file and places the Site Visit Report in the agenda for the next meeting. During the meeting, the REP Secretary distributes the completed Site Visit Report (*Form 3.21.3*) to REP Members along with the meeting agenda. The REP deliberates on the results of the Site Visit based on the rights, safety, and welfare of the study participants and makes an overall conclusion of protocol compliance.

Step 6. Transmittal of the final report and recommendations to the Principal Investigator:

The REP Secretary notifies the Principal Investigator of the REP action or recommendations through the form Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action (*Form 4.28.4*). The REP decision will be sent to the Principal Investigator within seven (7) days after the REP Full Board Meeting. The Principal Investigator may be requested to provide additional information, submit additional documents, or implement corrective action.

Step 7. Filing of the site visit documents and updating of the protocol database:

The REP Secretary files the accomplished Site Visit Report and the recommendations in the appropriate folder and updates the protocol database accordingly. (See SOP 30 on Management of Active Files).

6. FORMS

Form 3.21.1 Letter of Invitation to Members of Site Visit Team
Form 3.21.2 Notice of Site Visit to Principal Investigator
Form 3.21.3 Site Visit Report
Form 4.28.4 Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.09	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
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7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Rulf J. Alcober Niceforo P. Casaus Mari Lina Georgia Cipriano Rufo A. Labarrete Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

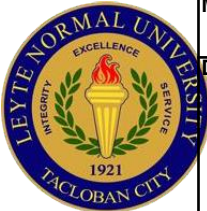
8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.

EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.10	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE	VERSION NO. 1
	RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	
	DOCUMENT NAME	APPROVAL DATE
	Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES SOP 22 Review of Final Reports	JULY 26, 2023 EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC shall require the submission of the final report not later than four (4) weeks after the end of the study. "End of Study" is defined as follows:

For LNU-initiated protocols - "End of Study" refers to date of dissemination of Final Report by the Department.

For non-LNU initiated protocols – "End of Study" will be based on the submitted Gantt Chart of the Principal Investigator.

Final reports shall undergo expedited review unless there are indications of deviations or violations of REC approvals. Submission and review of final reports signal the completion of the study and its acceptance by the research ethics committee.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity primarily aims to ensure that the conduct of the study was in compliance with the approved protocol and that the safety and welfare of study participants were promoted and the integrity of data protected until the end of the study.

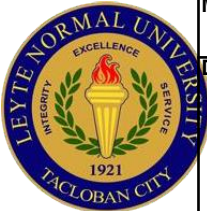
3. SCOPE

This policy applies to the management and review of final reports submitted by the investigators at the end of the study. This SOP begins with the receipt and entry of the final report into the logbook and ends with an update of the protocol database.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt of final report and entry into logbook	REP Secretary
Step 2: Retrieval of pertinent protocol file	REP Secretary
Step 3: Notification of REP Chairperson and Primary Reviewers	REP Secretary
Step 4: Expedited Review	REP Chairperson Primary Reviewers
Step 5: Communication of committee action	REP Chairperson REP Secretary
Step 6: Filing of the final report and related documents and updating of the protocol files	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

DOCUMENT NO. REM 6.10	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE	VERSION NO. 1
	RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	
	DOCUMENT NAME	APPROVAL DATE
	Chapter III POST APPROVAL PROCEDURES SOP 22 Review of Final Reports	JULY 26, 2023 EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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Step 1. Receipt and entry of final report in the logbook:

The REP Secretary receives and enters the date of receipt of the approved manuscript (e-copy) and the Review of Final Report (*Form 3.22.1*) in the logbook. For theses and dissertations, the Final Report will only be accepted when submitted together with a certification of approval/ Approval Sheet and/or clearance from the Department's Research and Technical Review Committee/ or Panel of Examiners.

Step 2. Retrieval of pertinent protocol file:

The REP Secretary retrieves the corresponding protocol file as reference in the review of the Final Report.

Step 3. Notification of REC Chairperson and Primary Reviewers:

The REP Secretary notifies the REP Chairperson and the Primary Reviewers of the receipt of the Final Report and awaits further instructions.

Step 4. Expedited review:

The REP Chairperson instructs the REP Secretary to include the report in the agenda of the next meeting and to ensure that the Primary Reviewers are given the necessary documents to check if the research was conducted in accordance with the REC approved protocol. The Primary Reviewers recommend approval of the final report if there is no deviation or violation of REC approvals. If there is any deviation or violation of approvals given by the REP, the Primary Reviewers may recommend for explanation of deviation or violation. Approval of the Final Report or other recommendations of the Primary Reviewers for protocols subject to Expedited Review are reported by the Primary Reviewers during Full Board Review.

Step 5. Communication of committee action:

The REP Chairperson finalizes the decision and signs the Notification of REP Decision (*Form 4.28.3a*) forwarded by the REP Secretary to the Principal Investigator.

Step 6. Filing of the Final Report and related documents and update of the protocol database:

The REP Secretary files the Final Report and related documents in the appropriate folder and updates the protocol database.

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6. FORMS

Form 3.22.1 Review of Final Report

Form 4.28.3d Reminder Letter for Continuing Review/Progress Report/Final Report
Form 4.28.3a Notification of REP Decision

7. HISTORY OF SOP

Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1	07/26/2023	Rulf J. Alcober Niceforo P. Casaus Mari Lina Georgia Cipriano Rufo A. Labarrete Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version

5.7. EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review

Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures. PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PREPARED BY:  ATTY. ALMA SONIA Q. SANCHEZ-DANDAY, PhD Director, Research Ethics Office	APPROVED BY:  EVELYN B. AGUIRRE, DA University President		
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DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.01	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 23 Preparing for a REC Meeting	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

Meetings are one of the major activities of a research ethics committee. They are the venues for deliberation and decision making regarding ethical evaluation of protocols and opportunities for REC to be informed and updated regarding its operations and relevant matters. It is important that the LNU-REC panels conduct regular meetings.

The LNU-REC panels shall hold regular meetings every Saturday of the month for the Full Board Review of protocols classified as such: 1st Saturday for Graduate School and Faculty REP; 2nd Saturday for COE REP; 3rd Saturday for CAS REP; and 4th Saturday for CME REP. Meetings for review of expedited protocols are scheduled on a Wednesday of the following week after the deadline and are set beyond office hours. In case quorum will not be obtained or if there are remaining protocols to be discussed, another meeting for Expedited Review may be called by the REP Chairperson on a Wednesday of the succeeding weeks or at any other day convenient for all reviewers involved prior to the scheduled Full Board Review.

Two special meetings may be held every year (one mid-year and one year-end) to assess LNU-REC performance. Clarificatory meetings may be held to resolve issues that require immediate attention such as safety of participants and protocol violation that impact research integrity. All meetings shall be held inside the institution or through the chosen LNU-REC online platform.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

The SOP on preparation for a meeting aims to contribute to a smooth, orderly, and efficient conduct of meetings.

3. SCOPE

This SOP provides instructions related to the preparation of the LNU-REC Panels' meeting agenda and its distribution to inform REP members and other interested individuals about the items to be brought up during a meeting. It is the responsibility of the REP Secretary under the supervision of the REP Member-Secretary to compile all documents/information submitted to the REP within the prescribed deadline and to include them in the next scheduled meeting.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Preparation of the agenda	REP Chairperson Member Secretary
Step 2: Coordination with physical plant	REP Secretary

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Step 3: Preparation of the presentation (Onsite/Online/Hybrid)	REP Secretary
Step 4: Notification of REP members and confirmation of attendance	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Preparation of the agenda:

The REP Secretary compiles all documents/information submitted to the REP within the prescribed deadline and includes them in either expedited or full board agenda for the information of the REP members

Step 2. Coordination with physical plant division:

The REP Secretary secures the venue for the onsite/online/hybrid meeting at least five (5) days before the meeting.

Step 3. Preparation of the presentation (Onsite/Online/Hybrid):

The REP Secretary ensures that the necessary equipment such as screen projector, laptop, peripherals, and food and beverages are available for onsite meetings. For online meetings, the REP Secretary should ensure that the laptop, documents, and platform link are ready.

Step 4. Notification of REP members and confirmation of the attendance:

The Chairperson or Member-Secretary supervises the REP Secretary in the preparation of the Notice of Meeting (*Form 4.24.1*) that includes the provisional agenda. A Notice of Meeting will be sent to the REP members at least five (5) days before the schedule and the REP Secretary conducts a follow up for confirmation of attendance to ensure quorum.

In case of expedited protocols, only the Primary Reviewers are required to attend. If the Primary Reviewers for the expedited protocols cannot attend, appropriate adjustments should be made. For the Full Board Meeting, all REP members are required to attend. In case quorum cannot be met, the REP Secretary informs the REP Chairperson and the Member-Secretary for appropriate adjustments to be made.

6. FORMS

Form 4.24.1 Notice of Meeting

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7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Candice C. Aguilos Kristel Joyce P. Cabacang Cristina N. Estolano Marc Y. Llarenas Jocelyn A. Tiopes Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.

EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.02	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING SOP 24 Preparing the Meeting Agenda	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The meeting agenda serves as a guide in the conduct of meetings. The standard agenda includes the submitted protocols within the prescribed deadline and shall follow an established template. The provisional agenda shall be included in the Notice of Meeting sent at least five (5) days prior to the meeting.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

The preparation of the Notice of Meeting aims to ensure a smooth, orderly, inclusive, and efficient conduct of meetings.

3. SCOPE

The SOP begins with the creation of the draft meeting agenda to the notification of the REP members, confirmation of attendance and the filing of the final meeting agenda.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Preparation of the draft meeting agenda	Member Secretary REP Secretary
Step 2: Preparation of the provisional meeting agenda	REP Chairperson
Step 3: Distribution of the provisional meeting agenda	REP Secretary
Step 4: Approval of the provisional meeting agenda	REP Members
Step 5: Filing of the final meeting agenda	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Preparation of the draft meeting agenda:

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The REP Secretary under the supervision of the Member-Secretary prepares the draft meeting agenda at least seven (7) days before the scheduled meeting using the meeting agenda template. The agenda includes the following:

Agenda of the Expedited Protocol Review Meeting (*Form 4.24.2a*)

- Date of preparation
- Date, time and venue whether onsite or online
- PROTOCOL REVIEW – All Expedited
 - New Protocols
 - Review of Protocol Resubmission
 - Protocol Amendments
 - Progress Report
 - Protocol Deviations/Violations
 - Continuing Review
 - Final Report
- Other Matters

Agenda of the Full Board Review Meeting (*Form 4.24.2b*)

- Date of preparation
- Date, time and venue whether onsite or online
- Call to order
- Approval of the Provisional Agenda
- Disclosure of Conflict of Interest
- Review and approval of the minutes of the previous meeting
- Business arising from the minutes
- New Business:
- Protocol Review
 - New Protocols under Full Review
 - Review of Protocol Resubmission
 - Protocol Amendments
 - Progress Report
 - Protocol Deviations / Violations
 - RNE Reports
 - SAE and SUSAR Report
 - Early Study Termination
 - Continuing Review
 - Final Reports
 - Management of Appeals

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- Site Visits Report
- Queries or Complaints
- Report of Protocols under Expedited Review
 - Approved Protocols
 - Approved Resubmitted Protocols
 - Approved Amendments (Minor)
 - Approved Progress Report
 - Decisions on Protocol Deviations / Violations (Minor)
 - Decision on Off-site SAE/SUSARs
 - Decision on Continuing Review Applications
 - Report of Final Reports
- Report on Exempt from Review Protocols
- Report on SJREB Protocols
- Other Matters

Step 2. Preparation of the provisional agenda:

The REP Chairperson reviews the draft agenda within three (3) days as basis in preparing the provisional agenda for inclusion in the Notice of Meeting.

Step 3. Distribution of the provisional meeting agenda:

The REP Chairperson instructs the REP Secretary to distribute the meeting agenda to all members via email and/or printed copy five (5) days before the scheduled meeting.

Step 4. Approval of the provisional meeting agenda

The REP members shall approve the provisional agenda during the meeting.

Step 5. Filing of the final meeting agenda

The REP Secretary files all approved meeting agenda in chronological order in a special folder.

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6. FORMS

Form 4.24.1 Notice of Meeting
Form 4.24.2a Provisional Agenda of the Expedited Protocol Review Meeting
Form 4.24.2b Provisional Agenda of the Full Board Review Meeting

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Candice C. Aguilos Kristel Joyce P. Cabacang Cristina N. Estolano Marc Y. Llarenas Jocelyn A. Tiopes Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

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EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.
PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants. PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.03	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 25 Conduct of Meetings	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

Meetings of the LNU-REC shall be presided by the REP Chairperson or Vice-Chairperson. The Expedited Review shall proceed when the Primary Reviewers are present. Full Board Review meetings shall proceed only when a quorum has been declared and shall be guided by the meeting agenda. The presence of conflict of interest among its members shall be disclosed prior to the discussion of protocols for review.

The Expedited Review agenda will be divided into initial submissions for the new protocols, expedited protocol for resubmission, progress report, continuing review, and final reports. For Full Board Reviews, the agenda will be divided into initial submissions for the new protocols, protocol for resubmission and lastly, review of the post approval submissions including final reports. Approvals and decisions or actions on protocols classified under Expedited Review will be reported during the Full Board Meeting. Exemptions from review protocols shall be reported after all post approval submissions. SJREB protocols shall be reviewed according to classification made by the REP Chairperson.

By policy, Full Board meetings shall be conducted onsite and Expedited Review meetings shall be conducted online. However, Full Board online meetings may be conducted when onsite meetings cannot be done. The REP shall allow attendance, participation, and voting of members not physically present through online/hybrid and other remote means of communication for the following reasons:

1. When onsite meetings cannot be held due to inclement weather, national disaster or calamities, and other similar events preventing physical presence in the office; and
2. When a member cannot physically attend nor vote but can participate and vote through online/hybrid and other remote means of communication.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

Meetings are conducted to come up with consensus decisions regarding protocols and REP operations and to be informed of pertinent administrative matters.

Setting internal guidelines and policies for onsite, online, and hybrid meetings shall ensure that all members have the opportunity to participate and vote during the meetings (including an opportunity to read or hear the discussion substantially). In addition, internal policies for the conduct of online or hybrid meetings shall ensure that submitted research protocols are reviewed and decided upon within the acceptable time frame.

3. SCOPE

This SOP describes the manner by which the REP conducts all its meetings (including holding of online or hybrid meetings and/or participation by absentia). It covers actions and activities from the time the meeting is called to until its adjournment. This shall apply for both expedited protocols and meetings for Full Board Review. This begins with the distribution of meeting materials and ends with the collection, storage, and disposal of such materials.

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4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Distribution of meeting materials a. onsite meeting b. hybrid or online meeting	REP Secretary
Step 2: Declaration of quorum	Member-Secretary
Step 3: Approval of the provisional agenda	REP Chairperson REP Members
Step 4: Declaration of Conflict of Interest a. onsite meeting b. hybrid or online meeting	REP Members
Step 5: Approval of the minutes of the previous meeting	REP Members
Step 6: Discussion of business arising from the minutes	REP Chairperson
Step 7: Review of protocols and protocol related submission	REP Members
Step 8: Report of result of expedited review and exempt from review protocols.	Primary Reviewer
Step 9: Discussion of operations- related matters	REP Chairperson Member-Secretary
Step 10: Adjournment	REP Members
Step 11: Collection, storage and disposal of meeting materials a. onsite meeting b. hybrid or online meeting	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Distribution of meeting materials:

- a. **For onsite meetings** – those members who have confirmed their attendance will be given a printed copy and/or receive an email of the minutes of the previous meeting and notice of meeting at least five (5) days prior to the meeting for review.

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- b. **For online or hybrid meetings** – those members who have confirmed their attendance will be forwarded an email of the minutes of the previous meeting and notice of meeting at least five (5) days before the scheduled meeting for review.

All hard and soft copies are prepared by the REP Secretary after approval by the REP Chairperson.

Step 2. Declaration of Quorum:

A quorum is not needed for Expedited Reviews. For the review of the full board classified protocols, a quorum is necessary and declared if attendees consist of 50% plus one (1) with a minimum number of 5 members, inclusive of the presence of one (1) non-institutional and one (1) non-scientist member. Onsite attendees will be required to sign the Attendance Sheet (*Form 4.25.2*).

The Member-Secretary notifies the members that the meeting will be recorded. S/he then proceeds to call on the names of the members and identifies them as non-institutional, non-scientist as well as guests or independent consultants.

Step 3. Approval of the provisional agenda:

The REP Chairperson or Presiding Officer invites the members to examine the provisional agenda (*Form 4.24.2a; Form 4.24.2b*) and to propose addition or deletion of items.

Step 4. Declaration of Conflict of Interest:

After the approval of the provisional agenda, the presiding officer inquires from the members if there is any Conflict of Interest (COI). The REP Members will abide by the following guidelines:

- a. On-site meeting – the REP Member who declares a COI for a particular research will be requested to leave the room prior to the discussion until a decision has been reached.
- b. Online or hybrid meeting – the REP Member who declares a COI for a particular research will be requested to log out from the online platform prior to the discussion until a decision has been reached. The REP Secretary will notify the REP Member once done so s/he can rejoin the meeting.

The REP Member-Secretary will record the time the members with COI left the room or logged out from the online or hybrid discussion and the time s/he returned.

Step 5. Approval of the minutes of the previous meeting:

The REP Chairperson will remind the REP Members that the previous minutes of the meeting has been sent through email and a page by page review will be done at the current meeting. Any correction, addition

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or deletion to the minutes of the meeting may be raised by the REP Members. Approval will be asked by the presiding officer from the REP Members present.

Step 6. Discussion of business arising from the minutes:

The REP Chairperson discusses any business arising from the minutes and a consensus shall be met after discussion.

Step 7. Review of protocols and protocol related submissions:

In the conduct of Expedited Review, it is the Primary Reviewer who presents the protocol by giving a background about the study and their comments (rationale, significance of the study, study objectives, methodology, and ethical considerations). The Primary Reviewers will then give the decision as follows: approved, minor and major modification, and will give suggestions which will be discussed at the full board meeting.

As for the Full Board Review, after the presentation of the Primary Reviewers, other members may give their comments and a discussion will ensue taking into consideration three (3) key points: technical, ethical, and informed consent issues. A clarificatory interview may be scheduled with the Principal Investigator during the current meeting or at a later date through a Letter for Clarificatory Interview (*Form 4.25.1*).

After all the issues and concerns have been discussed, the REP Chairperson asks for a motion regarding REP's action on the protocol (approved, minor and major modification, or disapproved) and shall request for a showing of hand regarding the motion. If a consensus has not been met, the REP Members who disagree will be asked to voice out their opinions. Recommendations based on the unresolved issues will be summarized and sent to the Principal Investigator. A board decision is arrived at when a majority vote is reached.

Step 8. Report of result of expedited review and exempt from review protocols:

The protocols which are set for Expedited Review will be discussed at a REP regular meeting. Only the Primary Reviewers of Expedited Reviews (or the REP Chairperson in their absence) are to make a report on the protocol to inform the REP Members of the findings. Should there be a need for a Full Board Review on the protocol, it shall be discussed upon resubmission.

Reports on exempt from review protocols are also presented and noted. Presentation of approved final reports is done during a full board meeting.

Step 9. Discussion of operations-related matters:

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The operations-related matters include administrative issuances, schedules, and assignment of members for REP-related workshops, lectures, and conferences as well as any updates in the policy and guidelines of PHREB, FERCAP and other accrediting bodies.

Step 10. Adjournment:

After all items in the agenda have been discussed/resolved, a REP Member must move for the adjournment of the meeting duly seconded by another.

Step 11. Collection, storage, and disposal of meeting materials:

Storage and disposal of meeting-related materials are governed by the following guidelines:

- a. Onsite meetings – all the printed copies of the Minutes of Meeting (*Form 4.27.1*) distributed must be given back to the REP Secretary for disposal and the original hard copy is filed. It is placed in a separate folder and in a locked cabinet.
- b. Hybrid or online meetings – it is the responsibility of the REP Secretary to secure the emailed copies of the minutes of the meeting in a password protected folder.

6. FORMS

Form 4.24.1 Notice of Meeting
Form 4.24.2a Provisional Agenda of the Expedited Review
Meeting Form 4.24.2b Provisional Agenda of the Full Board
Review Meeting Form 4.25.1 Letter for Clarificatory Interview
Form 4.25.2 Attendance
Sheet Form 4.27.1 Minutes of
Meeting

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Candice C. Aguilos Kristel Joyce P. Cabacang Cristina N. Estolano Marc Y. Llarenas Jocelyn A. Tiopes Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

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8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7. EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants. PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.04	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING SOP 26 Conduct of Special Meetings	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

Special meetings shall be held (onsite/online/hybrid) to resolve issues that require immediate attention such as oversight problems involving safety of participants, protocol violation that impact research integrity, RNE clarificatory meetings, clarificatory interviews/dialogues with the Principal Investigator, and urgent administrative and operational concerns of the LNU-REC.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

Special meetings are conducted to provide an opportunity for the REP to arrive at consensus decisions on issues requiring immediate attention regarding on-going study protocols and urgent administrative and operational concerns of the LNU-REC.

3. SCOPE

This SOP describes the process in conducting special meetings which begins with the preparation for the special meeting and ends with the collection, storage, and disposal of meeting materials.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Preparation for conduct of Special Meeting	REP Chairperson Member-Secretary y REP Secretary
Step 2: Conduct of Special Meeting	REP Chairperson REP members
Step 3: Collection and storage or disposal of meeting materials	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Preparation for conduct of Special Meeting:

A special meeting may be called by the REP Chairperson or proposed by a member of the LNU-REC. The decision to call a special meeting is based on the following criteria:

- Oversight problems requiring immediate action if delay will affect or have impact on the safety of participants;

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- Protocol violations that impact on research integrity;
- Occurrence of unexpected serious adverse events;
- Urgent LNU-REC activities such as but not limited to selection of new member or officer, approval of new or revised SOP, budget deliberation, accreditation applications, trainings and other unexpected administrative or operational events that would affect the LNU-REC; and
- Clarificatory meetings / interview / dialogue.

The REP Secretary informs all members and invited guests of the special meeting: its date, time and venue. For hybrid or online meetings, a link, notice of meeting, and agenda will be sent through various channels to attendees. Confirmation of attendance will be noted to ensure quorum during the special meeting (See SOP 23 on Preparing for a REC Meeting and SOP 24 on Preparing the Meeting Agenda).

Step 2. Conduct of the Special Meeting:

At the start of the meeting, members are informed that the meeting will be recorded. The REP Member- Secretary determines the quorum and the number of votes to reach a decision. Confirmation of quorum is done at the start of the meeting and re-confirmation is done every time a decision needs to be made. Quorum is defined as the presence of at least 50% plus one (1) member with a minimum number of 5 members inclusive of at least one (1) non-institutional and one (1) non-scientist member.

For clarificatory interview/meeting, attendees may be composed of the REP Chairperson or Vice Chairperson, Primary Reviewers, Principal Investigator, and if necessary, an Independent Consultant.

A special meeting may be conducted between the members onsite or through online and hybrid means which will follow the same sequence as Full Board Review with similar corresponding actions. Likewise, minutes of the special meeting shall follow the same sequence as regular meetings. Resolutions on the minutes of the special meeting will be reported accordingly during the Full Board Review.

Independent Consultants may be invited for a special meeting or during a clarificatory interview for purposes of clarifying a study protocol related to their fields of expertise. As in the case of regular meetings, they will not be counted for quorum and are not allowed to vote for full board actions.

Step 3. Collection and storage or disposal of meeting materials:

In case of onsite meetings, the REP Secretary collects all meeting materials, including documentation collected. All meeting materials must be stored in relevant study files as prescribed.

In case of hybrid and online meetings, the REP Secretary shall save and store the digital files in cloud accordingly in different password protected folders accessible only by the REP Chairperson, Member- Secretary, and REP Secretary.

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6. FORMS

Form 4.24.1 Notice of Meeting
Form 4.25.1 Letter for Clarificatory
Interview Form 4.25.2 Attendance Sheet
Form 4.27.1 Minutes of Meeting

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Candice C. Aguilos Kristel Joyce P. Cabacang Cristina N. Estolano Marc Y. Llarenas Jocelyn A. Tiopes Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7. EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.
PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants. PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.05	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING SOP 27 Preparing the Minutes of the Meeting	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

The Minutes of the Meeting shall be based on the approved agenda and shall be the basis of the LNU-REC decision on the protocols.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

The preparation of the minutes of the meeting ensures the proper documentation of the procedures and decisions during a REP meeting.

3. SCOPE

This SOP procedure includes REP actions related to the documentation of the proceedings of a meeting. This begins with the entry of preliminary information on the minutes template and ends with the filing of the approved minutes.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Entry of preliminary information on the minute's template	Member Secretary REP Secretary
Step 2: Preparation of the draft minutes a. onsite meeting b. hybrid or online meeting	Member-Secretary REP Secretary
Step 3: Notation of the draft meetings	Member-Secretary
Step 4: Approval of the minutes in the next REP meeting	REP Members
Step 5: Filing of the approved minutes	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Entry of preliminary information on the minute's template:

The REP Secretary under the supervision of the Member-Secretary organizes the documents in the minute's template ahead of the meeting.

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Step 2. Preparation of the draft minutes:

a. On-site Meeting

The Member-Secretary and REP Secretary are tasked with the documentation of the proceedings in accordance with the agenda. The Member-Secretary, assisted by the REP Secretary, may do real time note-taking while the template of the agenda is projected on screen. The information noted includes comments and recommendations on the scientific, ethical, and informed consent form issues. It is understood that the opinions and actions included in the minutes are collective and should not be attributed to a specific member. The REP Chairperson ensures that the Member-Secretary and REP Secretary fulfill the task.

b. Hybrid or Online Meetings

It is the Member-Secretary, assisted by the REP Secretary, who may do real time note-taking on the agenda template projected in the online platform and shared screen.

Step 3. Notation of the Draft Meetings:

The draft minutes prepared will be forwarded to the REP Chairperson within two (2) days for checking and notation. In general, the following items are included in the minutes of the meeting.

- Date, time, and venue of meeting
- Members' attendance (members present and absent)
- Presence of Independent consultants, principal investigators, guests and observers
- Time when the meeting was called to order
- Declaration of quorum
- Name of presiding officer
- Conflict of interest (COI) declaration
- Items discussed, issues raised and resolutions
- REP decisions and recommendations
- Name and signature of person who prepared the minutes
- Name and signature of the REP Chairperson and date of notation

Step 4. Approval of the minutes in the next REP meeting:

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The approval of the minutes of the expedited review meeting and the full board review meeting is done on the next meeting through a formal motion of any member which is seconded accordingly.

Step 5. Storage of the approved minutes:

The LNU-REC maintains a central file in a filing cabinet of all minutes of meeting by year to facilitate retrieval and storage.

Digital copies of the minutes of meeting are also filed by year in a password protected digital folder saved both in the external hard drive and cloud.

6. FORMS

Form 4.27.1 Minutes of Meeting

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Candice C. Aguilos Kristel Joyce P. Cabacang Cristina N. Estolano Marc Y. Llarenas Jocelyn A. Tiopes Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

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8. REFERENCES

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EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

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	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 28	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
	Communicating REC Decisions	PAGE NO. 116 of 142

1. POLICY STATEMENT

The LNU-REC panels shall communicate its decision to the Principal Investigator within seven (7) days after the expedited or full board meeting or deliberation as the case may be. The communication document shall include clear instructions/recommendations for guidance of the Principal Investigator and must be written in the prescribed LNU-REC template signed by the REP Chairperson.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This activity ensures that all stakeholders are properly, correctly, and promptly informed of the results of deliberations of the REP.

3. SCOPE

This SOP provides instructions related to the preparation of LNU-REC communications (hard/soft copies) regarding its decisions. This includes transmittal of communications and proper filing.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Classification and/or finalization of recommendations A. For Full Board Review- finalization of recommendations of the REP B. For Expedited Review- finalization of recommendations of Primary Reviewers C. For Exemption from Review- classification by REP Chairperson	REP Chairperson
Step 2: Transfer of information from meeting minutes to LNU-REC decision forms or templates	Member-Secretary REP Secretary
Step 3: Approval of the prepared decision document	REP Chairperson
Step 4: Transmittal of REP decision to the Principal Investigator	REP Secretary
Step 5: Filing of the decision document in the protocol file and updating of protocol database	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Classification and/or finalization of recommendations:

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The REP Chairperson classifies protocols submitted and finalizes the recommendations submitted based on the type of review done.

- A. Full Review- Finalization of recommendations of the REP members (See SOP 9 on Full Board Review)
- B. Expedited Review - Finalization of Primary Reviewers' recommendations (See SOP 8 on Expedited Review)
- C. Exemption from Review- Classification of REP Chairperson (See SOP 7 on Exemption from Review)

Step 2. Transfer of information from meeting minutes to LNU-REC decision forms or templates:

After classification, finalization of the reviewers' recommendations, and approval of the minutes, the REP Secretary, under the supervision of the Member-Secretary, prepares the following forms:

Approval Letter (*Form 4.28.2*)
Notification of REP Decision (*Form 4.28.3a*)
Letter for Modification (*Form 4.28.3b*)
Letter of Exemption from Ethical Review (*Form 4.28.3c*)
Reminder Letter for Continuing Review/Progress Report/Final Report (*Form 4.28.3d*)
Letter for Clarificatory Interview (*Form 4.25.1*)
Notice of Receipt of Protocol & Assessment for Review Fee (Non-institutional Electronic Submissions) (*Form 4.28.1*), and
Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action (*Form 4.28.4*)

Step 3. Approval of the prepared decision documents:

The REP Chairperson reviews, approves, and signs the decision documents within five (5) days from the decision of the committee for full review or the decision of the reviewers for expedited review.

Step 4. Transmittal of REP decision to the Principal Investigator:

Within seven (7) days after a decision has been reached during the expedited or full review, the REP Secretary sends the approved decision documents through email to the Principal Investigator. The Principal Investigator may also get a printed copy of the document at the Research Ethics Office.

Step 5. Filing of the decision document in the protocol file and updating of the protocol database:

All meeting deliberations and decisions as well as copies of the assessment forms of a protocol are filed in its specific protocol folder. The LNU-REC database is then updated every after a document is submitted or a protocol is completed.

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6. FORMS

- Form 4.25.1 Letter for Clarificatory Interview
- Form 4.28.1 Notice of Receipt of Protocol & Assessment for Review
Fee (Non-institutional Electronic Submissions)
- Form 4.28.2 Approval
- Letter Form 4.28.3a
REP
Decision
- Form 4.28.3b Letter for Modification
- Form 4.28.3c Letter of Exemption from Ethical Review
- Form 4.28.3d Reminder Letter for Continuing Review/Progress Report/Final Report;
and Form 4.28.4 Receipt and Recommendation for Further Action

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Candice C. Aguilos Kristel Joyce P. Cabacang Cristina N. Estolano Marc Y. Llarenas Jocelyn A. Tiopes Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

- BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.
- EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review
Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.
- PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.
- PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.07	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 29 Management of the Incoming and Outgoing Communications	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

LNU-REC communications can be in the form of printed copies or emails to facilitate documentation of all actions, instructions, and responses to queries. All incoming and outgoing communications shall be recorded properly and correctly in a log book (hard/soft copy). Communications pertaining to protocols are filed separately from administrative communications. All incoming communications shall be acted upon immediately.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This SOP describes the preparation and management of all LNU-REC communication records, thus, promoting an effective monitoring and tracking system for efficient operations and quality service of the LNU-REC.

3. SCOPE

This SOP provides instructions related to the preparation and issuance of an LNU-REC communication to various parties and management of such files. This begins with the organization of all communications received and issued by the LNU-REC and ends with filing of communication documents.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Organization of all the communications received and issued by the LNU-REC	REP Secretary
Step 2: Recording of the details of incoming/outgoing communications	REP Secretary
Step 3: Actions on incoming communications	REP Chairperson Members-Secretary y REP Secretary
Step 4: Filing of incoming/outgoing communications and updating of database	REP Secretary

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5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Organization of all the communications received and issued by the REC:

The REP Secretary organizes the incoming/outgoing communications and sorts these as follows:

A. Administrative-related

1. Incoming
2. Outgoing

B. Protocol-related

1. Incoming
2. Outgoing

Step 2. Recording of the details of incoming/outgoing communications:

The REP Secretary, supervised by the REP Member-Secretary, records all protocol and administrative- related communications separately in a logbook. These logs should have at least the following elements:

A. Administrative-related

1. Date of communication received / sent
2. Name of REP party contacted
3. Content of communication
4. Notation of any follow-up, if necessary
5. Contact information (address, telephone number, and e-mail) of sending party
6. Signature of individual who received the communication and completed the record

B. Protocol-related

1. Date of communication submission
2. Study information, i.e., sponsor, protocol number, principal investigator, etc.
3. Content of communication or submission
4. Notation of any follow-up, if necessary
5. Type of submission (if communication refers to a submission)
6. Name and signature of individual who received the communication and completed the record

Step 3. Actions on incoming communications:

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The REP Chairperson or the Member-Secretary, after being informed by the REP Secretary, initiates and finalizes the response on incoming communications. The REP Chairperson reviews and signs the outgoing communications.

Step 4. Filing of incoming/outgoing communications and updating of database:

The REP Secretary, with the supervision of the Member-Secretary, files a copy of the communication in the:

- Protocol file folder – for protocol-related communication
- Other appropriate LNU-REC communications folder – for administrative communication
- Digital folder which is then filed in the hard drive and Google drive.

Communication is filed in each folder from the most recent on top of the previous communications.

6. FORMS

Form 4.29.1a Submission Log (Protocol-Related)

Form 4.29.1b Submission Log

(Administrative-Related) Form 4.29.2 Study

Protocol Database

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
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8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.

EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.08	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 30	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
	Management of Active Files (Administrative and Study Files)	PAGE NO. 123 of 142

1. POLICY STATEMENT

LNU-REC protocol files are considered active files the moment they are received for review until such time these are inactivated either by completion or termination. These files shall be sorted, coded, and secured in a locked cabinet and in a password protected digital protocol folder which are arranged chronologically for easy identification and retrieval.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This SOP aims to describe the LNU-REC procedure related to the management of active protocol files, documentations, and records for accessibility and easy retrieval, as well as to maintain confidentiality.

3. SCOPE

This SOP provides instructions related to the management of active protocol files starting from its submission until its completion ensuring that all actions of the LNU-REC are properly reflected.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Designing of a standard coding system for all protocols submitted for review.	LNU-REC Members
Step 2: Filing of all submitted documents in an individual protocol folder and chronologically organizing the content according to the time of receipt	REP Secretary
Step 3: Updating and recording of active protocols	REP Secretary
Step 4: Storing of active protocol files in a secured cabinet and in a password-protected digital folder	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Designing of a standard coding system for all protocols submitted for review:

The LNU-REC designs a unique identifier or code to refer to each active file for efficient file management. Each REP has been assigned to the following code/number:

1- GS/F

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- 2- COE
- 3- CAS
- 4- CME

All codes will follow the format REP-YEAR-nth Protocol. For example, the 5th protocol submission in Year 2023 lodged at the COE REP will use the protocol code 2-2023-005.

Step 2. Filing of all submitted documents in an individual protocol folder and chronologically organizing the content according to the time of receipt:

The REP Secretary files protocol documents using one folder per study in sturdy file folders.

File folders are labeled using the code of the protocol file. Soft copies of active protocol documents are filed in each labeled digital folder. Exempted protocols and files are separated from regular protocol files.

The protocol file folder contains the following documents and should have a protocol index:

- All versions of study protocol
- Related documents that came with the study protocol
- Principal investigator and co-investigators' CVs and other similar documents
- Reviewers' assessment forms
- Amendment reports
- Continuing review applications
- Serious Adverse Event Reports or Safety Notifications
- Suspected Unexpected Serious Adverse Reaction (SUSAR)
- Non-compliance (Deviation or Violation) reports
- Participant Queries
- Site Visit Reports
- Early termination
- Approval letters
- Notifications of REP Decision
- Miscellaneous communication
- Final reports

Step 3. Updating and recording of active protocols:

Each protocol file information is entered into a secured LNU-REC database using its unique code. The REP Secretary, with the supervision of the Member-Secretary, updates the protocol file folder and the database every week.

The database can be a hard copy (logbook locked in the active files cabinet) or soft copy (password protected) and should have at least the following fields:

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	Management of Active Files (Administrative and Study Files)	PAGE NO. 125 of 142

- Protocol code
- Protocol title
- Principal Investigator details
- Submission date
- Full Board or Expedited Review date
- Primary Reviewers
- Review decision
- Approval date
- Date for progress report

Step 4. Storing of active protocol files in a secured cabinet and in a password-protected digital folder:

The REP Secretary shall keep all active protocol files in a secured file cabinet, with access limited only to the REP Chairperson, Member-Secretary, and REP Secretary. The lock and key will be entrusted to the REP Secretary. Password of digital folders shall only be known to the REP Chairperson, Member- Secretary, and REP Secretary.

Active files and other LNU-REC documents can also be accessed outside of regular protocol review (See SOP 32 on Management of Confidential Files).

6. FORMS

Form 4.29.1a Submission Log (Protocol-Related)
Form 4.29.1b Submission Log
(Administrative-Related) Form 4.29.2 Study
Protocol Database
Form 4.30.1. Protocol Index

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
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8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.

EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.09	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 31	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
	Archiving Files of Terminated, Inactive or Completed Studies	PAGE NO. 127 of 142

1. POLICY STATEMENT

Files of protocols which have been terminated, completed, or declared inactive shall be archived and kept in a separate storage for three (3) years in accordance with prescribed guidelines.

Retention Rules:

1. INACTIVE – Three (3) years;
2. COMPLETED/TERMINATED - Three (3) years;

2. OBJECTIVE/S

This SOP outlines the steps on how to archive inactive, terminated, or completed protocols ensuring efficient retrieval of information from the files for reference in compliance with national and international guidelines.

3. SCOPE

This SOP includes procedures related to the storage and retrieval of protocols that are classified as inactive, terminated, or completed. This begins with the acceptance of final or early termination reports and the identification of protocols as inactive and ends with the inclusion of the files in the archives and the updating of the protocol database and disposal record.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Acceptance of Final or Early Termination Reports and identification of a protocol as inactive.	Member-Secretary REP Secretary
Step 2: Updating of corresponding protocol folder	REP Secretary
Step 3: Transfer of the protocol folder in the archives and updating of the protocol database	REP Secretary
Step 4: Retrieval of documents from archive section	Member-Secretary REP Secretary REP Chairperson

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Step 5: Disposal of archived protocol files	REP Secretary
Step 6: Disposal of administrative records	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Acceptance of Final or Early Termination Reports and identification of an inactive file:

The REP members shall approve or accept the final report or early termination report of the protocol during a meeting (See SOP 22 on Review of Final Reports and SOP 18 on Early Study Termination Application). In the identification of an INACTIVE File, the REP Secretary informs the Member-Secretary of the failure of a concerned Principal Investigator to respond to the recommendations of the REP in the last three (3) months during which time the Principal Investigator has been appropriately reminded of the requirement.

This is included in the agenda of the next meeting where the protocol is declared inactive. Archiving notifications will be communicated to the Principal Investigator within seven (7) days after the Full Board Review.

Step 2. Updating of the corresponding active file:

The REP Secretary files the Final or Early Termination Report of the protocol in the corresponding protocol folder including the excerpts of the minutes where the report was approved or the protocol declared inactive.

Step 3. Transfer of the protocol folder in the archives and updating of the protocol database:

The REP Secretary checks whether the documents listed in the protocol file index are complete and removes extraneous documents. The REP Secretary transfers the folder to the archive section and updates the protocol database.

- An archive number is assigned to the protocol by adding the year of archiving as a suffix to the original protocol code. For example, if the Final Report of Protocol 2-2023-005 is approved in 2024, the archiving code is 2-2023-005/2024.
- The archiving data should be entered accordingly in the protocol database and in the Register of Archived Protocols (*Form 4.31.2*).
- The archived protocols shall be placed in an envelope labeled with the REP code, Surname of the Principal Investigator, and the date of inactivation. Such an envelope should be placed in a secured archives filer.

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Step 4. Retrieval of documents from Archive Section:

The REP Secretary, Member-Secretary, and REP Chairperson can retrieve documents either from the active protocol files or from the archives. Archived protocols can be retrieved within the three (3) year archiving period.

Step 5. Disposal of Archived Protocol Files:

Archived files must be reviewed at the end of the year. At the end of each year, the REP Secretary generates the following:

1. List of inactive protocols that are beyond three (3) years past its date of inactivation from the Study Protocol Database and
2. List of completed and terminated protocols that are beyond three (3) years past its date of archiving from the Study Protocol Database.

The REP Secretary submits the list to the REP Chairperson for review, verification, and approval of disposal in accordance with government rules.

The REP Secretary retrieves the archived protocols and disposes the files accordingly through manual shredding or with the use of a paper shredder to be witnessed by an LNU-REC Member or other REP Secretaries.

The REP Secretary shall update the Register of Archived Protocols (*Form 4.31.2*) as to date of actual disposal and the Register of Disposed Protocols (*Form 4.31.3*).

Step 6. Disposal of Administrative Records:

Guidelines and references that have been superseded or outdated for three (3) years must be removed from the files and disposed of properly. Removed document files are shredded and are permanently deleted from electronic and physical files in compliance with R.A. 9470, otherwise known as the "National Archives of the Philippines Act of 2007".

6. FORMS

Form 4.31.1 Archiving Notification
Form 4.31.2 Register of Archived
Protocols Form 4.31.3 Register of
Disposed Protocols

7. HISTORY OF SOP

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.09	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE	VERSION NO. 1
	RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	
	DOCUMENT NAME	APPROVAL DATE
	Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING SOP 31 Archiving Files of Terminated, Inactive or Completed Studies	JULY 26, 2023 EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023 PAGE NO. 130 of 142

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Candice C. Aguilos Kristel Joyce P. Cabacang Cristina N. Estolano Marc Y. Llarenas Jocelyn A. Tiopes Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

BatMC (2021). Batangas Medical Center Research Ethics Review Committee SOP Manual version 5.7.

EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.10	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 32	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
	Management of Confidential Files	PAGE NO. 131 of 142

1. POLICY STATEMENT

Access to LNU-REC confidential files shall be regulated and limited to LNU-REC members and staff. Other persons with legitimate interest in these files (e.g. institutional authorities, regulatory agencies, sponsors) shall be allowed limited access to specific files with proper justification. Researchers/Investigators shall be allowed access only to their own protocol files upon request.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

Management of access to confidential files helps protect the intellectual property rights of researchers and research participants (*in compliance with R.A. 10173 otherwise known as "Data Privacy Act of 2012"*) and enhances the credibility and integrity of the LNU-REC.

3. SCOPE

This SOP consists of activities in accessing confidential files including document handling and distribution. This begins with the receipt of the request to access and ends with the return of the documents to the protocol folder. The LNU-REC considers the following as confidential:

- Protocols
- Protocol-related documents (case report forms, informed consent documents, scientific documents, diary forms, expert opinions or reviews)
- Minutes of Meetings
- Decisions, notice of board action / notification of REP decision
- Certificate of Approvals
- Protocol-related communications

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt and logging of request for access to confidential files	REP Secretary
Step 2: Approval of requests for access and retrieval of documents	REP Chairperson Member-Secretary
Step 3: Supervision on the use of retrieved documents	REP Secretary
Step 4: Return of document to the file folders	REP Secretary

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	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt and logging of request for access to confidential files:

The Secretary receives and logs the request to access specific files and ensures that the individual requesting the document has affirmed to uphold its confidentiality through a signed Request to Access Document (*Form 4.32.1*) then forwards the request to the REP Chairperson or Member-Secretary.

Step 2. Approval of requests for access and retrieval of documents:

The REP Chairperson or Member-Secretary considers the indicated reason for the request and shall approve it if found satisfactory. The REP Secretary proceeds to retrieve the pertinent documents once approved.

Note: Regulatory authorities have full access to REP documents provided it is within their mandate (e.g. CHED, DOH, DOST, FDA) and upon reasonable notice to make the files available signed by the recognized official of the regulatory authority (e.g. CHED Regional Director, DOH Regional Director, DOST Regional Director, FDA Regional Director).

Step 3. Supervision on use of retrieved document:

The REP Secretary asks the user to sign the appropriate logbook, enforces the room-use restriction of documents, and limits photocopying by the REP Secretary on behalf of concerned Principal Investigators or on special cases of regulatory authorities and REP reviewers. If allowed by the REP Chairperson, documents may be brought outside the LNU-REC office but must be returned within one (1) day from borrowing and must be recorded in the Logbook of Request to Access (*Form 4.32.2*) and Logbook of Request of Copies of Documents (*Form 4.32.3*). All borrowers must leave one (1) valid Identification Card (any government issued ID, passport, etc.) before they can take the records out of the office.

Official Receipt of payment is required for the release of requested photocopied documents.

Step 4. Return of document to the files:

The REP Secretary returns the retrieved files to the protocol file folder.

6. FORMS

Form 4.32.1 Request to Access
Document Form 4.32.2 Logbook of
Request to Access
Form 4.32.3 Logbook of Request for Copies of Documents

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	SOP 32	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
	Management of Confidential Files	PAGE NO. 133 of 142

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Candice C. Aguilos Kristel Joyce P. Cabacang Cristina N. Estolano Marc Y. Llarenas Jocelyn A. Tiopes Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

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PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.11	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter IV DOCUMENTATION AND ARCHIVING	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
	SOP 33	EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
	Management of Queries and Complaints	PAGE NO. 134 of 142

1. POLICY STATEMENT

Queries and complaints from clients and research participants shall be attended to promptly and appropriately while exercising due diligence. The nature of queries shall determine whether they can be answered by the REP Secretary or referred to the Primary Reviewers of the specific protocol. All complaints shall be referred to the REP Chairperson who shall determine the level of risk involved. Complaints of minimal risk shall be referred to the Primary Reviewers for resolution. Complaints of more than minimal risk shall be taken up in a special meeting for deliberation by the committee *en banc* with the Primary Reviewers leading the discussion. The Primary Reviewers shall present all protocol-related resolved queries during the nearest Full Board Review meeting.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

Managing queries and complaints aims to promote public trust and confidence in the institution, especially in the LNU-REC and ensures that the rights and well-being of participants are attended to. Communication of queries and complaints, especially from the research participants, provides mechanisms that contribute both to maintaining transparency of LNU-REC decision-making processes, as well as the empowerment of research participants.

3. SCOPE

This SOP is limited to queries and complaints of research participants, or their families, in protocols that have been issued an ethical approval by the LNU-REC. The LNU-REC will also accept communications of queries, notifications, and complaints from other parties provided these communications are relevant to the LNU-REC oversight function. This SOP begins with the receipt, logging, and acknowledgement of queries and complaints, and ends with the logging of the response and inclusion in the agenda of the REP meeting.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Receipt, logging, and acknowledgement of queries and complaints	REP Secretary
Step 2: Referral of query or complaint to competent authority 2.1 Referral of protocol-related query to Primary Reviewers. 2.2. Referral of all complaints (non-protocol related) to the REP Chairperson	REP Secretary

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	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
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	Management of Queries and Complaints	PAGE NO. 135 of 142

Step 3: Formulation of response 1. Protocol-related queries 2. Minimal-risk complaints 3. More than minimal risk complaints: <i>en banc</i> committee	Primary Reviewers REP Chairperson REP Members
Step 4: Communication of response	Member-Secretary REP Secretary
Step 5: Logging of the response and inclusion in the agenda of the REP meeting	REP Secretary
Step 6: Filing of Query/Complaint and Query/Complaint Response on relevant protocol folders	REP Secretary

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Receipt, logging, and acknowledgement of queries and complaints:

Each REP will maintain a logbook dedicated to queries and complaints which will include date, time, name of concerned party, specific protocol number and title, name of Principal Investigator, and nature of query or complaint. The complainants shall accomplish the form on Query/Complaint (*Form 4.33.1*) to be properly coded by the REP Secretary.

Step 2. Referral of query or complaint to competent authority:

The REP Secretary refers queries and complaints to the REP Chairperson to determine the level of risk affected by the issue.

Non-protocol related queries or complaints shall be referred by the REP Secretary to the REP Chairperson. Minimal risk complaints are referred to the Primary Reviewers of the concerned protocol as well as other protocol-related queries.

Complaints that involve more than minimal risk are referred to the REP Members through a special meeting that shall be called. The REP Secretary notifies the concerned Primary Reviewers that they will lead the discussion and provides relevant materials to them in advance as reference.

Step 3. Formulation of response:

For queries, the Primary Reviewers shall accomplish the portion on "Action Taken" on the Query/Complaints (*Form 4.33.1*).

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For minimal risk complaints, the Primary Reviewers accomplish Query/Complaints form (*Form 4.33.1*). For more than minimal risk, the REP may choose any of the following options:

- a. Constitute a site visit team to gather more information, verification, and clarification regarding the source and cause/s of the complaint for its early resolution;
- b. Designate the Primary Reviewers to meet with the complainants and the researcher (preferably separately) for clarification of issues and obtain suggestions for resolution; and
- c. Formulate recommendation, if satisfied with the adequacy of information and/or:
 - request for explanation/justification from the researcher
 - accept request/demand of participant
 - recommend suspension of further recruitment
 - recommend amendment of protocol and re-consent of participants
 - others.

Step 4. Communication of response:

The REP Secretary and the Member-Secretary prepare the official communication of response to queries and complaints using the form for Query/Complaint Response (*Form 4.33.2*) to be duly signed by the REP Chairperson.

Step 5. Logging of the response and inclusion in the agenda of the REP meeting:

The REP Secretary logs the response and includes it in the agenda of the next REP Full Board meeting.

Step 6. Filing of copies of Query/Complaint Form and Query/Complaint Response Form:

The REP Secretary stores the signed forms in the protocol folder.

6. FORMS

- Form 4.33.1 Query/Complaint
- Form 4.33.2 Query/Complaint Response

DOCUMENT NO. REM 7.11	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
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		EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Candice C. Aguilos Kristel Joyce P. Cabacang Cristina N. Estolano Marc Y. Llarenas Jocelyn A. Tiopes Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

8. REFERENCES

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EVHRDC (2022). Eastern Visayas Health Research and Development Consortium-Ethics Review Committee Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Manual version 4.

PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

PREPARED BY:  ATTY. ALMA SONIA Q. SANCHEZ-DANDAY, PhD Director, Research Ethics Office	APPROVED BY:  EVELYN B. AGUIRRE, DA University President		
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DOCUMENT NO. REM 8.01	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter V WRITING AND REVISION OF SOPS SOP 34 Writing and Revision of LNU-REC SOPs	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
		EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023
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1. POLICY STATEMENT

This SOP provides instruction on how the LNU-REC Standard Operating Procedures are prepared, approved, and distributed. The SOPs ensure efficiency, transparency, and consistency of LNU-REC operations. The SOP manual needs to be periodically reviewed so as to determine the revision needs to respond to emerging operational issues of the LNU-REC. The LNU-REC shall propose the designation of a team to review its set of SOPs every two (2) years to ensure its continuing relevance and effectiveness.

2. OBJECTIVE/S

Writing and revising SOPs ensures continuing quality assurance of LNU-REC functions.

3. SCOPE

This SOP on writing and revising the LNU-REC SOP covers the procedures the LNU-REC has put in place in order to be able to develop new and relevant SOPs and to revise and update old SOPs. This SOP applies to all LNU-REC activities involved in the development of its SOPs and their revisions as published and distributed by LNU. This SOP begins with the proposal and approval for revision or writing of a new SOP and ends with the inclusion of the new or revised SOP in the Research Ethics Manual and its dissemination.

4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Step 1: Proposal for the writing/ revision of SOPs	LNU-REC Members
Step 2: Designation of the SOP-writing technical team	University President
Step 3: Drafting of the SOP revision or new SOP	SOP-Writing Technical Team (LNU-REC Members)
Step 4: Review of the SOP	LNU-REC Members
Step 5: Submission of the SOP	REP Chairpersons REO Director REO Secretary
Step 6: Final approval of the SOP	LNU Board of Regents University President
Step 7: Inclusion of the new or revised SOP in the Research Ethics Manual and its dissemination	REO Secretary REO Director QMSO

DOCUMENT NO. REM 8.01	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME Chapter V WRITING AND REVISION OF SOPS SOP 34 Writing and Revision of LNU-REC SOPs	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES

Step 1. Proposal for the writing/ revision of SOPs:

Aside from findings of regulatory agencies mandating the revisions of existing LNU-REC SOPs or the creation of a new one, any LNU-REC Member may propose the revision of an SOP using Request for Revision of an SOP or Guideline (*Form 5.34.1*). The REP Chairperson determines the need for writing or revising the SOP and advises the proponent to present it during regular/special meeting for deliberation. Once found to be with merit, the REP Chairperson presents the request and the outcome of the deliberation to the REO Director.

Step 2. Designation of the SOP-writing technical team:

The University President, through endorsements from the REO Director and the Research Council representative, designates an SOP-writing technical team and may assign members and non-members, as needed, to be part of the team. The team receives an orientation from the REP Chairpersons regarding their duties and responsibilities and may organize SOP-writing workshops to facilitate the drafting of SOPs.

Step 3. Drafting of the SOP revision or new SOP:

The design, format, and layout of an SOP is based on the following guidelines and SOP Template (*Form 5.34.2*):

- a) **Title**, which is descriptive of its content;
- b) **Number and Version**, which follows the SOP in coding of SOPs and Guidelines;
- c) **Policy Statement**, which dictates the way the committee intends to conduct the SOP;
- d) **Objective/s**, which defines the purpose and intended outcome;
- e) **Scope**, which defines the extent of coverage of the SOP and its limitations;
- f) **Workflow**, which is a matrix briefly showing the different steps involved in the activity and the responsible persons;
- g) **Detailed Description of Procedures**, which elaborates the steps outlined in the workflow;
- h) **Forms**, which are documents to be filled out or accomplished by different parties as required by the SOP;
- i) **History**, which is a tabulation of the version dates and number, authors, and the enumeration of major changes that the SOP has undergone;
- j) **References**, which lists the instruments used to draft the Guidelines such as other SOPs, guidelines or policies; and
- k) **Glossary**, which is a list of terms, including acronyms and abbreviations used in the SOP that need to be defined or explained compiled and found at the end of all SOPs.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 8.01	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE	VERSION NO. 1
	RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	
	DOCUMENT NAME	APPROVAL DATE
	Chapter V WRITING AND REVISION OF SOPS SOP 34 Writing and Revision of LNU-REC SOPs	JULY 26, 2023 EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023 PAGE NO. 140 of 142

Each SOP should be given a number and a title that is self-explanatory and is easily understood. The LNU-REC SOPs use the format SOP XX where XX is the number corresponding to a specific SOP. Moreover, these SOPs are assigned with a specific document number under the Research Ethics Manual from REM 4.01 to REM 8.01. The header of each page of the Research Ethics Manual incorporating the SOPs will contain the chapter number, SOP number and title of the SOP, the version number and dates of approval and effectivity of the version.

Step 4. Review of the SOP:

The LNU-REC members deliberate on the drafted SOP in terms of relevance to the current trends in research ethics review.

As the LNU-REC sees fit, an existing SOP may be revised. A revision should be substantial (correction of grammatical errors is not considered substantial; a change in the identifier of an SOP is considered substantial).

- Minor changes refer to editorial, grammatical, or administrative changes that have no substantial effect on procedures.
- Major changes, on the other hand, are those that have a substantial effect on procedures, definitions, requirements, and similar considerations. When an SOP is difficult to understand or does not cover what it should, a revision may become necessary.

When the need for a revision of the SOP has been identified and agreed on, a draft will be written by the SOP-writing technical team. The team drafts the revision, noting that the SOP identifier reflects the chronological number and date of the revision. If an SOP supersedes a previous version, the team indicates the previous SOP version and the main changes under the part "History of SOP".

A draft of the revised SOP will be discussed and reviewed by the LNU-REC members. Once found satisfactory, this draft version will be forwarded by the REP Chairpersons to the REO Director.

Step 5. Submission of the SOP:

The REP Chairpersons, through the REP Secretaries, prepare the final form of the SOP incorporating the necessary recommendations, corrections, agreement and indicating the SOP No., Version No., Approval Date and Effectivity Date with the signature of the REP Chairpersons and submit it to the REO Director. The REO Director, through the REO Secretary, submits the copy of the SOP revision to the Research Council and secures the endorsement from the Council representative prior to its submission to the Administrative Council and then the Board of Regents.

DOCUMENT NO. REM 8.01	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
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Step 6. Final approval of the SOP:

The University President includes the request for approval of the LNU-REC SOP revisions in the agenda for the next LNU Board of Regents' Meeting. Once approved by the Board, the University President affixes his/her signature in the documents.

Step 7. Inclusion of the new or revised SOP in the Research Ethics Manual and its dissemination:

The REO Director, through the REO Secretary ensures that the recent revisions are incorporated in the Research Ethics Manual. The LNU Quality Management Systems Office (QMSO), however, shall be the sole issuer of the authorized revision of this manual and shall provide recipients of the controlled copies of this manual with amendments or any updates.

Though the university policy states that if there is a new version of the Research Ethics Manual, the QMSO shall retrieve the controlled copies of the current version and replace these with the latest version and that QMSO shall be responsible for disposing superseded version of the controlled copies, the REP Secretaries shall, upon prior notification to the QMSO, retain one (1) complete originally signed Research Ethics Manual incorporating these SOPs and archives the superseded version of the SOP in the historical file maintained by the LNU-REC following prescribed guidelines. Superseded SOPs are clearly marked "superseded" with year of archiving stamped in the cover page.

Once the authorized revision of the manual has been forwarded by the QMSO to the Research Ethics Office, the REO Director shall facilitate the distribution of copies of the SOP to the LNU-REC Members within thirty (30) days from receipt of the documents. Electronic copies of relevant SOP Forms will likewise be made available to the LNU academic community.

6. FORMS

Form 5.34.1 Request for Revision of an SOP or Guideline

Form 5.34.2 SOP Template

7. HISTORY OF SOP

VERSION NO.	DATE (mm/dd/yyyy)	AUTHORS	MAIN CHANGE
1	07/26/2023	Leenard Niño O. Mateo Leoncio P. Olobia Maricar C. Tegero Alma Sonia Q. Sanchez-Danday	Initial Version

DOCUMENT NO. REM 8.01	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE	VERSION NO. 1
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	Chapter V WRITING AND REVISION OF SOPS SOP 34 Writing and Revision of LNU-REC SOPs	JULY 26, 2023 JULY 26, 2023 PAGE NO. 142 of 142

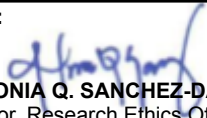
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PHREB (2022). National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

PHREB (2020). Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures.

PREPARED BY:	APPROVED BY:		
 ATTY. ALMA SONIA Q. SANCHEZ-DANDAY, PhD Director, Research Ethics Office	 EVELYN B. AGUIRRE, DA University President		

APPENDICES

APPENDIX A

GLOSSARY

	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME APPENDICES Appendix A Glossary	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
		EFFECTIVITY DATE JULY 26, 2023

1. **Active Files** - are documents pertaining to protocols which are currently being assessed, managed or monitored by the LNU-REC.
2. **Active study** - is an ongoing study, implementation of which is within the period covered by ethics clearance.
3. **Active study files** - a file containing all active studies.
4. **Adjournment** - Formal closure of the meeting. Motion for adjournment and records of time are included in the minutes.
5. **Agenda** - the list of topics or items to be taken up in a meeting arranged in a sequential manner. It is an outline of the meeting procedure and starts with a "Call to Order".
6. **Amendment** - a change in or revision of the protocol made after it has been approved.
7. **Amendment report** - a report created and reported on any amendments to decisions, documents and other important information on forms.
8. **Appeal** - a request of a researcher/ investigator for a reconsideration of LNU-REC recommendation.
9. **Archiving** - is the systematic keeping of protocol files in storage after the studies have been completed with final reports accepted, or terminated or declared inactive.
10. **Archived protocol** - protocols filed in archives folder.
11. **Assessment Form** - evaluation tool accomplished by the reviewers when appraising the protocol or the informed consent form.
12. **CAS** - refers to the College of Arts and Sciences of Leyte Normal University.
13. **Cloud** - refers to servers that are accessed over the Internet, and the software and databases that run on these servers. Cloud servers are located in data centers all over the world. By using cloud computing, users and companies do not have to manage physical servers themselves or run software applications on their own machines.
14. **Cloud protocol box** - refers to the data collection and storage folder saved in a cloud.
15. **Clarificatory Interview/Meeting** - is a face-to-face consultation between the LNU-REC and the researcher for the purpose of obtaining explanations or clarity regarding some research issues identified by the LNU-REC.

	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE	
	MANUAL TITLE RESEARCH ETHICS MANUAL	VERSION NO. 1
	DOCUMENT NAME APPENDICES Appendix A Glossary	APPROVAL DATE JULY 26, 2023
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16. **CME** - refers to the College of Management and Entrepreneurship of Leyte Normal University.
17. **COE** - refers to the College of Education of the Leyte Normal University.
18. **Coding** - a unique number assigned to a document. A protocol code indicates the year and order of receipt. The SOP code indicates its serial position among the other SOPs and its version number.
19. **Committee en banc** – this refers to the six (6) members of the Research Ethics Panel.
20. **Completed study files** - a file containing all completed studies.
21. **Complaint** - the act of expressing discontent or unease about certain events or arrangements in connection with a study.
22. **Conflict of interest** - a situation in which aims or concerns of two (primary and secondary) different interests are not compatible such that decisions may adversely affect the official/primary duties.
23. **Confidentiality** - is the duty to refrain from freely disclosing private/ research information entrusted to an individual or organization.
24. **Confidential files** - files kept or secured areas with limited access by authorized members of the panel/committee.
25. **Conforme** - acceptance of or agreement to an assignment or designation.
26. **Consensus** - a collective agreement. The process of arriving at a decision without voting but by generating the overall sentiment of a group such that deliberations continue until no more strong objections are registered.
27. **Continuing Review** - is the decision of the LNU-REC to extend ethical clearance of a study beyond the initial period of effectivity based on an appreciation that the research is proceeding according to the approved protocol and there is reasonable expectation of its completion.
28. **Database** - a collection of information that is structured and organized so that this can easily be accessed, managed, interpreted, analyzed and updated. It is usually in an electronic platform used for tracking and monitoring the implementation of a study.
29. **Decision** - the result of the deliberations of the LNU-REC in the review of a protocol or other submissions.
30. **Draft Meeting Agenda** - the order of business that includes the list of topics or items recommended for discussion in a meeting. This is endorsed to the LNU-REC Chairperson for his/her approval.
31. **Draft Meeting Minutes** - Proceedings of the meeting prepared by the Secretariat.

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32. **Early study termination** - is ending the implementation of a study before its completion. This is a decision made by the sponsor or a regulatory authority and/or recommended by the Data Safety Monitoring Board, researcher/investigator in consideration of participant safety, funding issues, protocol violations, and data integrity issues.
33. **Ethical guidelines** - used by groups and organizations to define what actions are morally right and wrong.
34. **Exemption Report** - a list of protocols submitted for review that were deemed not to require the conduct of either expedited or full review. This report is presented during a regular committee meeting or as required by the institutional authority
35. **Expedited Review** - is the ethical evaluation of a research proposal and other protocol-related documents, a resubmission, and after-approval submissions conducted by only 2-3 members of the committee without the involvement of the panel.
36. **Exempt from Review** - a decision made by the LNU-REC Chairperson or designated member of the committee regarding a submitted study proposal based on criteria in the NEGHR 2017 The Research Ethics Review Process Guideline 3.1. This means that the protocol will not undergo an expedited nor a full review.
37. **Expedited Review Reports** - is an enumeration of protocols (including titles, code number, proponent, submission date, names of reviewers and decisions) that underwent expedited review presented during a regular LNU-REC meeting for information of the LNU-REC members and for record purposes.
38. **Faculty** - refers to the teaching force of Leyte Normal University.
39. **Final meeting agenda** - the approved provisional meeting agenda.
40. **Final Report** - a summary of the outputs and outcomes of the study upon its completion. The LNU- REC requires the accomplishment of the Final Report form within one (1) month after the end of the study.
41. **Full Board Review** - it is the ethical evaluation of a research proposal and other protocol-related documents, a resubmission, and after- approval submissions conducted by the research ethics committee *en banc*, in the presence of a quorum, using established technical and ethical criteria.
42. **Graduate School** - refers to the graduate school of the Leyte Normal University.
43. **Honorarium / Honoraria** - a nominal payment given for professional services that are rendered; alternately refers to incentive in this SOP.
44. **Hybrid** - a face-to-face meeting conducted on the premises with online participants.
45. **Incentive** - a thing that motivates or encourages someone to do something; alternately refers to honorarium in this SOP.

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- 46. Independent Consultant** - individuals who are not members of the LNU-Research Ethics Committee, but whose expertise is needed in the review of a research protocol/proposal and who may be invited to attend a committee meeting but are non-voting during the deliberation.
- 47. Inactive study** – a study whose proponent has not communicated with the LNU-REC with regard to issues pertaining to the approval or implementation of the study within three (3) months.
- 48. Inactive study files** - a file containing all inactive studies.
- 49. Informed consent** - is an ongoing communication process between research participants and the investigator to ensure participants' comfort. Informed consent allows potential research participants to volunteer their participation freely, without threat or undue coaching.
- 50. Initial Review** - the ethical assessment of the first complete set of study documents submitted to the LNU-REC for assessment that can be expedited or full review.
- 51. Logbook** – a real-time, chronological record of incoming protocols that includes the Date /Time of Receipt, Title of the Document, Name of the Proponent, Name and Signature of the Submitting Entity, Name and Signature of the Receiving Person and Action done.
- 52. LNU-REC** - stands for Leyte Normal University- Research Ethics Committee composed of four (4) panels: the Graduate School and Faculty Research Ethics Panel, College of Education Research Ethics Panel, College of Arts and Sciences Research Ethics Panel, and College of Management and Entrepreneurship Research.
- 53. Major Modification** - is a recommended revision of significant aspects/s of the study (e.g., study objectives, recruitment of participants, exclusion/inclusion criteria, collection of data, statistical analysis, mitigation of risks, protection of vulnerability, etc.) that impact on potential risks/harms to participants and on the integrity of the research.
- 54. Minor Modification** - is a recommended revision of particular aspect/s of the study or related documents that do not impact on potential risks/harms to participants and on the integrity of the research, e.g. incomplete documentation, incomplete Informed Consent elements, unsatisfactory Informed Consent format.
- 55. Minutes of the meeting** - the official narration and record of the proceedings of the assembly of LNU- REC Members, based on the agenda.
- 56. Minutes template** - the guide for which the minutes are drafted and prepared.
- 57. Minimal Risk** - term used when the probability and magnitude of harm or discomfort anticipated in research are not greater, in and of themselves, than those encountered in daily life or during the performance of routine physical or psychological examinations or tests.

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- 58. Multi-site Research** - refers to researches that will be conducted in three or more sites that utilize the same study protocol.
- 59. Non-affiliated Member/s** – are regular members who are not in the roster of personnel or staff of the Institution. They are not employees of the institution, nor do they receive regular salary or stipend from the institution. Alternately referred to as non-institutional members as used in this SOP manual.
- 60. Non-institutional members** - are regular members who are not in the roster of personnel or staff of the Institution. They are not employees of the institution since they do not receive regular salary or stipend from the institution.
- 61. Non-scientist members** - are individuals whose primary interest is not in any of the natural, physical and social sciences and whose highest formal education is a bachelor's degree. This may also include those who earned a degree higher than a bachelor's degree but who has retired already and is no longer practicing the profession nor updated with current trends in his/her field.
- 62. Online** - meetings conducted in virtual meeting platforms.
- 63. Onsite** - face-to-face meetings conducted in the premises.
- 64. Physical Plant Division** - unit within the institution that is in charge of the maintenance and use of physical facilities.
- 65. Protocol** - the documentation of the study proposal that includes a presentation of the rationale and significance of the study, background and review of literature, study objectives, study design and methodology, data collection, dummy tables, plan for analysis of data, ethical consideration, and dissemination plan.
- 66. Protocol amendments** - a change in or revision of the protocol made after it has been approved.
- 67. Protocol database** - a collection of information about protocols that is structured and organized for easy access, management, interpretation, analysis and updating. It is usually an electronic platform used for tracking and monitoring the implementation of a study.
- 68. Protocol Deviation** - non-compliance with the approved protocol that does not increase risk nor decrease benefit to participants and does not significantly affect their rights, safety or welfare or the integrity of data. Example: missed visit, non-submission of a food diary on time.
- 69. Protocol File/Folder** - is an organized compilation of all documents (physical or electronic form) related to a study.
- 70. Protocol Index** - is a chronological record of the documents in the protocol file. The protocol index is in table form indicating the date of filing, the nature of the document filed, the name and signature of the person who filed and an extra column to record any movement of the document. The index is pasted inside the cover page of the protocol file/folder for easy reference and checking.

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- 71. Provisional meeting agenda** - is the order of business that includes the list of topics or items approved for discussion in a meeting by the REP Chairperson.
- 72. Protocol Package** - consists of all the documents in the initial protocol package plus the blank copies of the protocol evaluation forms with the transmittal letter to the primary reviewers.
- 73. Protocol Violation** - non-compliance with the approved protocol that may result in an increased risk or decreased benefit to participants or significantly affect their rights, safety or welfare or the integrity of data. Example: incorrect treatment, non-compliance with inclusion/exclusion criteria.
- 74. Principal Investigator** - the lead person or lead researcher in a study.
- 75. Primary reviewer** - are members of the Research Ethics Committee (usually a scientist and a non- scientist) assigned to do an in-depth evaluation of the research-related documents using technical and ethical criteria established by the committee. The non-scientist member shall focus on the review of the Informed Consent process and form and reflect on community values, culture and tradition in order to recommend acceptance, non-acceptance or improvement of the informed consent process and form. The primary reviewers shall present their findings and recommendations during the meeting for discussion.
- 76. Query** - the act of asking for information or clarification about a study.
- 77. Quorum** - the minimum number (i.e., majority of the members) and type of members of the LNU-REC that are required to be present in any meeting for the proceedings to be considered valid. International and national guidelines require the presence of at least 5 regular members including the non-affiliated and the non-scientist members.
- 78. REP-** stands for Research Ethics Panel for each College and for the faculty members which operates independently from each other.
- 79. REP- Secretary** - refers to the staff secretary assigned per Research Ethics Panel.
- 80. Regular Members** - are members constituting the research to the ethics committee, who receive official appointments from the institutional authority with specific terms and responsibilities including review of research proposals and attendance in meetings.
- 81. Regular Meeting** - a periodically scheduled assembly of the LNU-REC.
- 82. REO** - stands for Research Ethics Office headed by the Research Ethics Director.
- 83. REO- Secretary** - refers to the staff secretary assigned to the Research Ethics Office.
- 84. Reportable Negative Events (RNE)** - are occurrences in the study site that indicate risks or actual harm to participants and to members of the research team. Examples are brewing hostilities in the research community, natural calamities, unleashed dogs, threats of harassment, etc.,

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- 85. Research Council** - refers to the body which has oversight function over the administrative operations of the Research Ethics Office.
- 86. Research Ethics** - specifically involves the analysis of ethical issues that are raised when people are involved as participants in research.
- 87. Resubmissions** - the revised study proposals that are forwarded to the LNU-REC in response to the recommendations given during the initial review.
- 88. Reviewer** - a regular member of the Research Ethics Committee who is assigned to assess a research protocol, Informed Consent, and other research-related submissions based on technical and ethical criteria established by the committee.
- 89. Scientists** - individuals whose formal education is at least a master's degree in a scientific discipline, e.g., biology, physics, social science, etc.
- 90. Serious Adverse Event (SAE)** - is an event observed during the implementation of a study where the outcome is any of the following: Death, Life threatening, Hospitalization (initial or prolonged), Disability or permanent damage, Congenital anomaly/ birth defect, required intervention to prevent permanent impairment or damage (devices) and Other serious (important medical) event whether or not it is related to the study intervention.
- 91. Single Joint Research Ethics Board (SJREB)** - is organized by the Department of Health to conduct a harmonized joint review of health or health-related research protocols involving three (3) or more sites to ensure quality of ethics review and shorten the turnaround time of the ethics review.
- 92. Site Visit** – is an action of the REC (based on established criteria) in which an assigned team goes to the research site or office for specific monitoring purposes.
- 93. Site Visit Report** - a report made and submitted to the LNU-REC after the site visit.
- 94. Site Visiting Team** - members/staff of the LNU-REC (2-4 members) assigned by the LNU-REC Chairperson to formally go to the research site, meet with the research team and evaluate compliance with the approved protocol and Informed Consent Form and Process, including other related research procedures to ensure promotion of the rights, dignity and well-being of participants and protection of integrity of data.
- 95. Special Meeting** - an assembly of the Committee outside of the regular schedule of meetings for a specific purpose, usually to decide on an urgent matter like selection of officer, approval of a revised or new SOP, report of critical research problem that requires immediate action, oversight problems and other administrative or operational concerns of the LNU-REC.
- 96. Sponsor** - an individual, company, institution or organization which takes responsibility for the initiation, management, and financing of a laboratory trial or a study.
- 97. Study documents** – include all materials (protocol, forms, certificates, research tools) pertinent to a research proposal that have to be submitted to the LNU-REC for review.

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- 98. Study Protocol** - the documentation of the study proposal that includes a presentation of the rationale and significance of the study, background and review of literature, study objectives, study design and methodology, data collection, dummy tables, plan for analysis of data, ethical consideration, and dissemination plan.
- 99. Study Protocol Database** - include all materials (protocol, forms, certificates, research tools) pertinent to a research proposal that have to be submitted to the LNU-REC for review.
- 100. Suspected Unexpected Serious Adverse Reaction (SUSAR)** – is a noxious response to a drug that is not described in the Investigator's Brochure nor in the drug insert or to any intervention.
- 101. Term of office** - the specified length of time that a person serves in a particular designation /role.
- 102. Training** - the action of teaching a person or animal a particular skill or type of behavior.
- 103. Vulnerable Groups** - participants or potential participants of a research study who may not have the full capacity to protect their interests and may be relatively or absolutely incapable of deciding for themselves whether or not to participate in the research. They may also be at a higher risk of being harmed or to be taken advantaged of.

APPENDIX B

Standard Forms Workbook



**LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY
RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE**

REO

RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE

STANDARD FORMS WORKBOOK

JULY 26, 2023

PREPARED BY:

ALMA SONIA Q. SANCHEZ-DANDAY

DIRECTOR, RESEARCH ETHICS



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 1.1.1
LETTER OF APPOINTMENT WITH TERMS OF REFERENCE

Date:

Name: _____

Department: _____

Institution: _____

Dear _____:

In line with your nomination to the Leyte Normal University- Research Ethics Committee (LNU-REC), we are pleased to appoint you as the **(POSITION)** of the **GS/F/COE/CAS/CME** Research Ethics Panel with the following duties and responsibilities, to wit:

(Mention the responsibilities stated in TOR Section IV. Roles and Responsibilities)

As the **(POSITION)** of the Research Ethics Panel, you will be entitled to an honorarium as stipulated under SOP 2 (Incentives of LNU-REC Members and Consultants) of the Research Ethics Manual (REM 4.05). You will also be entitled to claim travel expenses and allowances for your attendance in trainings and other LNU-REC and/or REP activities. Please find attached Terms of Reference.

If you agree to these terms, please sign in the spaces below:

Very truly yours,

University
President
Designating Officer

Date: _____

Conforme:

Name & Signature

Date: _____

TERMS OF REFERENCE



. Role/ Purpose

The role of the Leyte Normal University –Research Ethics Committee (LNU-REC) are the following:

- . Issue ethical clearance for researches reviewed and approved for scientific and ethical acceptability for locally, nationally, and internationally implemented research involving the university and external clients;
- . Review amendments/ changes in the protocol of researches previously approved;
- a. Ensure application of ethical standards in research and monitor progress reports; and
- . Ensure responsiveness of proposals to the research needs and priorities of the university.

Based on the WHO Operational Guidelines for Ethics Committee, the Research Ethics Committee (REC) is responsible for *“acting in the full interest of potential research participants and affected communities, taking into the account the interests and needs of the researchers with due regard to the requirement of relevant regulatory agencies and applicable laws.”*

I. Terms

This Term of Reference is effective from **(start date)** and continues until **(completion date)** or will be ongoing until terminated by agreement between the parties.

II. Membership

1. The selection of Leyte Normal University-Research Ethics Committee (LNU-REC) members shall be done through an appointment and selection process represented by the different disciplines (*scientists and non-scientists*), institutional and non-institutional members, and sectors (male and female, older and younger age groups).

Following the PHREB-prescribed composition for membership, the LNU-REC is composed of four (4) Research Ethics Panels (REPs):

- Graduate School and Faculty Research Ethics Panel (GS/F REP)
- College of Education Research Ethics Panel (COE REP)
- College of Arts and Sciences Research Ethics Panel (CAS REP)
- College of Management and Entrepreneurship Research Ethics Panel (CME REP)

The above composition considers age balance and gender equality. Each REP is composed of six (6) members composed of five (5) scientist-members and one (1) non-institutional and non-affiliated member.

2. Resignation, Disqualification, and Replacement of Members

- Members may resign from their positions by submitting a letter of resignation to the REP Chairperson endorsed to the University President by the REO Director and the Research Council representative.
- Members may be disqualified from serving in the REP for valid reasons as determined by a majority vote of the REP members.
- Members who have resigned or have been disqualified may be replaced following the nomination and appointment procedures previously stated.
- The terms of the replacement shall be limited to the remaining term of the member that he/she has replaced.



III. ROLES and RESPONSIBILITIES OF MEMBERS

1. Responsibilities of the REP Chairperson

The REP Chairperson has the following responsibilities:

- 1.1. Presides over REP meetings and directly reports to the REO Director for administrative concerns;
- 1.2. Prepares an annual report summarizing REP activities and decision outcomes;
- 1.3. Ensures sufficient financial and administrative support for REP operations in coordination with the REO;
- 1.4. Encourages continuing education of REP members in research ethics review;
- 1.5. Represents the REP interests within the Leyte Normal University;
- 1.6. Represents the REP to external organizations and entities; and
- 1.7. Primarily responsible for the classification of study protocols received and assignment of Primary Reviewers.

2. Responsibilities of the REP Vice-Chairperson

The REP Vice-Chairperson has the following responsibilities:

- 2.1. Presides over meetings in the absence of the Chairperson;
- 2.2. Classifies study protocols and assigns Primary Reviewers in the absence of the Chairperson; and
- 2.3. Performs other duties as designated by the Chairperson.

3. Responsibilities of the Member–Secretary

The Member-Secretary has the following responsibilities:

- 3.1. Supervises the REP Secretary;
- 3.2. Calendars meetings, takes the minutes of Full Board Meetings with the assistance of the REP Secretary, supervises the taking of minutes of the REP Secretary in all other meetings, and releases notice of meeting to all REP members;
- 3.3. Ensures good REP documentation;
- 3.4. Assists the REP Chairperson in preparing an annual report summarizing REP activities and decision outcomes; and
- 3.5. Classifies study protocols and assigns Primary Reviewers in the absence of the Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson.

4. Responsibilities of the Assistant Member-Secretary

The Assistant Member-Secretary has the following responsibilities:

- 4.1. Performs all secretarial duties in the absence of the Member-Secretary;
- 4.2. Classifies study protocols and assigns Primary Reviewers in the absence of the Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson, and Member-Secretary; and
- 4.3. Assists in the designated duties of the Member-Secretary.

5. Responsibilities of Non-institutional and Non-scientist Members



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The Non-Institutional and the Non-Scientist Members have the following responsibilities:

- 5.1. Share his or her insights about the communities from which participants will be drawn and about the informed consent process and form;
- 5.2. Review the ethical considerations in the conduct of research which includes social value, vulnerability issues, risk versus benefit, measures to mitigate risks, privacy and confidentiality, and the informed consent process and forms; and
- 5.3. Provide an external perspective to ensure the independence of the position of the LNU-REC from possible bias posed by the institution that may impact on the rights, safety, and well-being of human subjects.

6. Responsibility of Members

The Scientist-Members have the following responsibilities:

- 6.1 Review, discuss, and consider research proposals submitted for evaluation;
- 6.2 Assess serious adverse event reports and recommend appropriate action;
- 6.3 Review progress reports and monitor ongoing studies as appropriate;
- 6.4 Evaluate the final report;
- 6.5 Maintain confidentiality of the documents and deliberations during the REP meeting;
- 6.6 Declare any conflict of interest; and
- 6.7 Participate in continuing education activities in research ethics.

IV. Reference

Research Ethics Manual Version No. 1, July 26, 2023.



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE

Form 1.1.2

CONFIDENTIALITY AND CONFLICT OF INTEREST DISCLOSURE AGREEMENT (Member)

Know all Men by these Presents:

In view of the appointment of _____, as a member of the Leyte Normal University Research Ethics Review Committee (LNU-REC), hereinafter referred to as the ***Undersigned***, and whereas:

The ***Undersigned*** has been asked to assess research studies and protocols involving human subjects in order to ensure that the same is conducted in a humane and ethical manner, with the highest standards of care according to the applied national and local laws and regulations, institutional policies and guidelines;

The appointment of the ***Undersigned*** as a member of the Leyte Normal University- Research Ethics Committee is based on individual merits and not as an advocate or representative of a home province/ territory/ community nor as the delegate of any organization or for private interest;

The fundamental duty of an LNU-REC member is to independently review both scientific and ethical aspects of research protocols involving human subjects and make a determination and the best possible objective recommendations, based on the merits thereof under review; The Leyte Normal University-REC must meet the highest ethical standards in order to merit the trust and confidence of the communities in the protection of the rights and well-being of human subjects;

The following terms and conditions covering **Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest** arising in the discharge of said appointed LNU-REC members' functions are hereby stipulated in this Agreement for purposes of ensuring the same high standards of ethical behavior necessary for the LNU-REC to carry out its mandate.

Confidentiality

This Agreement thus encompasses any information deemed Confidential, Privileged, or Proprietary provided to and/or otherwise received by the ***Undersigned*** in conjunction with and/or in the course of the performance of his/her duties as a member of the LNU-REC.

Any written information provided to the ***Undersigned*** that is Confidential, Privileged, or Propriety in nature shall be identified accordingly. Written Confidential Information provided for review shall not be copied or retained. All Confidential information (and any copies and notes thereof) shall remain the sole property of the LNU-REC.



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As such, the ***Undersigned*** agrees to hold in trust and in confidence all Confidential, Privileged, or Proprietary information, including trade secrets and other intellectual property rights (hereinafter) collectively referred to as the "information". Moreover, the ***Undersigned*** agrees that the information shall be used only for contemplated purposes. Neither shall the said information be disclosed to any third party.

The Undersigned further agrees not to disclose or utilize, directly or indirectly, any information belonging to a third party, in fulfilling this agreement. Furthermore, the ***Undersigned*** confirms that her performance of this agreement is consistent with LNU-REC policies and any contractual obligations owed to third parties.

Conflict of Interest

It is recognized that the potential for conflict of interest will always exist; however, there is concomitant faith in the ability of the LNU-REC to manage these conflict issues, if any, in such a way that the ultimate outcome of the protection of human subjects remains.

It is the policy of the LNU-REC that no member may participate in the review, comment, or approval of any activity in which he/she has a conflict of interest except to provide information as requested by the LNU-REC

The ***Undersigned*** will immediately disclose to the chairperson of the LNU-REC any actual or potential conflict of interest that he/she may have in relation to any particular proposal submitted for review by the LNU-REC and abstain from any participation in discussions or recommendations in respect of such proposals.

If an applicant submitting a protocol believes that an LNU-REC member has a potential conflict, the investigator may request that the member be excluded from the review of the protocol.

The request must be in writing and addressed to the Chairperson. The request must contain evidence that substantiates the claim that a conflict exists with the LNU- REC member(s) in question. The LNU-REC may elect to investigate the applicant's claim of the potential conflict.

When a member has a conflict of interest, the member should notify the Chairperson and may not participate in the LNU-REC review or approval except to provide the information requested by the Board. Examples of conflict-of-interest cases may include but are not limited to any of the following:

A member is involved in a potentially competing research program;

Access to funding or intellectual information may provide an unfair competitive advantage; and

A member's personal biases may interfere with his or her impartial judgment.



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Agreement on Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest

To the **Undersigned**: Please sign and affix the date on this Agreement if you agree with the terms and conditions set forth above. The original (signed and dated Agreement) will be kept on file in the custody of the LNU-REC. A copy will be given to you for your records.

In the course of my activities as a member of the LNU-REC, I will be provided with confidential information and documentation (which we will refer to as "Confidential Information"). I agree to take reasonable measures to protect the Confidential Information, subject to applicable legislation; not to disclose the Confidential Information to any person; not to use the Confidential Information for any purpose outside the Committee's mandate, and in particular, in a manner which would result in a benefit to myself or any third party; and to return all Confidential Information (including any minutes or notes I have made as part of my LNU-REC duties) to the REP Chairperson upon termination of my function as an LNU-REC member.

Whenever I have a conflict of interest, I shall immediately inform the REP Chairperson not to count me toward a quorum for voting.

I have read and accept the aforementioned terms and conditions as explained in this Agreement.

Name of

Member: Date:



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 1.1.3
CURRICULUM VITAE

Latest
(1x1) ID
Picture

PERSONAL INFORMATION

1. **Name of Nominee:** _____
2. **Contact Details:** _____
_____ Home Address: _____
Phone No.: _____ Mobile No.: _____
Email Address: _____
3. **Date of Birth:** _____

AFFILIATION

4. **Name of Agency/ Institution:** _____
5. **Agency/ Institution Address:** _____
6. **Present Job Position:** _____
7. **Contact Details**
Phone No: _____ Fax No: _____
Mobile No: _____ Email address: _____

EDUCATION (Highest degree earned and year graduated)

WORK EXPERIENCES (related to Ethics)

TRAININGS ATTENDED RELATED TO ETHICS:



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Name of Training	Participation	Date

Name & Signature

Date



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE

Form 1.3.1

LETTER OF INVITATION FOR INDEPENDENT CONSULTANT

Date:

Dear

The **LNU-REC** would like to invite you to be an **Independent Consultant** for a research protocol that has been submitted to our committee for approval.

PROTOCOL TITLE:

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:

PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:

As **Independent consultant**, we recognize your expertise in the field of research that is being proposed and appreciate your insights/expert opinions as well as any recommendations.

As Independent Consultant, your review will be focused on:

- Scientific procedures and methodology,
- Any new information about the research topic and the proposed Interventions, and
- Benefits and Risks of the intervention and how to mitigate the risks.
- The consultant will be given an honorarium.
- Services may be terminated by either the consultant or by the LNU-REC.

As **Independent Consultant**, you will not have the right to vote, you will not be counted in the quorum, and your attendance will be required only during the time the protocol assigned to you is to be discussed. The consultant may attend the LNU-REC meeting, present his/her assessment, and participate in the discussion.

Please sign Conforme below if you accept our invitation. Likewise, please go over and sign the Confidentiality/Conflict of Interest Agreements (refer to attached agreement) and return them to the LNU-REC Secretariat along with the Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Agreement and latest curriculum vitae (Form attached).

An honorarium will be given for your attendance and participation in the ethics review. For any questions, please feel free to contact the REP Chairperson at _____. Thank you for your attention and hoping for your favorable response.



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Respectfully yours,

Chairperson, Research Ethics

Panel Date: _____

Conforme:

Name of Independent

Consultant Date: _____



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 1.3.2
APPOINTMENT LETTER OF INDEPENDENT CONSULTANT

Date:

NAME:

Department / Position:

Institutional Affiliation:

Subject: Appointment as Independent Consultant

Dear (Name):

You are hereby appointed as Independent Consultant of the Leyte Normal University-Research Ethics Committee (LNU-REC) effective (from) to (to). As Independent Consultant, your responsibilities are as follows:

1. *Attend LNU-REC meetings when requested to present your assessment and participate in the discussion but without the right to vote;*
2. *Participate in the review of research proposals and other related reports when requested focusing on:*
 - *Scientific merits of the protocol (methodology and procedures)*
 - *Benefits and risks of the intervention and how to mitigate the risks*
 - *Any new information about the disease/research topic and the proposed intervention*
3. *Complete and submit LNU-REC assessment forms;*
4. Declare any conflict of interest (COI) in the review of research proposals; and
5. Maintain confidentiality of the documents and deliberations during LNU-REC meetings.

We look forward to work in partnership with you in ensuring that all research conforms to local, national, and international ethical principles and standards toward respect for the rights, well-being, and dignity of persons.

Thank you for accepting the invitation to be the member / Independent Consultant of the Research Ethics Committee. Kindly signify your acceptance by signing the conforme below.

Very truly yours,

Designating Officer

University President Date: ____

Conforme:

Name of Independent Consultant



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Date: _____

LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 1.3.3
CONFIDENTIALITY AND CONFLICT OF INTEREST DISCLOSURE AGREEMENT (Independent
Consultant)

Know all Men by these Presents:

In view of the appointment of _____, as an independent consultant of the Leyte Normal University-Research Ethics Committee (LNU-REC), hereinafter referred to as the ***Undersigned***, and whereas:

The ***Undersigned*** has been asked to assess research studies and protocols involving human subjects in order to ensure that the same is conducted in a humane and ethical manner, with the highest standards of care according to the applied national and local laws and regulations, institutional policies and guidelines;

The appointment of the ***Undersigned*** as an independent consultant of the Leyte Normal University-REC is based on individual merits and not as an advocate or representative of a home province/ territory/ community nor as the delegate of any organization or for private interest;

The fundamental duty of an independent consultant is to independently review both scientific and ethical aspects of research protocols involving human subjects and make a determination and the best possible objective recommendations, based on the merits thereof under review; and

The LNU-REC must meet the highest ethical standards in order to merit the trust and confidence of communities in the protection of the rights and well-being of human subjects;

The following terms and conditions covering **Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest** arising in the discharge of said appointed LNU-REC independent consultants' functions are hereby stipulated in this Agreement for purposes of ensuring the same high standards of ethical behavior necessary for the LNU-REC to carry out its mandate.

Confidentiality

This Agreement thus encompasses any information deemed Confidential, Privileged, or Proprietary provided to and/or otherwise received by the ***Undersigned*** in conjunction with



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and/or in the course of the performance of his/her duties as Independent Consultant of the LNU- REC.

Any written information provided to the **Undersigned** that is Confidential, Privileged or Proprietary in nature shall be identified accordingly. Written Confidential information provided for review shall not be copied or retained. All Confidential information (and any copies and notes thereof) shall remain the sole property of the REC.

As such, the Undersigned agrees to hold in trust and in confidence all Confidential, Privileged, or Proprietary information, including trade secrets and other intellectual property rights (hereinafter collectively referred to as the "information"). Moreover, the Undersigned agrees that the information shall be used only for contemplated purposes. Neither shall the said information be disclosed to any third party.

The **Undersigned** further agrees not to disclose or utilize, directly or indirectly, any information belonging to a third party, in fulfilling this agreement. Furthermore, the Undersigned confirms that his/her performance of this agreement is consistent with LNU-REC policies and any contractual obligations owed to third parties.

Conflict of Interest

It is recognized that the potential for conflict of interest will always exist; however, there is concomitant faith in the ability of the LNU-REC to manage these conflict issues, if any, in such a way that the ultimate outcome of the protection of human subjects remains.

It is the policy of the LNU-REC that no consultant may participate in the review, comment, or approval of any activity in which he/she has a conflict of interest except to provide information as requested by the LNU-REC.

The Undersigned will immediately disclose to the Chairperson of the LNU-REC any actual or potential conflict of interest that he/she may have in relation to any particular proposal submitted for review by the LNU-REC, and abstain from any participation in discussions or recommendations in respect of such proposals.

If an applicant submitting a protocol believes that the LNU-REC independent consultant has a potential conflict, the investigator may request that the independent consultant be excluded from the review of the protocol.

The request must be in writing and addressed to the REP Chairperson. The request must contain evidence that substantiates the claim that a conflict exists with the LNU-REC independent consultant in question. The REC may elect to investigate the applicant's claim of the potential conflict.

When a consultant has a conflict of interest, the consultant should notify the Chairperson and may not participate in the REC review except to provide the information requested by the Board.

Examples of conflict-of-interest cases may include but are not limited to any of the following: A consultant is involved in a potentially competing research program;

Access to funding or intellectual information may provide an unfair competitive advantage; and



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A consultant's personal biases may interfere with his or her impartial judgment.

Agreement on Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest

To the **Undersigned**: Please sign and affix the date on this Agreement, if you agree with the terms and conditions set forth above. The original (signed and dated Agreement) will be kept on file in the custody of the LNU-REC. A copy will be given to you for your records.

In the course of my activities as an independent consultant of the LNU-REC, I will be provided with confidential information and documentation (which we will refer to as "Confidential Information"). I agree to take reasonable measures to protect the Confidential Information, subject to applicable legislation, not to disclose the Confidential Information to any person; not to use the Confidential Information for any purpose outside the Committee's mandate, and in particular, in a manner which would result in a benefit to myself or any third party; and to return all Confidential Information (including any minutes or notes I have made as part of my REC duties) to the REP Chairperson upon the termination of my functions as an LNU-REC Independent Consultant.

Whenever I have a conflict of interest, I shall immediately inform the REP Chairperson.

I have read and accept the aforementioned terms and conditions as explained in this Agreement.

Name of Independent

Consultant Date: _____



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 1.4.1
 TRAINING RECORD OF AN LNU-REC MEMBER

SURNAME:	NAME:
-----------------	--------------

BASIC COURSES		Training Provider	Venue	Date	Funded (Y/N), Funding Source
1	Research Ethics			<dd/mm/yyyy>	

CONTINUING ETHICS EDUCATION: Research Ethics Workshops, Conferences, Meetings, Lectures		Training Provider	Venue	Date	Funded (Y/N), Funding Source
1				<dd/mm/yyyy>	
2				<dd/mm/yyyy>	
3				<dd/mm/yyyy>	

AS RESOURCE PERSON	Training Provider	Venue	Date	Funded (Y/N), Funding Source
1			<dd/mm/yyyy>	
2			<dd/mm/yyyy>	
3			<dd/mm/yyyy>	
Certified Correct:				
REP SECRETARY		Signature		
Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>		Name	<Title, Name, Surname>	
MEMBER-SECRETARY		Signature		
Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>		Name	<Title, Name, Surname>	



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 1.4.2
TRAINING REFERRAL REQUEST FORM

Date:	
Type of Request	☐ Member requesting to participate in training activity ☐ LNU-REC recommending training for member
Reason for Request	☐ Initial Training ☐ Update Training
Name of Member	<Title, Name, Surname>
Date of 1 st Appointment	<dd/mm/yy>
College/Institute (and department), as applicable	
Type of training requested	☐ Good Clinical Practice ☐ Research Ethics ☐ Standard Operating Procedures ☐ Continuing Ethics Education ☐ Other Educational Activities <specify>
Training Details	Date: <dd/mm/yy> Title: Provider:
Details of Participation	☐ Participant only ☐ Resource person ☐ Others: <specify>
Training Cost	



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Other sources of funding, if any	Amount : Source:
RECOMMENDED BY:	<Title, name, Surname> and Signature ____REP Chairperson Date:<dd/mm/yy>
COMMITMENT TO ATTEND	I commit to attend the <Title Training> on <dd/mm/yy>, for which attendance I will provide a certificate of completion with the training program or agenda attached. <Title, Name, Surname> and Signature Member, LNU-REC <number> Date: <dd/mm/yy>
APPROVED BY:	I approve the request of <Member> to participate in the <training requested>. <Title, Name, Surname> and Signature Director, Research Ethics Office Leyte Normal University Date: <mm/dd/yyyy>



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.6.1
PROTOCOL PACKAGE CHECKLIST

PROTOCOL TITLE:

PROTOCOL CODE: _____

PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR/S / PROPONENTS:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

Date of Submission: _____

Basic Documents to be Submitted (Kindly check once accomplished.)

- ☐ Form 2.6.1 Protocol Package Checklist
- ☐ Form 2.6.1a Assessment of Fees
 - ☐ Proof of Payment of Initial Review Fee, if applicable
 - ☐ Proof of Payment of Special Orientation on Research Ethics and LNU-REC protocols, if applicable
- ☐ Form 2.6.2 Application for Protocol Review
- ☐ Form 2.6.4 Protocol Summary
- ☐ Form 2.6.5 Technical Review Certificate
- ☐ Form 2.6.6 Non-disclosure Agreement (Principal Investigator)
- ☐ Form 2.12.2 Informed Consent Assessment
- ☐ Form 2.12.2a Informed Consent Self-Assessment
- ☐ Form 2.12.1a Study Protocol Self-Assessment
- ☐ Study Protocol / Proposal
 - ☐ Title
 - ☐ Significance of the study
 - ☐ Literature Review
 - ☐ Project Duration



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- ☐ Objectives of the study
- ☐ Methodology & Procedures
- ☐ Description of the study population
- ☐ Exclusion/inclusion criteria
- ☐ Data analysis
- ☐ Work Plan Schedule (Gantt chart for schedule of activities) (Could be an Annex or in Protocol Appendices)
- ☐ Ethical considerations (which include, but not limited to)
 - ☐ Disclosure of Conflict of Interest
 - ☐ Confidentiality and Data Protection Plan (in compliance with Data Privacy Act)
 - ☐ Research Dissemination Plan
- ☐ Schematic Diagram/Conceptual Framework, if applicable
- ☐ Study Protocol Budget/Line-Item Budget (Could be an Annex or in Protocol Appendices)
- ☐ Supplementary Documents (if applicable)
 - ☐ Questionnaire
 - ☐ Data Collection Forms

-
-
- ☐ Informed Consent Forms (Use the WHO template available at <https://tinyurl.com/53z96bdd>)
 - ☐ English ☐ Vernacular ☐ Others
 - ☐ Assent Form (if applicable) (Use the WHO template available at <https://tinyurl.com/53z96bdd>)
 - ☐ English ☐ Vernacular ☐ Others
 - ☐ Curriculum Vitae for all members of the Study Team
 - ☐ Three (3) hardcopies of the study protocol placed inside a brown expanding envelope w/o any label (It will be properly labeled by the REP Secretary.)

Study Specific Documents (submit as needed particularly for externally originated studies and sponsored studies)

- ☐ Recruitment advertisements (as needed by the study protocol)
- ☐ Other information or documents for participants (such as diaries, etc.)
- ☐ Material Transfer Agreement (for any research involving transfer of biological specimens)
- ☐ Memorandum of Agreement (for collaborative studies)
- ☐ Previous ethical review approvals/clearances (for students/personnel of foreign universities researching in the Philippines or those with prior ethical review)
- ☐ National Commission for Indigenous People (NCIP) Clearance (for studies with indigenous populations; can be processed while LNU-REC review is ongoing)



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- ☐ Contracts and/or Approval of relevant offices / regulatory authorities (Written review agreement / Authorization and Acknowledgement of review)

Name: _____

Date Submitted: _____

Signature: _____



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.6.1a
ASSESSMENT OF FEES

NAME: _____

DATE: _____

STUDENT ID NUMBER: _____

DEGREE: _____

TITLE OF THE PROTOCOL/PROPOSAL:

(For LNU Research Ethics Office Use Only)

REVIEW FEE	
☐ Junior High School/Senior High School Research	Php 100 / per student
☐ LNU Faculty/Staff Research	NONE (c/o LNU)
☐ Undergraduate Research	NONE (c/o CHED) under the Free Tertiary Education (RA 10931)
☐ Graduate School Research (Masteral Level)	Php 1, 500 / per study
☐ Graduate School Research (Doctoral Level)	Php 2, 000 / per study
☐ External Research	Php 2, 500 / per study
RESUBMISSION FEE	
☐ Resubmission of documents/protocol (2 nd to nth resubmission)	Php 500/resubmission
SEMINAR FEE	
☐ Annual Orientation on Research Ethics and LNU-REC Protocols	FREE (with certificate)
☐ Special Orientation on Research Ethics and LNU-REC Protocols	Php 500/research group

REP Secretary



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE

FORM 2.6.2

APPLICATION FOR PROTOCOL REVIEW

Date

Dr./Prof:

REP Chairperson

Dear Ma'am/Sir,

Good day!

May I/we submit our proposal for ethics review by the Research Ethics Panel.

Enclosed here is the protocol package for your review and perusal.

Thank you!

Sincerely,

Study Proponent / Principal Investigator



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College:		LNU-REC Protocol Code:	
Degree Program:		Submission Date:	
Protocol Title:			
Principal Investigator:			
Telephone Number:		Mobile Number	Fax:
Email Address:		Preferred Contact:	☐ Phone ☐ Fax ☐ Email
Institute:			
Sponsor:			
Conflict of Interest Declaration (Relationship with Sponsor)	Are you a regular employee of the sponsor? Did you do consultancy or part-time work for the sponsor? In the past year, did you receive any monetary remuneration from the sponsor? Other ties with the sponsor		☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Yes ☐ No
Type of Submission:	☐ Initial Review ☐ Resubmission for re-review ☐ Protocol Amendments ☐ Continuing Review ☐ Protocol Termination ☐ Final Report		
Signature of Principal Investigator	_____ Name and Signature -----		
Verified Complete by (REP Secretary)	_____ Name and Signature		



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.6.3
 PROTOCOL EVALUATION FORM

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:		DATE:
NAME OF PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:		
PROTOCOL TITLE:		
1. Type of Submission	☐ 1.1 Initial Review ☐ 1.2 Resubmission ☐ 1.3 Continuing Review/Progress Report ☐ 1.4 Protocol Termination ☐ 1.5 Protocol Amendments ☐ 1.6 Final Report	
2. Date of Submission		
3. Study Category	☐ 3.1 Research involving human participants ☐ 3.2 Research not involving human participants ☐ 3.3 Vulnerable participants ☐ 3.4 Not Vulnerable participants ☐ 3.5 Not more than minimal risk ☐ 3.6 More than minimal risk	
4. Proposed Study	☐ 4.1 Academic requirement (Thesis, Dissertation, Course/Program Requirement) ☐ 4.2 Independent research work ☐ 4.3 Multi-institutional or multi-country collaboration ☐ 4.4 Others (indicate): _____	
5. Description of the Study in brief	☐ 5.1 Randomized ☐ 5.2 Purposive Selection ☐ 5.3 Multicenter study ☐ 5.4 Single Site ☐ 5.5 Global protocol ☐ 5.6 Sponsor-initiated ☐ 5.7 Investigator-initiated	



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	☐ 5.8 Observational ☐ 5.9 Questionnaire/ Survey ☐ 5.10 Experimental ☐ Others, please specify _____ _____ _____
(For LNU-REC use only) 6. Classification of REVIEW	☐ EXPEDITED REVIEW ☐ FULL BOARD REVIEW ☐ EXEMPTED from REVIEW
7. Assigned Primary Reviewers	Primary Reviewer 1: _____ Primary Reviewer 2: _____
8. Independent Consultant	
Signature of REP Chairperson:	_____ Name and Signature _____ Date



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.6.4
PROTOCOL SUMMARY SHEET

LNU-REC Protocol Code:	<u>Title</u>
Principal Investigator	Sponsor
Rationale	
Objectives	
Study Design/ Methodology	
Inclusion Criteria (Also include type of participants to be recruited; indicate age group and gender)	
Exclusion Criteria	
Data Analysis Plan	
Study Outcomes	
Ethical Considerations (Also include Confidentiality and Data Protection Plan; Research Documentation Plan)	

Name: _____

Date Submitted: _____

Signature: _____



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.6.8
TECHNICAL REVIEW CERTIFICATE

Date: _____

This is to certify that the protocol entitled “_____

_____”

by:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

(AUTHORS)

has been granted approval by the Technical Review Committee/Panel of Examiners on _____

_____ at _____
(DATE) (PLACE)

The Committee/Office hereby endorses the above-mentioned protocol for ethical review.

Very truly yours,

<Name and Signature>

Chairperson, Technical Review Committee/Panel of Examiners/
Executive Director, Office of Research and Innovation



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.6.9
NON-DISCLOSURE AGREEMENT

I, _____, all of legal age, Filipino, and resident of, hereby
depose and say that:

WITNESSETH THAT

1. I am an (employee/student) of _____, having office at _____.
2. I am espousing a research proposal entitled: " _____
_____ " that includes the need to
gather personal and medical information of certain population.
3. I hereby undertake to protect and make confidential such information;
4. I understand that Confidential Information means any information disclosed by or in possession of the data subject identified as confidential when first disclosed and provided in tangible form, or if disclosed orally summarized in writing, other than information that:
 - a. is or becomes generally available to the public other than as a result of disclosure by the data subject
 - b. is already known by or in our possession at the time of disclosure;
 - c. is obtained by us from a third party that has not breached any obligations of confidentiality.
5. Subject to exceptions stated below, I shall not disclose or use any information that I may have acquired other than for the purpose disclosed in the study and in compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2021.
6. I shall use reasonable care not to disclose to any third-party information I may have known or acquired by reason of our research except those identified people who need to know the Confidential Information to carry out the research. Further, I shall not offer for sale, or otherwise disclose to any third-party devices containing information gathered in the conduct of our research, unless otherwise permitted in writing by the data subject and subject to applicable laws.
7. The information subject of this agreement shall pertain to all data or information collated, transmitted to and transcribed reason of my research.
8. I undertake not to disclose any information obtained by reason of my research and the same shall continue to take effect notwithstanding the non-continuity of the research or the completion



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of the same. I shall destroy all copies, reproductions, summaries and notes of the contents of the personal information in accordance with the Data Privacy Policy after the lapse of the retention period;

9. I acknowledge and agree that disclosure, divulgence or unauthorized use of the Confidential Information could damage the data subject, therefore, it has a strong interest in protecting the Confidential Information by all legal means.
10. In the event that I violate my obligations under this Agreement, I shall fully indemnify the data subject for all damages caused by such breach. Moreover, because money damages may not be a sufficient remedy for any breach of the foregoing covenants and agreements, the data subject shall be entitled to specific performance and injunctive and other equitable relief as a remedy for any such breach of this undertaking in addition to all monetary or other remedies available at law or in equity.

I fully understand the concepts regarding confidentiality and privacy of personal information. In addition, I also know and agree that my failure to fulfil any of the agreements set forth in this undertaking and/or our violation of any terms of this undertaking shall result in our being subject to appropriate legal actions.

(Name and Signature) / (Date)



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Tacloban City, Leyte, Philippines
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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.7.1
CHECKLIST FOR EXEMPTION FROM ETHICAL REVIEW

STUDY PROTOCOL INFORMATION

LNU-REC Protocol Code:	
Study Protocol Title:	
Principal Investigator:	
Study Protocol Submission Date:	

INSTRUCTIONS

To the REP Chairperson:

Please evaluate how the exemption criteria outlined below apply to the study protocol by confirming the submitted information and putting your comments in the space provided under "REVIEWER COMMENTS." Finalize your review by indicating your conclusion under "RECOMMENDED ACTION" and signing in the space provided for the primary reviewer.

	To be filled out by the Primary Reviewer	
CRITERIA FOR EXEMPTION	Indicate if the assessment point applies to the study protocol	REVIEWER COMMENTS
1. PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT	YES NO	
1.1. Does this research involve human participants?		
1.2. Does this research involve use of non-identifiable human tissue/ biological samples?		
1.3. Does this research involve use of non-identifiable publicly available data? <i>*Protocols that neither involve human participants, nor identifiable human tissue, biological samples and data shall be exempted from review (NEGHR 2017)</i>		



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1.4. Does this research involve interaction with human participants?			
1.5. Type of research 1.5.1. Institutional quality assurance 1.5.2. Evaluation of public service program 1.5.3. Public health surveillance 1.5.4. Educational evaluation activities 1.5.5. Consumer acceptability test *These 5 have been identified in the NEGHHR as exemptible, as long as it does not involve more than minimal risk.			
1.6. What is/are the method/s of data collection (please tick appropriate box) 1.6.1. Surveys and/or questionnaire, interviews, or observations of public behavior 1.6.2. Audio/video recordings of public behavior 1.6.3. Research which only uses existing data *These have been identified in the NEGHHR as exemptible, as long as anonymity and/or confidentiality is protected.			
1.7 Will the collected data be anonymized or de-identified?			



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1.8. Is there a data protection plan? Measures or guarantees to protect privacy and confidentiality of participant information and in compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 as indicated by data collection methods including data protection plans including the steps to be taken so that all who have access to the data and the identities of the respondents can safeguard privacy and confidentiality (ex. providing adequate instructions to research assistants, transcribers, or translators) (NEGHHR 2017)			
1.9. Is this research likely to involve any foreseeable risk of harm or discomfort to participants; above the level experienced in everyday life? (NEGHRR 2017) *Please refer to section 2. Risk Assessment, prior to answering this item. *If YES, then this protocol does not qualify for exemption			
2. RISK ASSESSMENT	YES	NO	
2.1. Does this research involve the following (please select all that apply):			
2.1.1. Any vulnerable groups?			
2.1.2. Sensitive topics that may make participants feel uncomfortable (i.e. sexual behavior, illegal activities, racial biases, etc.)			
2.1.3. Use of drugs			
2.1.4. Invasive procedure (e.g. blood sampling) and specify			



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2.1.5. Physical stress/distress, discomfort			
2.1.6. Psychological/mental stress/distress			
2.1.7. Deception of/or withholding information from subjects			
2.1.8. Access to data by individuals or organizations other than the investigators			
2.1.9. Conflict of interest issues			
2.1.10. Or any other ethical dilemmas			
2.1.11. Is there any blood sampling involved in the study?			
RECOMMENDED ACTION: ☐ QUALIFIED FOR EXEMPTION ☐ NOT QUALIFIED FOR EXEMPTION			
SUMMARY OF RECOMMENDATIONS:			
JUSTIFICATION FOR RECOMMENDED ACTION			
_____ Name and Signature of REP Chairperson		_____ Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>	

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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.7.2
 CERTIFICATE OF EXEMPTION FROM ETHICAL REVIEW

Date:

This is to certify that the following protocol and related documents have been reviewed and granted exemption from review by the Leyte Normal University-Research Ethics Committee for implementation.

LNU-REC Protocol Code	
-----------------------	--

Title	
-------	--

Principal Investigator/s	
--------------------------	--

Protocol Version No.		Version Date	
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ICF Version No.		Version Date	
Other documents			

REP Chairperson	Name	Signature	Date

Received by:

 * Signature over Printed Name

 * Date



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REO
RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE

RESPONSIBILITIES OF PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR WHILE STUDY IS IN PROGRESS:

Continuing compliance with the exemption criteria of the **National Ethical Guidelines for Health and Health-Related Research 2017** in the duration of the study;

Nonetheless, such human participants in case reports/case series/non-health research are entitled to compliance of researchers with universal ethical principles of respect for persons, beneficence, and justice, as well as applicable local regulations, including the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173). Thus, it is the responsibility of the author/investigator/s to ensure satisfactory compliance with the aforementioned principles and all applicable regulations, and to obtain informed consent from the human subjects involved, if personally identifiable information will be used in any way.

No substantial changes in research design, methodology and subject population from the protocol submitted for exemption. Modifications that significantly affect previous risk-benefit assessment or qualification for exemption may be submitted as new protocol for initial review.

RESPONSIBILITIES OF PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR WHILE STUDY IS IN PROGRESS:

Continuing compliance with the exemption criteria of the **National Ethical Guidelines for Health and Health-Related Research 2017** in the duration of the study;

Nonetheless, such human participants in case reports/case series/non-health research are entitled to compliance of researchers with universal ethical principles of respect for persons, beneficence, and justice, as well as applicable local regulations, including the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173). Thus, it is the responsibility of the author/investigator/s to ensure satisfactory compliance with the aforementioned principles and all applicable regulations, and to obtain informed consent from the human subjects involved, if personally identifiable information will be used in any way.

No substantial changes in research design, methodology and subject population from the protocol submitted for exemption. Modifications that significantly affect previous risk-benefit assessment or qualification for exemption may be submitted as new protocol for initial review.

Protocols that qualify for EXEMPTION are automatically archived and classified as INACTIVE, and protocol records will be made available by LNU-REC for **three years** from date of action. Protocols granted for exemption are exempt from further review including continuing review. LNU-REC must be provided with a copy of the FINAL report not later than one **(1) month** from the end of study. All further queries regarding this request may be forwarded to the undersigned through _____(contact info).



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.12.1
 STUDY PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:		DATE	
TITLE OF THE STUDY			
TYPE OF REVIEW	☐ Full Board Review ☐ Expedited Review	INSTITUTION	
PROONENTS / PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATORS			
PRIMARY REVIEWERS		E-MAIL ADDRESS	
CONTACT NO.		STATUS	☐ NEW ☐ FOR RENEWAL OF APPROVAL

GUIDE QUESTIONS FOR REVIEWING THE PROPOSAL OR PROTOCOL.

1. Is/Are the research question(s) reasonable?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>			
2. Are the study objectives specific, measurable, attainable, and reasonable?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>			
3. Is the research methodology appropriate?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>			
4. Does the research need to be carried out with human participants?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If YES, are appropriate mechanisms in place to protect vulnerable participants?</i>			
5. Does the protocol present sufficient background information or results of previous studies / review of related literature?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO, please comment.</i>			
6. Does the study involve individuals who are vulnerable?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If YES or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>			



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7. Are appropriate mechanisms in place to protect the vulnerable potential participants?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N ONE
<i>If NONE or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>			
8. Are there probable risks to the human participants in the study?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N ONE
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>			
9. Are the risks identified in the protocol?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO, please comment.</i>			
10. Are the possible benefits identified in the protocol?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO, please comment.</i>			
11. Does the protocol adequately address the risk/benefit balance?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>			
12. Does the protocol address issues of privacy and confidentiality? Is there a Data Protection Plan?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>			
13. Is the informed consent procedure/form adequate and culturally appropriate?	☐ NOT APPLICABLE	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO, please comment.</i>			
14. Are the proponents adequately trained and do they have sufficient experience?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>			
15. Does the protocol describe community engagement/consultation prior to and during the conduct of research?	☐ NOT APPLICABLE	☐ ES	☐ N O
<i>If NO, please comment.</i>			



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16. Does the protocol include strategies to be used in disseminating/ ensuring utilization of the expected research results?	☐ NOT APPLICABLE	☐ ES	☐ NO
If NO, please comment.			
17. Is the research facility appropriate?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ NO
If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.			
18. Do you have any other concerns?			

RECOMMENDATION:

DECISION	Approval	Minor Revision
	Major Revision/ Resubmission	Disapproval

Comments (Identify items for revision)	
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Reviewer's Name		Date:	
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Signature:	
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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.12.1a
 STUDY PROTOCOL SELF-ASSESSMENT

This form is for preliminary assessment of Principal Investigator / Research Proponent

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:		DATE	
TITLE OF THE STUDY			
PROPOSERS / PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATORS			
INSTITUTION		E-MAIL ADDRESSES	
CONTACT NO.		STATUS	☐ NEW ☐ FOR RENEWAL OF APPROVAL

GUIDE QUESTIONS FOR REVIEWING THE PROPOSAL OR PROTOCOL.				PAGE NO.
1. Is/Are the research question(s) reasonable?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS <i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>	☐ YES ☐ NO		
2. Are the study objectives specific, measurable, attainable, and reasonable?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS <i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>	☐ YES ☐ NO		
3. Is the research methodology appropriate?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS <i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>	☐ YES ☐ NO		
4. Does the research need to be carried out with human participants?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS <i>If YES, are appropriate mechanisms in place to protect vulnerable participants?</i>	☐ YES ☐ NO		
5. Does the protocol present sufficient background information or results of previous studies / review of related literature?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS <i>If NO, please comment.</i>	☐ YES ☐ NO		



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6. Does the study involve individuals who are vulnerable?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ NO	
<i>If YES or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>				
7. Are appropriate mechanisms in place to protect the vulnerable potential participants?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ NO NE	
<i>If NONE or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>				
8. Are there probable risks to the human participants in the study?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ NO NE	
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>				
9. Are the risks identified in the protocol?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ NO	
<i>If NO, please comment.</i>				
10. Are the possible benefits identified in the protocol?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ NO	
<i>If NO, please comment.</i>				
11. Does the protocol adequately address the risk/benefit balance?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ NO	
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>				
12. Does the protocol address issues of privacy and confidentiality? Is there a Data Protection Plan?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ NO	
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>				
13. Is the informed consent procedure/form adequate and culturally appropriate?	☐ NOT APPLICABLE	☐ ES	☐ NO	
<i>If NO, please comment.</i>				
14. Are the proponents adequately trained and do they have sufficient experience?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ NO	
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>				



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15. Does the protocol describe community engagement/consultation prior to and during the conduct of research?	☐ NOT APPLICABLE	☐ ES	☐ NO	
<i>If NO, please comment.</i>				
16. Does the protocol include strategies to be used in disseminating/ensuring utilization of the expected research results?	☐ NOT APPLICABLE	☐ ES	☐ NO	
<i>If NO, please comment.</i>				
17. Is the research facility appropriate?	☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ ES	☐ NO	
<i>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS, please comment.</i>				
18. Do you have any other concerns?				

Name of Principal Investigator / Research Participant		Date:	
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Signature:	
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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.12.2
INFORMED CONSENT ASSESSMENT

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:	DATE	
TITLE OF THE STUDY		
PROPOSERS / PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR		

GUIDE QUESTIONS FOR REVIEWING THE INFORMED CONSENT PROCESS AND FORM.

1. IS IT NECESSARY TO SEEK THE INFORMED CONSENT OF THE PARTICIPANTS

☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS

☐ YES

☐ NO

***If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS,** please comment.*

***If YES,** are the participants provided with sufficient information about the following items?*

	YES	NO
1. Purpose of the Study?		
2. Expected duration of Participation?		
3. Procedures to be carried out?		
4. Discomfort and Inconvenience?		
5. Risk (including possible discrimination)?		
6. Compensation and/or medical treatment in case of injury?		
7. Benefit of participants?		
8. Statement that one can withdraw at any time from the study without penalty?		
9. Statement that one can refuse to answer a question/s in the course of a study?		
10. Sharing the result of the study?		
11. Person to contact in case there are concerns / emergency situations? (Include the Research Ethics Committee Contact information)		
12. Certificate of consent with the provision for the name of the participants, her or his signature, and date of signing of ICF?		



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13. An alternative manner of giving of consent?		
14. A referral system for appropriate interventions in place in case the need arises?		
15. Assurance of the confidentiality of all information?		
	YES	NO
☐ Extent of Confidentiality? If informed consent is taken by online/electronic means, is there a statement that says, "confidentiality will be maintained to the degree permitted by the technology user. Your participation in this online survey involves risk similar to a person's everyday use of the internet.		
☐ Is there an adequate and clear description of the data protection plan or details about how data will be stored (including who has access to the data)?		
☐ For online/internet-based research and/or if the informed consent is taken electronically:		
☐ Is the instruction of providing informed consent through online or electronic means clear and easy to follow?		
☐ Does the online consent process provide a mechanism for the participants to ask questions?		
☐ Is there a clear description of how the participant can withdraw from the study if the participant wishes to withdraw their information?		
☐ Is there a description of how the participants will obtain their copy of their consent form (i.e., if the hard copy or an online copy will be provided and how)?		
☐ If compensation will be provided, is there a description of how the compensation will be given/delivered to the participants?		
	YES	NO
2. IS THE INFORMED CONSENT WRITTEN AND PRESENTED IN NON-TECHNICAL LANGUAGE THAT PARTICIPANTS CAN UNDERSTAND?		
3. DOES THE PROTOCOL INCLUDE AN ADEQUATE PROCESS FOR ENSURING THAT CONSENT IS VOLUNTARY?		



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4. DO YOU HAVE ANY CONCERNS?

RECOMMENDATION:

DECISION		Approval		Minor Revision
		Major Revision/ Resubmission		Disapproval

Comments (Identify
items for revision)

Reviewer's Name

Date:

Signature:



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.12.2a
 INFORMED CONSENT SELF-ASSESSMENT

This form is for preliminary assessment of Principal Investigator / Research Proponent

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:	DATE
TITLE OF THE STUDY	
PROONENTS / PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR	

GUIDE QUESTIONS FOR REVIEWING THE INFORMED CONSENT PROCESS AND FORM.			PAGE NO.
1. IS IT NECESSARY TO SEEK THE INFORMED CONSENT OF THE PARTICIPANTS			
☐ UNABLE TO ASSESS	☐ YES	☐ NO	
<u>If NO or UNABLE TO ASSESS.</u> please comment.			
<u>If YES,</u> are the participants provided with sufficient information about the following items?			
	YES	NO	
1. Purpose of the Study?			
2. Expected duration of Participation?			
3. Procedures to be carried out?			
4. Discomfort and Inconvenience?			
5. Risk (including possible discrimination)?			
6. Compensation and/or medical treatment in case of injury?			
7. Benefit of participants?			
8. Statement that one can withdraw at any time from the study without penalty?			
9. Statement that one can refuse to answer a question/s in the course of a study?			
10. Sharing the result of the study?			



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11. Person to contact in case there are concerns / emergency situations? (Include the REC contact information)			
12. Certificate of consent with the provision for the name of the participants, her or his signature, and date of signing of ICF?			
13. An alternative manner of giving of consent?			
14. A referral system for appropriate interventions in place in case the need arises?			
15. Assurance of the confidentiality of all information?			
	YES	NO	
o Extent of Confidentiality? If informed consent is taken by online/electronic means, is there a statement that says, "confidentiality will be maintained to the degree permitted by the technology user. Your participation in this online survey involves risk similar to a person's everyday use of the internet.			
o Is there an adequate and clear description of the data protection plan or details about how data will be stored (including who has access to the data)?			
o For online/internet-based research and/or if the informed consent is taken electronically:			
☐ Is the instruction of providing informed consent through online or electronic means clear and easy to follow?			
☐ Does the online consent process provide a mechanism for the participants to ask questions?			
☐ Is there a clear description of how the participant can withdraw from the study if the participant wishes to withdraw their information?			
☐ Is there a description of how the participants will obtain their copy of their consent form (i.e., if the hard copy or an online copy will be provided and how)?			
☐ If compensation will be provided, is there a description of how the compensation will be given/delivered to the participants?			



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	YES	NO	
2. IS THE INFORMED CONSENT WRITTEN AND PRESENTED IN NON-TECHNICAL LANGUAGE THAT PARTICIPANTS CAN UNDERSTAND?			
3. DOES THE PROTOCOL INCLUDE AN ADEQUATE PROCESS FOR ENSURING THAT CONSENT IS VOLUNTARY?			
4. DO YOU HAVE ANY CONCERNS?			

Name of Principal Investigator / Research Proponent		Date:	
Signature:			

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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 2.13.1
 REVIEW OF RESUBMITTED STUDY PROTOCOL

LNU-REC Code:	Date of Initial Submission: <dd/mm/yyyy>
Study Protocol Title:	
Total Participants :	☐ 2 nd Review ☐ 3 rd Review
Principal Investigator: <Title, Name, Surname>	Tel.:
Initial Review Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>	Last Review Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>
Recommendations from last review: 1. 2. 3. 4.	Were the recommendations met (Yes/No)? Explain 1. 2. 3. 4.
RECOMMENDATION OF PRIMARY REVIEWER: • APPROVE • MINOR MODIFICATION • MAJOR MODIFICATION • DISAPPROVE • PENDING, IF MAJOR CLARIFICATIONS ARE REQUIRED BEFORE A DECISION CAN BE MADE	JUSTIFICATION FOR RECOMMENDED ACTION:

Date		Name	Signature
<dd/mm/yyyy>	Primary Reviewers	1.	
		2.	
	Other Reviewers	1.	
		2.	
		3.	
		4.	
		5.	



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.14.1
PROTOCOL AMENDMENT REVIEW

INSTRUCTIONS TO THE PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR: A *protocol amendment review* is a written description of a change(s) to or formal clarification of a protocol and/or informed consent documents. Favorable opinion or approval should be obtained from the REC that issued the ethical clearance or approval prior to the implementation of an amendment. Obtain an electronic copy of this form and encode all information required in the space provided. Multiple amendments classified under ONE type of review (expedited or full review) can be submitted in one form. Print the report in A4 size paper; then affix date and sign this form before submission.

PROTOCOL CODE:			
STUDY PROTOCOL TITLE:			
APPROVAL DATE: <dd/mm/yyyy>			
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:			
Email:	Telephone:	Mobile:	
STUDY SITE: <Name and address>			
STUDY SITE ADDRESS:			
SPONSOR:			
SPONSOR CONTACT PERSON:			
Email:	Telephone:	Mobile:	
AMENDMENT SUBMISSION DATE: (to be filled out by LNU-REC) <dd/mm/yyyy>			
1. Item/procedure to be amended in the approved protocol/ICF	2. Proposed Amendment (indicate page # where amendment is found)	3. Justification	4. LNU-REC Review Assessment (to be filled out by the LNU-REC)
A. Protocol			
1.			
2.			
B. Informed Consent Form			
1.			



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2.			
5. TYPE OF REVIEW:			
5.1. ■ EXPEDITED REVIEW FOR AMENDMENTS THAT:			
• Do not involve changes in study populations • Do not involve the collection of stigmatizing information • Do not change approved use of anonymized or archived samples • Do not involve further recruitment of participants • Involve study protocols previously classified under expedited review • Are administrative in nature (such as contact details of study personnel) • Do not materially affect the risk-benefit ratio of the approved protocol or increase risks to study participants			
5.2 ■ FULL REVIEW for any amendments not cited under EXPEDITED REVIEW			
SIGNATURE OF PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:			
<i>For LNU-REC use only</i>			
Primary Reviewers	Signature	Date	
1.		<dd/mm/yyyy>	
2.		<dd/mm/yyyy>	

RECOMMENDED ACTION: (for LNU-REC use only)	
• APPROVAL • MINOR MODIFICATION TO THE STUDY PROTOCOL, SUBJECT TO EXPEDITED REVIEW AT THE LEVEL OF THE PANEL CHAIR • MAJOR MODIFICATION TO THE STUDY PROTOCOL, SUBJECT TO FULL PANEL REVIEW • DISAPPROVAL	
COMMENTS: <i>(identify items for revision) Write comments of all members if full board</i>	
Signature	
REP MEMBER SECRETARY	
Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>	Name <Title, Name, Surname>
Signature	
REP CHAIRPERSON	
Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>	Name <Title, Name, Surname>



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.15.1
PROGRESS REPORT

LNU-REC Protocol No.		Approval Date	
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Protocol Title	
----------------	--

Investigator		Sponsor	
--------------	--	---------	--

Any amendment since the last review? (Describe briefly)	No	Yes	☐	☐
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Any change in participant population, recruitment or selection criteria since the last review? (Explain the changes)	☐ No	☐ Yes
--	-----------------------------	------------------------------

Any change in the Informed Consent process or documentation since the last review? (Please explain)	☐ No	☐ Yes
---	-----------------------------	------------------------------

Is there any new information in recent literature or similar research that may change the risk/benefit ratio for participants in the study? (Discuss and attach a narrative)	☐ No	☐ Yes
---	-----------------------------	------------------------------

Any unexpected complication or side effect noted since the last review? (Discuss and attach a narrative)	☐ No	☐ Yes
--	-----------------------------	------------------------------

Did any participant withdraw from this study since the last approval? (Reasons for withdrawal)	☐ No	☐ Yes
---	-----------------------------	------------------------------



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Any new investigator that has been added to or removed from the Research team since the last review? (Please identify them and submit The CVs of new investigators.)

☐ No ☐ Yes

Summary of protocol participants

- ☐ Total number of participants in the approved protocol _____
- ☐ Total number of participants in the actual study _____

Exclusion considerations for additional participants

- ☐ None
- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Others (Specify)

Are there any new collaborating sites that have been added or deleted since

the last review?
Please identify the sites and note the addition or deletion.

☐ No ☐ Yes

With Impaired Participants?

- ☐ No
- ☐ Yes, specify _____

To be filled up LNU-REC

Date received:

Received by:

Printed Name

Signature

PRIMARY REVIEWERS

Signature

DATE: mm/dd/yyyy

1.

2.

DATE: mm/dd/yyyy

Names: Other reviewers

Signature of members if full board review

1.

2.



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Recommendations

Approve
Request an amendment to the
protocol or consent form
Request further information
Suspend or terminate the study
Others

Type of review:

Expedited review Full
Board review

Date of meeting

Change to the protocol
recommended? Comments:

No Yes
N/A

Changes to the informed consent form
recommended?? Comments:

No Yes
N/A

REP Final Decision:

Certified by:

REP Chairperson

Signature

Date



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.16.1
DEVIATION / NON-COMPLIANCE / VIOLATION REPORT

INSTRUCTIONS TO THE PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR: *Obtain an electronic copy of this form and encode all information required in the space provided. Multiple deviations/violations classified under ONE type of review (expedited or full review) can be submitted in one form; then affix date and sign this form before submission.*

PROTOCOL CODE:			
STUDY PROTOCOL TITLE:			
APPROVAL DATE:			
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:			
Email:		Telephone:	Mobile:
STUDY SITE:			
STUDY SITE ADDRESS:			
SPONSOR:			
SPONSOR CONTACT PERSON:			
Email:		Telephone:	Mobile:
Ethical clearance effectivity period			
1. Progress Report			
Start of study		Expected end of study	
Number of enrolled participants		Number of required participants	
Number of participants who withdrew			
0. Indicate each protocol deviation/violation:		Actions taken to prevent future deviation/violation	
1		1	
2		2	
3		3	
0. Impact of deviation/violation on participants' risks/harms and integrity of data		How would you address these factors?	



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DATE OF DEVIATION/VIOLATION: <dd/mm/yyyy>	
REPORTED BY:	
DATE OF REPORT: <dd/mm/yyyy>	
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR SIGNATURE:	

FOR LNU-REC USE ONLY

NATURE OF REPORT

- ☐ MINOR PROTOCOL DEVIATION - (non-systematic protocol noncompliance with minor consequences, in terms of its effect on the participant's/subject's rights, safety or welfare, or the integrity of study data; includes deviations that are administrative in nature)
- ☐ MAJOR PROTOCOL DEVIATION - Persistent protocol noncompliance with potentially serious consequences that could critically affect data analysis or put patients' safety at risk)

DESCRIPTION OF REPORTED DEVIATION/VIOLATION:

DESCRIPTION OF INVESTIGATOR CORRECTIVE ACTION:

Recommended Action:

- ☐ UPHOLD ORIGINAL APPROVAL WITH NO FURTHER ACTION
- ☐ REQUEST INFORMATION: (specify)
- ☐ RECOMMEND FURTHER ACTION



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SITE VISIT NEEDED

- ☐ Suspend the study (until additional information is made available)
- ☐ Suspend the study (until recommendations are implemented by the Principal Investigator and found to be satisfactory)
- ☐ Revoke approval of the current study
- ☐ Reprimand the Principal Investigator

PRIMARY REVIEWERS

1.
2.

Signature

Date Signed

Other reviewers

1.
2.
3.

REP Member-Secretary:

Date:

REP Chairperson:

Date:



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.17.1
SAE AND SUSAR REPORT

Principal Investigator:		Protocol Code:	
Study Protocol Title:			
Name of the study medicine/device		Report Date: <dd/mm/yyyy> REC Submission Date: <dd/mm/yyyy> ☐ Initial ☐ Follow-up Onset date: <dd/mm/yyyy>	
Sponsor:		Date of first use:	
Patient's Initial/Number:		Age:	☐ Male ☐ Female
Patient's Date of Birth: dd/mm/yyyy	Weight: kg	Height: cm	
Relevant medical history and concurrent conditions:			

SAE/SUSAR

I. REACTION INFORMATION:

_____ (use CIOMS definition) List all relevant tests/ lab data:	Check all appropriate to adverse reaction: ☐ Patient died ☐ Involved or prolonged inpatient hospitalization ☐ Involved persistence or significant disability or incapacity ☐ Life threatening
--	--



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II. SUSPECT DRUG/S INFORMATION:

Suspect drug/s (include generic name)		Did reaction abate after stopping drug? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA
Daily dose/s:	Routes of administration:	Did reaction appear after reintroduction? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ NA
Indication/s for use:		
Therapy date/s: (from/to)	Therapy duration:	
Is this reaction ☐ Unexpected ☐ Expected		
Treatment given for Adverse Event:		
Causality Assessment By Investigator (Using WHO-UMC Causality Assessment System) ☐ Certain ☐ Probable ☐ Possible ☐ Unlikely ☐ Unclassifiable		
Outcome of reaction/event at the time of last observation: ☐ Recovered ☐ Recovering with sequelae ☐ Death ☐ Recovering ☐ Not recovering ☐ Unknown		

III. CONCOMITANT DRUG/S AND HISTORY:

Concomitant drug/s and dates of administration (exclude drug used to treat reaction)
--



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ROEthCeOr rMeI MevEaNNdt hEiDstoArCy T(eIO.gN. d: i(afgonr oRsEtiCcs,uasleleorgnileys), pregnancy with last month of period, etc.)

- ☐ NO FURTHER ACTION
- ☐ REQUEST INFORMATION: (indicate information)
- ☐ RECOMMEND FURTHER ACTION: (indicate action)
- ☐ PENDING, IF MAJOR CLARIFICATIONS ARE REQUIRED BEFORE A DECISION CAN BE MADE

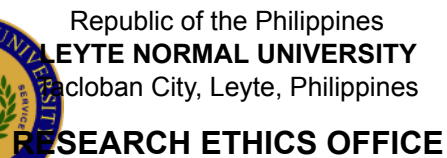
PRIMARY REVIEWER

Signature

Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>

Name

<Title, Name, Surname>



LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.17.2
 SAE AND SUSAR SUMMARY REPORT

PROTOCOL TITLE	
DRUG/INTERVENTION	
LNU-REC CODE	
TITLE	
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR	
DATE OF REPORT/S	
DATE OF MEETING	

[illegible]



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Total Number of New Events	=		Total Number of Unclassifiable	=	
Total Number of Certain	=		Total Number of Deaths	=	
Total Number of Probable	=		Items Which Need Follow-up	=	
Total Number of Possible	=				
Total Number of Unlikely	=				
Total Number of Conditional	=				

RECOMMENDED ACTION: (for EVHRDC-ERC use only)

- ☐ NO FURTHER ACTION
- ☐ REQUEST INFORMATION: (indicate information)
- ☐ RECOMMEND FURTHER ACTION: (indicate action)
- ☐ PENDING, IF MAJOR CLARIFICATIONS ARE REQUIRED BEFORE A DECISION CAN BE MADE

COMMENTS/ ASSESSMENTS OF SAE/SUSAR REPORT:

PRIMARY REVIEWER

Signature

Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>

Name

<Title, Name, Surname>

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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.17.3
 REPORT OF NEGATIVE EVENTS (RNE)

General Information			
Study Protocol Title:			
Study Protocol Code:		Study Site	
Principal Investigator:		Contact Information	Tel. No.:
			Mobile No.:
			Email:
Institution			
Address of Institution			
Ethical clearance effectivity period			
RNE Report	Date submitted		
Start of study	Expected end of study		
Number of enrolled participants	Number of required participants		
Description of Negative (harms, risks) Events a. Involving Participants b. Involving members of the Study Team c. Involving Data safety and integrity	Actions taken to prevent future RNEs, interventions and Outcome		
Recommendations			

Received by the REP Secretary:	Name & Designation:	Signature:	Date:
REP Chairperson:	Printed name:	Signature:	Date:



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REO
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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.18.1
EARLY STUDY TERMINATION

INSTRUCTIONS TO THE PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR: *This form is required to apply for premature termination or suspension of a study. Obtain an electronic copy of this form and encode all information required in the space provided. Print the application in A4 size paper; then affix date and sign this form before submission. Approval of this application would require further completion of Form 3.15.1 Progress Report.*

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:		
STUDY PROTOCOL TITLE:		
APPROVAL DATE:		
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:		
STUDY PROTOCOL APPROVAL DATE: <dd/mm/yyyy>		
Email:	Telephone:	Mobile:
STUDY SITE:		
STUDY SITE ADDRESS		
SPONSOR:		
SPONSOR CONTACT PERSON:		
Email:	Telephone:	Mobile:
APPLICATION SUBMISSION DATE: (to be filled out by REC) <dd/mm/yyyy>		
1. START DATE OF THE STUDY:		
2. PROPOSED TERMINATION DATE: <dd/mm/yyyy>		
3. NUMBER OF PARTICIPANTS TO DATE:		
4. SUMMARY OF RESULTS TO DATE:		
5. REASON FOR TERMINATION with JUSTIFICATION:		
SIGNATURE OF PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:		
DATE OF APPLICATION: <dd/mm/yyyy>		



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RECOMMENDATIONS (for LNU-REC use only)

Comments of REP Chairperson

RECOMMENDED ACTION:

- APPROVE
- REQUEST INFORMATION: (specify) _____
- RECOMMEND FURTHER ACTION: (specify) _____
- PENDING, IF MAJOR CLARIFICATIONS ARE REQUIRED BEFORE A DECISION CAN BE MADE

REP Chairperson Signature

Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>

Name <Title, Name, Surname>



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.19.1
CONTINUING REVIEW APPLICATION FORM

PROTOCOL CODE:		
STUDY PROTOCOL TITLE		
APPROVAL DATE: <dd/mm/yyyy>	EXPIRY OF ETHICAL CLEARANCE: <dd/mm/yyyy>	
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:		
Email:	Telephone:	Mobile:
STUDY SITE:		
STUDY SITE ADDRESS:		
SPONSOR:		
SPONSOR CONTACT PERSON:		
Email:	Telephone:	Mobile:
1. START DATE: 1.1. Date of research site initialization: <dd/mm/yyyy> 1.2. Explanation, if not yet initialized as of date of this application: <reason/s>		
2. ACTION REQUESTED: 2.1. ☐ Renewal: Ethical clearance renewal for one (1) year 2.2. ☐ Others (specify): _____		
3. HAVE THERE BEEN ANY AMENDMENTS SINCE THE LAST REVIEW/APPROVAL? 3.1. ☐ No 3.2. ☐ Yes (Describe briefly and indicate date/s of Study Protocol Amendment Submission/s)		
4. HAVE THERE BEEN ANY DEVIATION/NONCOMPLIANCE REPORTS SINCE THE LAST REVIEW/APPROVAL? 4.1. ☐ No 4.2. ☐ Yes (Describe briefly and indicate date/s of Study Protocol Deviation Submission/s)		
5. SUMMARY OF STUDY PROTOCOL PARTICIPANTS:		
<number>	5.1 ☐ Total number of participants in the approved protocol	
<number>	5.2 ☐ Total number of participants in the actual study	
6. EXCLUSION CONSIDERATIONS FOR ADDITIONAL PARTICIPANTS 6.1. ☐ None 6.2. ☐ Male 6.3. ☐ Female 6.4. ☐ Others (specify): _____		



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7. WITH IMPAIRED PARTICIPANTS?

7.1. ☐ No

7.2. ☐ Yes (specify): _____

8. HAVE THERE BEEN ANY CHANGES IN THE PARTICIPANT POPULATION, RECRUITMENT OR SELECTION CRITERIA SINCE THE LAST REVIEW/APPROVAL?

8.1. ☐ No

8.2. ☐ Yes (Explain changes and indicate date/s of Study Protocol Amendment Submission/s)

9. HAVE THERE BEEN ANY CHANGES IN THE INFORMED CONSENT PROCESS OR DOCUMENTATION SINCE THE LAST REVIEW/ APPROVAL? Attach latest version of participant information sheet and informed consent form/document

9.1. ☐ No

9.2. ☐ Yes (Explain changes and indicate date/s of Study Protocol Amendment Submission/s)

10. HAS ANY INFORMATION APPEARED IN THE LITERATURE, OR EVOLVED FROM THIS OR SIMILAR RESEARCH THAT MIGHT AFFECT THE PANEL'S EVALUATION OF THE RISK/BENEFIT ASSESSMENT OF HUMAN PARTICIPANTS INVOLVED IN THIS STUDY PROTOCOL?

10.1. ☐ No

10.2. ☐ Yes (Describe briefly and provide copy of literature cited, if applicable)

11. HAVE THERE BEEN ANY UPDATES OR MEASURES IN THE PROTOCOL TO GUARANTEE PROTECTION OF PRIVACY AND CONFIDENTIALITY OF PARTICIPANT INFORMATION IN COMPLIANCE WITH LOCAL REGULATIONS (e.g. DATA PRIVACY ACT OF 2012)?

11.1. ☐ No

11.2. ☐ Yes (Describe briefly these provisions)

12. IS A BIOBANK BEING MAINTAINED FOR THIS STUDY?

12.1. ☐ No

12.2. ☐ Yes (Describe governance and custodianship, access to data and transfer of materials, and measures protecting privacy and confidentiality)

13. HAVE ANY UNEXPECTED DISCOMFORTS, COMPLICATIONS, OR SIDE EFFECTS BEEN NOTED SINCE LAST REVIEW/ APPROVAL?

13.1. ☐ No

13.2. ☐ Yes (Summarize and indicate date/s of SUSAR report submission/s)

14. HAVE ANY PARTICIPANTS WITHDRAWN FROM THIS STUDY SINCE THE LAST REVIEW/APPROVAL?

14.1. ☐ No

14.2. ☐ Yes (Explain context surrounding withdrawal and documenting due diligence exerted by the study team in managing these withdrawals)

15. HAVE THERE BEEN ANY NEW INTERVENTION(S) OR METHODS IN THE CONDUCT OF STUDY THAT IS/ARE NOT IN THE APPROVED PROTOCOL

15.1. ☐ No

15.2. ☐ Yes (Describe use and indicate date/s of Study Protocol Deviation/Non-Compliance/Violation Report Submission/s)



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16. HAVE THERE BEEN ANY NEW INTERVENTION(S) OR METHODS IN THE CONDUCT OF STUDY THAT IS/ARE NOT IN THE APPROVED PROTOCOL

- 16.1. ☐ No
16.2. ☐ Yes (Describe use and indicate date/s of Study Protocol Deviation/Non-Compliance/Violation Report Submission/s)

17. HAVE ANY INVESTIGATORS BEEN ADDED OR DELETED SINCE LAST REVIEW/ APPROVAL?

- 17.1. ☐ No
17.2. ☐ Yes (Enumerate personnel and indicate date/s of Study Protocol Amendment Submission/s. Append CV if not yet submitted to the LNU-REC)

18. HAVE ANY INVESTIGATORS DEVELOPED EQUITY OR CONSULTATIVE RELATIONSHIP WITH A PARTY RELATED TO THIS STUDY PROTOCOL WHICH MIGHT BE CONSIDERED A CONFLICT OF INTEREST SINCE THE LAST REVIEW/ APPROVAL?

- 18.1. ☐ No
18.2. ☐ Yes (Append a statement of disclosure)

19. HAVE THERE BEEN CHANGES IN STUDY PERSONNEL SINCE THE LAST REVIEW/ APPROVAL?

- 19.1. ☐ NONE:
19.2. ☐ DELETED (Enumerate and indicate date/s of Study Protocol Amendment Submission/s)
19.3. ☐ ADDED (Enumerate and indicate date/s of Study Protocol Amendment Submission/s)

20. HAVE THERE BEEN OTHER CHANGES NOT MENTIONED ABOVE SINCE THE LAST REVIEW/APPROVAL? Attach protocol synopsis.

- 20.1. ☐ No
20.2. ☐ Yes (Describe changes and indicate date/s of Study Protocol Amendment Submission/s)

21. HAS THE STUDY SITE BEEN VISITED BY LNU-REC OR ANOTHER ETHICS COMMITTEE, AUDITED BY SPONSOR, OR INSPECTED BY ANY REGULATORY AGENCY?

- 21.1. ☐ No
21.2. ☐ Yes (Provide details regarding the visit/audit/inspection (when, where, etc), findings and recommendations, and corrective action of the site, if any)

22. PROGRESS STATUS (List the different components or activities in approved study protocol, provide a short description and indicate completion status, e.g., 50% complete, 75% complete)

RECOMMENDATIONS (for LNU-REC use only)

Comments of Primary Reviewers

RECOMMENDED ACTION:

- ☐ Grant renewal of the ethical clearance
Duration of Approval: from mm/dd/yyyy to mm/dd/yyyy
- ☐ Not grant the renewal of ethical clearance
Reason: _____
- ☐ REP requests for other documents to be able to make the decision to grant renewal



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REP MEMBER-SECRETARY

Signature

Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>

Name

<Title, Name, Surname>

REP CHAIRPERSON

Signature

Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>

Name

<Title, Name, Surname>



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.20.1
LETTER OF APPEAL

DATE: mm/dd/yy

To PI: Please bring all documents relevant to the activity.

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:	
Title of the Study:	
Principal Investigator:	
Date of Initial Submission:	
Date of Last Review:	
Sponsor	

Dear (REP Chairperson):

(Entity: PI, or Sponsor, or Institution) wish to **appeal** the following LNU-REC decisions:

Specify REP decision for appeal:	Indicate the points in question and provide justification for the request for reconsideration or repeal of the decision by providing evidences or corrective measures for a LNU- REC CONSIDERATION.

PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR/SPONSOR/HEAD OF INSTITUTION

Received by (REP Secretary):	Name and Signature
Date Received	



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.21.1
LETTER OF INVITATION TO MEMBERS OF SITE VISIT TEAM

<dd/mm/yyyy>

<NAME OF REP MEMBER>
LNU-REC Member

Re: <STUDY PROTOCOL TITLE> <LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE>

Dear **<TITLE OF VISITING TEAM MEMBER> <SURNAME>**:

We wish to inform you that the _____REP has appointed you to be a member of the Site Visit Team responsible for verifying compliance of the study site with LNU-REC approved protocol and related documents, such as, contents of the informed consent form, etc. This site visit is being organized because of: _____. As part of the team, your responsibilities include the following:

1. Review the study protocol and the ICF (note: make sure that the site is using the most recent version)
2. Review the submitted Progress Report
3. Ask the PI or staff to explain the informed consent process
4. Ensure security, privacy, and confidentiality of the documents at the study site
5. Discuss the findings with the research team

Study Site	
Address	
Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>
Time	<hh:mm>

6. Solicit feedback from the study site

The details of the Site Visit are as

follows:



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To facilitate the intended site visit, please signify your confirmation by signing in the space provided below, affix date and signature, and return one copy of this letter to the REP Secretary.



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Thank you and best
regards.

Very truly yours,

Name and
Signature
Chairperson, REP

Name and Signature

CONFORME of REP Member
DATE SIGNED: <dd/mm/yyyy>

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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.21.3
NOTICE OF SITE VISIT TO PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR

<dd/mm/yyyy>

<NAME OF PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR>

Principal Investigator

Re: <STUDY PROTOCOL TITLE> <LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE>

Dear **<PI>**:

We wish to inform you that the LNU-REC has scheduled a Site Visit for your site on (date) at (time) . In addition to yourself, I would appreciate the opportunity to meet the other members of your team during this visit.

During the visit, the team would like to verify the compliance of the study site and to perform the following:

1. Review the study protocol and the ICF (note: make sure that the site is using the most recent version)
2. Review the submitted Progress Report
3. Ask the PI or staff to explain the informed consent process
4. Ensure security, privacy, and confidentiality of the documents at the study site
5. Discuss the findings with the research team
6. Solicit feedback from the study site

To facilitate the intended site visit, please signify your confirmation by signing in the space provided below, affix date and signature, and return one copy of this letter to the REP Secretary. If you have any questions or concerns about anything outlined in this notification or any study related issues, you may visit the REP Secretary at the Research Ethics Office, email us at ethics@lnu.edu.ph, or call telephone number __for assistance.

Very truly yours,

Name and

Signature

Chairperson, REP

Name and Signature

CONFORME of Principal Investigator

DATE SIGNED: <dd/mm/yyyy>



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.21.3
SITE VISIT REPORT

INSTRUCTIONS TO THE LNU-REC MEMBERS: A Site Visit is conducted as result of full board action for purposes of monitoring study protocol compliance in the study site. The visit is limited to the review of study protocol related documents and procedures that have been approved by the LNU-REC that issued the ethical clearance or approval of the study. The visit should not in any way compromise the obligation to protect the privacy and confidentiality of research-related information of study participants/subjects. The REP Chairperson should ensure that the Site Visit Team is well-prepared to conduct the visit through a complete review of the study protocol folder prior to the visit. This form should reflect the consensus opinion of the Site Visit Team.

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:

STUDY PROTOCOL TITLE:

APPROVAL DATE: <dd/mm/yyyy>

PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:

Email:

Telephone:

Mobile:

STUDY SITE: <Name and address>

STUDY SITE ADDRESS:

SPONSOR:

SPONSOR CONTACT PERSON:

Email:

Telephone:

Mobile:

SITE VISIT DATE: <dd/mm/yyyy>

1. Total number of participants expected:

2. Total number of participants to date:

3. Are site facilities appropriate?

☐ YES

☐ NO

COMMENTS

:

4. Are informed consent documents updated to the version approved by the LNU-REC?

☐ YES

☐ NO

COMMENTS

:



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5. Are there any SAE/SUSAR reports not previously reported to the LNU-REC?

☐ YES

☐ NO

COMMENT

S

6. Are there any events of protocol noncompliance not previously reported to the LNU-REC?

☐ YES

☐ NO

COMMENT

S

7. Are investigation products and study documents secured adequately?

☐ YES

☐ NO

COMMENT

S

8. Are all other LNU-REC -approved documents (e.g. advertisements) used in accordance with the approved study protocol?

☐ YES

☐ NO

COMMENTS

:

9. Are there any significant findings in this visit that could affect participant's/subject's rights, safety or welfare?

☐ YES

☐ NO

COMMENTS

:

10. Overall, does the study site provide adequate protection for the rights, safety or welfare of study participants/subjects?

☐ YES

☐ NO

COMMENTS

:

11. How well are study participants/subjects protected?

☐ GOOD

☐ FAIR

☐ NOT

GOOD

COMMENTS

12. Are there further actions or queries resulting from this site visit?

☐ YES

☐ NO

COMMENT

S

13. Additional remarks



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14. **Duration of visit:** <hours >/ From <hh:mm> to <hh:mm>



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COMPLETED BY THE FOLLOWING REP MEMBER/ REPRESENTATIVES:

NAME	SIGNATURE	DATE
Name 1		<dd/mm/yyyy>
Name 2		<dd/mm/yyyy>
Name 3		<dd/mm/yyyy>
REP Secretary		<dd/mm/yyyy>



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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 3.22.1
REVIEW OF FINAL REPORT

INSTRUCTIONS TO THE PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR: *This form is required upon completion of the study or closure of study site. Obtain an electronic copy of this form and encode all information required in the space provided.*

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:		
STUDY PROTOCOL TITLE:		
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:		
STUDY PROTOCOL APPROVAL DATE: <dd/mm/yyyy>		
Email:	Telephone:	Mobile:
STUDY SITE: <Name and address>		
STUDY SITE ADDRESS:		
SPONSOR:		
SPONSOR CONTACT PERSON:		
Email:	Telephone:	Mobile:
REPORT SUBMISSION DATE: (to be filled out by LNU-REC) <dd/mm/yyyy>		
1. Intended number of participants:		
2. Number of study participants in the beginning of the study:		
3. Number of participants at the end of the study:		
4. Summary of amendments to the original protocol (including dates of approval):		
5. Summary of SAE reported:		
6. Summary of anticipated risks (other than SAEs) documented in the conduct of study:		
7. Summary of SUSAR reported:		
8. Summary of unanticipated risks (others than SUSAR) documented in the conduct of study:		
9. Summary of participants' complaints or grievances documented regarding conduct of study:		
10. Summary of benefits documented:		



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11. Summary of indemnifications (If applicable):
12. If terminated early, specify reason for termination:
13. Continuing Review Application Submission dates with corresponding panel action:
14. Summary of research tools used:
15. List of treatments or interventions (If applicable):
16. Duration of the study:
17. Study objectives and summary of results:
18. List of informed consent form used (version/date) and attach most recent version:
DATE OF LAST REVIEW: <dd/mm/yyyy>
SIGNATURE OF PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:
DATE SUBMITTED: <dd/mm/yyyy>
RECEIVED BY (REP SECRETARY):

RECOMMENDATIONS (for LNU-REC use only)

COMMENTS OF PRIMARY REVIEWER (i.e. compliance with the terms of the approved protocol including post-approval review requirements, and overall assessment of risks against benefits in the conduct of study)

RECOMMENDED ACTION:

- APPROVE
- REQUEST INFORMATION: (specify)
- RECOMMEND FURTHER ACTION: (specify)
- PENDING, IF MAJOR CLARIFICATIONS ARE REQUIRED BEFORE A DECISION CAN BE MADE

REP Chairperson

Signature

Date: <dd/mm/yyyy>

Name <Title, Name, Surname>

	Republic of the Philippines LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY Tacloban City, Leyte, Philippines RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE	
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LNU- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 4.24.1
NOTICE OF MEETING

Date of Notice:
Date of Meeting:
Venue: Zoom Meeting
Time:

Items for Discussion:

(EXPEDITED PROTOCOL REVIEW)

1. Expedited Review of Proposals
 - 1.1. New Protocols
 - 1.2. Resubmissions
 - 1.3. Protocol Amendments
 - 1.4. Progress Report
 - 1.5. Protocol Deviations / Violations
 - 1.6. Continuing Review
 - 1.7. Final Report

2. Other Matters

(FULL BOARD PROTOCOL REVIEW)

1. Full Board Review of Proposals
2. Report of Approved Protocols under Expedited Review
 - 2.1 Approved Protocols
 - 2.2. Approved Resubmitted Protocols
3. Updates on Full Review of Proposals (Resubmission)
4. Updates on Approved, Ongoing Researches
 - 4.1. Protocol Amendments
 - 4.2. Progress Report
 - 4.3. Continuing Review
 - 4.4. Final Report
 - 4.5. Report on Exempt from Review Protocols
5. LNU-REC Operations-related Matters
6. Other Matters



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RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.24.2a
PROVISIONAL AGENDA OF THE EXPEDITED PROTOCOL REVIEW MEETING

Date:

TO: (Name of Members) (Scientist/Non-Scientist & Non-Institutional Member)

Date of Meeting:

Time of Meeting:

Venue of Meeting:

AGENDA

1. PROTOCOL REVIEW

(Note: All Protocol Reviews should include the protocol number, title, PI, and Institution)

- 1.1. New Protocols
- 1.2. Review of Protocol Resubmissions (None)
- 1.3. Protocol Amendments (None)
- 1.4. Progress Report (None)
- 1.5. Protocol Deviations / Violations (None)
- 1.6. Continuing Review (None)
- 1.7. Final Report

2. OTHER MATTERS

- 2.1.

Your personal presence is

requested. Thank you.

Prepared by:

REP Secretary, ____Research Ethics Panel

Approved by:

Chairperson, ____Research Ethics Panel



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.24.2b
PROVISIONAL AGENDA OF THE FULL BOARD REVIEW MEETING

Date:

TO: (Name of Members) (Scientist/Non-Scientist & Non-Institutional Member)

Date of Meeting:

Time of Meeting:

Venue of Meeting:

AGENDA

- 1. Call to Order**
- 2. Declaration of Quorum**
- 3. Approval of the Provisional Agenda**
- 4. Disclosure of Conflict of Interest**
- 5. Review and Approval of the Minutes of the Previous Meeting**
- 6. Business Arising from the Minutes of the Previous Meeting**
- 7. New Business**

PROTOCOL

REVIEW

(Note: All Protocol Reviews should include the protocol number, title, PI, and Institution)

- 1.1 New Protocols for Full Review
- 1.2 Review of Protocol Resubmissions
- 1.3 Protocol Amendments
- 1.4 Progress Report
- 1.5 Protocol Deviations / Violations
- 1.6 RNE Report
- 1.7 SAE and SUSAR Report
- 1.8 Early Study Termination
- 1.9 Continuing Review
- 1.10 Final Reports
- 1.11 Management of Appeals
- 1.12 Site Visit Report
- 1.13 Queries or Complaints
- 1.14 Report of Approved Protocols under Expedited Review
 - 1.14.1 Approved Protocols
 - 1.14.2 Approved Resubmitted Protocols
 - 1.14.3 Approved Amendments (Minor)
 - 1.14.4 Approved Progress Reports
 - 1.14.5 Decisions on Protocol Deviations / Violations (Minor)
 - 1.14.6 Decision on Off-site SAE/SUSARs
 - 1.14.7 Decision on Continuing Review Applications
 - 1.14.8 Report of Final Report
- 1.15 Report on Exempt from Review Protocols
- 1.16 Report on SJREB Protocols



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8. **LNU-REC operations-related matters**
9. **Other matters**
10. **Adjournment**

Your personal presence is

requested. Thank you.

Prepared by:

REP Secretary, _____Research Ethics Panel

Approved by:

Chairperson, _____Research Ethics Panel



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RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.25.1
LETTER FOR CLARIFICATORY INTERVIEW

Date:

Principal Investigator

<Institution>

<Address>

Re: <Protocol Code> <Protocol Title>

Dear **<PI>**:

We wish to inform you that the **Leyte Normal University - Research Ethics Committee** reviewed your <submission> during its regular meeting on **<Date of REC Meeting>**. Upon review, the committee found issues requiring clarifications such as:

1.

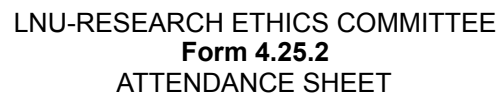
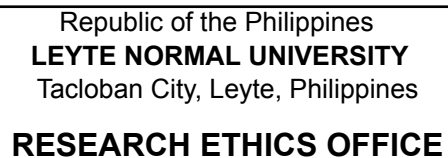
In this regard, the REC requests for a clarificatory interview with you during the next Full Review meeting on <Date of Next Full Board meeting> from <requested time> at the <venue>. Alternatively, we could arrange a teleconference meeting if you will not be able to appear in person. Kindly provide a number where you can be reached by telephone.

Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the above mentioned recommendations, please contact the undersigned through the REP Staff Secretary at _____ or ethics@lnu.edu.ph.

The **Leyte Normal University – Research Ethics Committee** looks forward to your immediate response and action.

Very truly yours,

Chairperson, Research Ethics Committee
Leyte Normal University



_____ FULL BOARD/EXPEDITED/SPECIAL MEETING

Date: _____

(mm/dd/yyyy) Time: _

[illegible]

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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.27.1
MINUTES OF MEETING

Title:	
Date/ Time:	
Venue:	

ATTENDANCE

PRESENT

(Name)	(Designation)
1.	
2.	
3	
.	
4	
.	
5	
.	
6.	

ABSENT: (Name) (Designation)

- 1.
- 2.

1. CALL TO ORDER

<Title, First Name, Surname>, **REP Chairperson**, called this regular meeting to order at **<time>**.

2. DECLARATION OF QUORUM

A quorum was declared with the presence of **<number>** members, inclusive of the presence of **<number>** non-institutional and **<number>** non-scientist members, and as confirmed by the Member-Secretary, <Title, Name, Surname>.



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3. APPROVAL OF THE PROVISIONAL AGENDA

<Title, Surname of REP Chairperson> presided over the approval of the provisional agenda. The approval of the agenda was moved by <Title, Name, Surname> and seconded by <Title, Name, Surname>.

4. DISCLOSURE OF CONFLICT OF INTEREST

<Title, Surname of REP Chairperson >, called for disclosure of Conflict of Interest (COI) in the Study Protocols scheduled for deliberation in the meeting. The following member/s inhibited from participation in the panel deliberations during the full review meeting for the following reasons:

5. REVIEW AND APPROVAL OF THE MINUTES OF THE PREVIOUS MEETING

<Title, Surname of REP Chairperson > presided over the discussion of the minutes of the **(REP)** meeting held last <dd/mm/yyyy> **(Date of last meeting)**. The minutes were corrected during the discussion and approved as amended.

6. BUSINESS ARISING FROM THE MINUTES OF THE PREVIOUS MEETING

6.1. Administrative concerns

7. NEW BUSINESS

STUDY PROTOCOL REVIEW

7.1. FULL REVIEW OF NEW PROTOCOLS

Protocol Code:	
Title of Protocol:	
Principal Investigator:	
Institution:	
Submission date:	
Primary Reviewers:	



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Discussion/Comments:

(1) Scientific Soundness:

(2) Ethical Considerations

- Social Value
- Vulnerability issue
- Measures to protect vulnerable population

- Risk/benefit ratio

- Measures to mitigate risks

- Confidentiality and privacy

(3) Review of Informed Consent process, form and content

Summary of major discussion points:

Recommendations:

Decision:

7.2. REVIEW OF RESUBMISSIONS

Protocol Code:	
Title of Protocol:	
Principal Investigator:	

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Institution:	
Submission date:	
Primary Reviewers:	
Discussion/Comments/Recommendations:	
Decision:	

7.3. REVIEW OF POST-APPROVAL REPORTS SUBMISSIONS

Protocol Code:	
Title of Protocol:	
Principal Investigator:	
Institution:	
Date of Initial Ethical Clearance:	
Type of Post Approval Report (Indicate by highlighting the item)	<i>(Progress Report, Amendment, Protocol Deviation/Violation, Reportable Negative Events Report, SAE/SUSAR, Continuing Review, Final Report, Early Termination Report, Complaints and Queries)</i>

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Report submission date:	
Primary Reviewers:	
Discussion/Comments/Recommendations:	
Decision:	

7.4. REPORT ON APPROVED EXPEDITED REVIEW OF PROPOSALS

Protocol Code:	
Title of Protocol:	
Principal Investigator:	
Institution:	
Primary Reviewers:	
Submission Date:	
Decision:	
Approval date:	



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7.5. PROTOCOLS EXEMPTED FROM REVIEW (if any)

Protocol Code:	
Title of Protocol:	
Principal Investigator:	
Institution:	
Primary Reviewers:	
Submission Date:	
Decision:	
Approval date:	

7.6. REPORTS ON SITE VISITS

Protocol Code:	
Title of Protocol:	
Principal Investigator:	
Institution:	
Submission date:	



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Approval date:	
Date of Site Visit:	
Site Visit Team:	
Discussion/Comments/Recommendations:	
Decision:	

8. LNU-REC-OPERATIONS RELATED MATTERS

9. OTHER MATTERS

10. ADJOURNMENT

Meeting was adjourned at **<time>**

Prepared by: _____ Signature over <Title, Name,
Surname> DATE: <dd/mm/yyyy> REP MEMBER-SECRETARY

Approved by: _____ Signature over <Title, Name,
Surname> DATE: <dd/mm/yyyy> REP CHAIRPERSON

Moved for approval of minutes as corrected: <Title, Name, Surname>
Seconded by: <Title, Name, Surname>

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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE

Form 4.28.2

NOTICE OF RECEIPT OF PROTOCOL AND ASSESSMENT FOR REVIEW FEE
(Non-Institutional Electronic Submissions)

<dd/mm/yyyy>

<TITLE, NAME, SURNAME OF PI>

Principal Investigator

<Institution/Affiliation>

<Address>

Re: Protocol Title

Dear <TITLE OF PI> <SURNAME>:

Good day!

We would like to inform you that your protocol has been received by the Leyte Normal University Research Ethics Committee (LNU-REC) and has been classified for <EXPEDITED REVIEW/FULL BOARD REVIEW> scheduled to be reviewed on <date of full board meeting>. Your protocol has been assigned protocol code <LNU code> which should be used for all communication to the LNU-REC related to this study.

Protocol Code	
Protocol Title	
Date of Submission	
Type of Review	
Principal Investigator	
Review fee	

In line with this and with the LNU-REC SOP Manual, we would like to inform you that as per LNU-BOR Resolution No.1520, series of 2023, you are required to pay the Ethics Review Fees as indicated above accorded to an external research.

Kindly secure the charge slip from the Research Ethics Committee Office and submit a copy of the official receipt once settled.

Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the above, please contact the LNU-REC Office at _____ or email us at ethics@lnu.edu.ph.

Respectfully yours,

< Name and
Signature> REP
Chairperson

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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.28.3
 APPROVAL LETTER

Date: _____

This is to certify that the following protocol and related documents have been granted approval by the LNU-REC for implementation.

LNU-REC Protocol Code No.		Sponsor Protocol No.	
Principal Investigator/s		Sponsor	
Title			
Protocol Version No.		Version Date	
ICF Version No.		Version Date	
Other Documents			
Type of Review	☐ Expedited ☐ Full Board Meeting Date: _____	Duration of Approval (Date) From: _____ To: _____	Frequency of continuing review: _____

Investigator Responsibilities after Approval:

- Submit document amendments for REC approval before implementing them. No amendment in the protocol or ICF shall be implemented without the REC approval.
- Submit SAE and SUSAR reports to the REC within 2 days / 48 hours
- Submit Reportable Negative Events to the REC within 3 days
- Submit progress report every 6 months
- Submit final report not later than 1 month after end of the study
- Apply for continuing review at least 1 month before expiry of ethical clearance
- Report protocol deviation/ violation within 1 month from detection
- Comply with all relevant international and national guidelines and regulations
- PI to accommodate possible SITE VISIT
- Abide by the principles of ethical research practice.

Very truly yours,

< Name and Signature >
 REP Chairperson

Received by: <Name and Signature>

_____ Date:



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.28.3a
NOTIFICATION OF REP DECISION

Date:
To:
Contact No.:

This is to inform you of the REP decision related to your application for review of the following documents:

LNU-REC Protocol No.		Sponsor Protocol No.	
-------------------------	--	----------------------	--

Type of Submission:

- ☐ Initial Review
- ☐ Resubmission
- ☐ Amendment
- ☐ Post-Approval Reports

Documents

- Submitted 1.
2.
3.

Principal Investigator		Sponsor	
Title			
Protocol Version No.		Version Date	
ICF Version No.		Version Date	
Other Documents			

Type of Review:

- ☐ Expedited Meeting
- ☐ Full Board Meeting

REC Decision:

- ☐ Approved
- ☐ Minor Revisions Required
- ☐ Major Revisions Required
- ☐ More Information Required
- ☐ Disapproved



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Date: _____

REP Chairperson	Name	Signature	Date



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RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.28.3b
LETTER FOR MODIFICATION

DATE:

PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR

Dear _____,

We wish to inform you that the LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY - RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE reviewed your study protocol during its regular meeting <date> and is requesting further revisions. Your study has been assigned protocol code **<Protocol Code>** which should be used for all communication to the LNU-REC related to this study.

As a result of the review, committee **MAJOR MODIFICATIONS / MINOR MODIFICATIONS**.

REVIEWER'S COMMENTS	
STUDY PROTOCOL	
1.	
INFORMED CONSENT	
1.	

Note that the LNU-REC is requesting you to submit the following:

1. REVISED PROTOCOL/INFORMED CONSENT> and related documents in printed copies. Submit the electronic copy of all documents to ethics@lnu.edu.ph. Fill out the LNU-REC FORM 2.13.1: REVIEW OF RESUBMITTED PROTOCOL FORM with the first column filled-out with recommendations and the second column are the responses if the recommendations are met.
2. Modified part should be underlined and bold-faced with indicated page where the revisions were made; and
3. Include footer in all pages that indicates both the DATE and VERSION NUMBER of the resubmitted study protocol, ICF and other documents forming part of the protocol.

Please note that the cut-off date for submission of revised protocol is on **day of the month**. Also, please note that resubmission can only be accepted until **deadline of submission**. Failure to respond with the specified date will inactivate the application and study protocol will be archived. Subsequent submissions will be processed as initial review. Should you have any questions or



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clarifications regarding the above-mentioned recommendations, please contact the undersigned through the LNU-REC Staff Secretary.

The LNU – REC looks forward to your immediate response and action.

Very truly yours,

Name and Signature
Chairperson, Research Ethics Panel
Leyte Normal University



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.28.3c
LETTER OF EXEMPTION FROM ETHICAL REVIEW

DATE:

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:	
PROTOCOL TITLE	
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR	

Dear _____,

We wish to inform you that the Leyte Normal University-Research Ethics Committee (LNU-REC) has reviewed your protocol entitled, "*Study Protocol Title*" (LNU-REC code).

Upon review of the protocol, the LNU-REC deemed it appropriate that the above proposal be **EXEMPTED FROM ETHICAL REVIEW**. This means that the study may be implemented without undergoing an expedited or full review. Neither will the proponents be required to submit further documents to the committee as long as there is no amendment nor alteration in the protocol that will change the nature of the study nor the level of risk involved. The Research Ethics Panel (REP) must be provided with a copy of the Final Report not later than one (1) month after the end of the study.

Please note that any changes to the protocol must be brought to the notice of the REP prior to implementation. The REP will determine whether the requested protocol changes alter the risk-benefit analysis of the study, thereby requiring a change in exemption category. You may contact the LNU-REC office if you have any questions.

The LNU-REC recommended the commencement of archiving procedures and reclassified the protocol as **INACTIVE**. The protocol records will be made available for three (3) years from this date.

Very truly yours,
Name and
Signature
Chairperson, Research Ethics Panel
Leyte Normal University



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Tacloban City, Leyte, Philippines

RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE

Form 4.28.3d

REMINDER LETTER

(PROGRESS REPORT / CONTINUING REVIEW / FINAL REPORT)

DATE:

<dd/mm/yyyy>

<TITLE, NAME, SURNAME OF PI>

Principal Investigator

<Institution/Affiliation>

<Address>

LNU-REC Protocol Code	
Protocol Title	
Date of LNU-REC Approval	
Date of Expiry of Ethical Clearance	

Dear **<TITLE OF PI> <SURNAME>**:

We wish to remind you that the <progress/final/continuing review> report for the protocol **<Protocol Title> <LNU-REC Code>** is due on/had been due since *< every_from date of approval for progress report > / < 1 month after end of the study for final report > / < 1 month before expiry of ethical clearance for continuing review application >*. Based on the records of the **LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY- RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE (LNU-REC)**, there had been no communication regarding the progress of this study, which is still in our active file and has an active ethical clearance. Please be reminded that data collection can only continue with active ethical clearance.

If the study had been concluded, kindly fill out a final report form [*LNU-REC Form 3.22.1*]; or if still ongoing, a progress report form [*LNU-REC Form 3.15.1*] , or a continuing review application form [*LNU- REC Form 3.19.1*] in case of expiring or expired ethical clearance. Protocol non-compliance (deviation/violation) should also be reported, whether minor or major, at the soonest possible time up to one (1) month after the event, using the applicable form [*LNU-REC Form 3.16.1 Deviation/Non-Compliance/Violation Report*]. Forms may be requested from the LNU-REC staff.

Kindly submit the relevant report/form within thirty (30) days of receiving this letter. If no submission is received within the indicated grace period, the committee will be constrained to implement standard procedures for non- compliance with reportorial requirements and considered as protocol deviation. This may result in a recommendation for revocation of ethical clearance and the protocol file subsequently inactivated and archived.



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Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the above-mentioned recommendations, please contact the **LNU-REC** staff _____ or ethics@lnu.edu.ph.

Thank you.

Very truly yours,

Chairperson, Research Ethics Panel



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE

Form 4.28.4

RECEIPT AND RECOMMENDATION FOR FURTHER ACTION

<dd/mm/yy>

Principal

Investigator

<Institution/Affiliation>

<Address>

Re: <Protocol title><Protocol

code> Dear <TITLE OF

PI><SURNAME>

We wish to inform you that the LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY - RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE acknowledges receipt of <Progress Report/Continuing Review Application/Final report/Study Protocol Non-Compliance Record/SAE Report/Site Visit Report/etc.> dated <date of document>.

Upon review of <Progress Report/Continuing Review Application Form/Final Report Form/Study Protocol non-compliance Record/serious Adverse Event Report Form/site visit Report Form/etc.> and <submitted document/s>, LNU-REC action <REQUEST INFORMATION/RECOMMENDATION FOR FURTHER ACTION/>. Recommended revisions and/or classifications are summarized below:

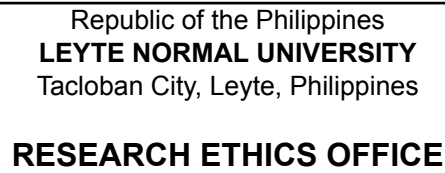
PROTOCOL TITLE:		LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:
PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR (PI):		DATE OF APPROVAL(Initial):
Documents Received:	Recommended Action:	DATE:

Please note that the cut-off date for submission is on <cut-off-date>. Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the above-mentioned recommendations, please contact the undersigned through the LNU-REC staff _____ or through ethics@lnu.edu.ph.

The LNU-REC looks forward to your immediate response and action.

Truly yours,

Chairperson, Research Ethics Panel



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.29.1a
 SUBMISSION LOG
 (Protocol-Related)

[illegible]



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RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.29.1b
 SUBMISSION LOG
 (Administrative-Related)

Date of Submission	Submitted by (Name)	Signature	Address	Telephone Number	Email	Received by (Name of REP contacted)	Signature	Content of Submission	Notation of any follow-up	Action	Remarks



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.29.2
Study Protocol Database

Protocol Code:
Principal Investigator:
Institution:
Funding Agency:
Type of Research:
Type of Review:
Date of Initial Submission:
Primary Reviewers:
Date of 1st Deliberation:
Decision on 1st Deliberation:
Date of Letter to PI on 1st Deliberation:
Date of Resubmission/s
Date of 2nd Deliberation:
Action Taken on 2nd Deliberation:
Date of Letter to PI on 2nd Deliberation
Date of Protocol Approval:
Date of Ethical Clearance Expiration:
PROGRESS REPORT
Progress Report:
Type of Review:



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Date of Deliberation:
Actions:
Date of Letter to PI:
AMENDMENT
Amendment:
Type of Review:
Date of Deliberation:
Actions:
Date of Letter to PI:
CONTINUING REVIEW
Continuing Review:
Type of Review:
Date of Deliberation:
Actions:
Date of Letter to PI:
Add other post-approval reports
Date of Final Report:
Status:
Remarks:
Submissions:



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.30.1
PROTOCOL INDEX

LNU-REC Protocol Code: _____

PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATORS: _____

SUBMISSIONS PRIOR TO REP APPROVAL

FILE	DATE RECEIVED
Checklist for Required Documents	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Application for Protocol Review	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Research Protocol	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Informed Consent Forms	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Notification to Primary Reviewers	PR 1: PR 2:
Study Protocol Assessment Forms	PR 1: PR 2:
Informed Consent Assessment Forms	PR 1: PR 2:
Approval/Decision Letter	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Resubmitted Documents (1 st)	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Review of Resubmitted Protocol Form	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Notification to Primary Reviewers	PR 1: PR 2:
Review of Resubmitted Protocol Forms	PR 1: PR 2:
Approval/Decision Letter	<dd-mm-yyyy>



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Resubmitted Documents (2 nd)	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Review of Resubmitted Protocol Form	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Notification to Primary Reviewers	PR 1: PR 2:
Review of Resubmitted Protocol Forms	PR 1: PR 2:
Approval/Decision Letter	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Resubmitted Documents (3 rd)	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Review of Resubmitted Protocol Form	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Notification to Primary Reviewers	PR 1: PR 2:
Review of Resubmitted Protocol Forms	PR 1: PR 2:
Approval/Decision Letter	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Withdrawal Application (if applicable)	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Other Documents(Specify)	<specific documents>

SUBMISSIONS AFTER REP APPROVAL

Package:	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Notification to Primary Reviewers	PR 1: PR 2:
Forms: 	PR 1: PR 2:
Notice of Panel Action	<dd-mm-yyyy>
Package:	<dd-mm-yyyy>



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LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY
Tacloban City, Leyte, Philippines

RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



Notification to Primary Reviewers

PR 1:

PR 2:

Forms:

PR 1:

PR 2:

Notice of Panel Action

<dd-mm-yyyy>

Package:

<dd-mm-yyyy>

Notification to Primary Reviewers

PR 1:

PR 2:

Forms:

PR 1:

PR 2:

Notice of Panel Action

<dd-mm-yyyy>

Package:

<dd-mm-yyyy>

Notification to Primary Reviewers

PR 1:

PR 2:

Forms:

PR 1:

PR 2:

Notice of Panel Action

<dd-mm-yyyy>

Package:

<dd-mm-yyyy>

Notification to Primary Reviewers

PR 1:

PR 2:

Forms:

PR 1:

PR 2:

Notice of Panel Action

<dd-mm-yyyy>

Package:

<dd-mm-yyyy>

Notification to Primary Reviewers

PR 1:



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RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



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Package:

Notification to Primary Reviewers

Forms:

Notice of Panel Action

PR 2:

PR 1:

PR 2:

<dd-mm-yyyy>

<dd-mm-yyyy>

PR 1:

PR 2:

PR 1:

PR 2:

<dd-mm-yyyy>

<dd-mm-yyyy>

PR 1:

PR 2:

PR 1:

PR 2:

<dd-mm-yyyy>

<dd-mm-yyyy>

PR 1:

PR 2:

PR 1:

PR 2:

<dd-mm-yyyy>



Republic of the Philippines
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Tacloban City, Leyte, Philippines

RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.31.1
ARCHIVING NOTIFICATION

<dd/mm/yyyy>

NAME OF PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR:
INSTITUTION/AFFILIATION:
ADDRESS:

We wish to inform you that the **LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY - RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE** has reviewed your protocol, with details as follows:

LNU-REC PROTOCOL CODE:
SUBMISSION DATE:
PROTOCOL TITLE:
Date of Notice of REP Decision <for approved or initial review if Inactive Protocol>
Date of Final / Early Termination Report < if Completed or Terminated Protocol >
REP Decision: APPROVED <for completed, terminated, approved protocols>
MAJOR MODIFICATION < for initial review with resubmission>
DATE OF ARCHIVING:
<i>(Instructions to REP Member-Secretary: Use template 1 for approved protocols and template 2 for protocols that are not yet approved and template 3 for completed or terminated protocols.)</i>
Template 1: The protocol is reclassified as INACTIVE and ethical clearance automatically EXPIRED . The protocol records will be made available for three (3) years from date of inactivation. Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the above-mentioned recommendations, please contact the undersigned through the REP Secretary _____or ethics@lnu.edu.ph
Template 2: The application for ethical review is reclassified as INACTIVE and study protocol will be ARCHIVED . Any subsequent submissions will be processed as initial review. The protocol records will be made available for three (3) years from date of inactivation. Should you have any questions



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or clarifications regarding the above-mentioned recommendations, please contact the undersigned through the REP Secretary __ or ethics@lnu.edu.ph.

Template 3:

The protocol is now considered **COMPLETED / TERMINATED** and ethical clearance automatically **EXPIRED**. The study protocol will be **ARCHIVED**. The protocol records will be made available for **three years** from date of inactivation. Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the above-mentioned recommendations, please contact the undersigned through the REP Secretary _____ or ethics@lnu.edu.ph.

<Name and Signature of REP Chairperson>



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RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.31. PAGE 2
REGISTER OF ARCHIVED PROTOCOLS

Date Archived	Protocol Number	Principal Investigator	Protocol Title	Date Disposed

Guide for Archiving:

Completed Protocols – upon receipt of Final Report

Terminated Protocols – upon receipt of Early Termination Report

Inactive Protocols – Approved but no communication within 1 year from issuance of Ethical Clearance

Inactive Protocols – Protocols with initial review but without resubmission or communication within 3 months from notice of REP action/decision.



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.31.3
REGISTER OF DISPOSED PROTOCOLS

Date of Disposal	Protocol Number	Principal Investigator	REP Member Witness	Signature of Witness	REP Staff	Signature of REP Staff

Guide for Disposal:

Inactive Protocols – three (3) years from date archiving

Completed Protocols – three (3) years from date of archiving

Terminated Protocols – three (3) years from date of archiving



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RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.32. PAGE 1
REQUEST TO ACCESS DOCUMENT

I, (Name, Surname) as a non-member of the **Leyte Normal University – Research Ethics Committee**, understand that the documents I am given access to by the **Leyte Normal University – Research Ethics Committee** are confidential. I shall use the information only for the purpose indicated in this form and shall not duplicate, give or distribute these documents to any person(s) without permission from the **Leyte Normal University – Research Ethics Committee**. Upon signing this form, I agree to take reasonable measures and full responsibility to keep the information confidential.

Name and Signature

Date

Received by:

Name and
Signature REP
Secretary

Date

Approved by:

Name and Signature
REP Chairperson/Member-Secretary

Date



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RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.32. PAGE 2
LOGBOOK OF REQUEST TO ACCESS

Name of Borrower	Protocol Number	Document Borrowed	Date Document Retrieved	Signature of Borrower	Date Document Returned	Signature of REP Staff



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.32.3
LOGBOOK OF REQUEST FOR COPIES OF DOCUMENTS

Title of Document	Name of Recipient	# of Copies	Reasons for the Request	Signature of Recipient	Initial of REP Secretary	Date Released



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RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE

Form 4.33. PAGE 1
QUERY/ COMPLAINT

Date received:		Received by:	
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Request from:	
☐ Telephone/Mobile Phone Number	_____
☐ Mailed letter / Date	_____
☐ E-mail / Date	_____
☐ Walk-in/Date/Time	_____
☐ Others, specify	_____

Name:	
-------	--

Contact Address:		Phone:	
------------------	--	--------	--

Title of the Study/Protocol:	
------------------------------	--

Starting date of participation (if a study participant):	
--	--

What are the concerns?	
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Action taken:	
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Outcome:	
----------	--

<Name and Signature>
<dd/mm/yy>
> Date



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RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE



LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
Form 4.33.2
QUERY/COMPLAINT RESPONSE

Dear <Name of Complainant>

We wish to inform you that the LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE has reviewed your filed <query / complaint > during its regular meeting <date of meeting>.

On the above stated <query / complaint>, please be advised of the following resolutions:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the above-mentioned resolution, please contact the undersigned through the REP Secretary _____ or through ethics@lnu.edu.ph.

Very truly yours,

<Name and
Signature> REP
Chairperson



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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 5.34. PAGE 1
REQUEST FOR REVISION OF AN SOP OR GUIDELINE

Please complete this form whenever a problem or a deficiency in an SOP is identified and submit to the LNU-REC for processing.

SOP or Guideline Code	SOP or Guideline TITLE
Reason for request (citing details of problems or deficiency in current document):	
Description of requested changes:	
Revision Requested by: (Name and signature)	Date: (dd/mm/yyyy)

REP Chairperson Comments:	
Recommendations by REP Chairperson ☐ Revision requirement affirmed, forward to REO Director ☐ Request further information (state)	
Signature	
Name of REP Chairperson	<Title, Name, Surname>
Date	<dd/mm/yyyy>

	Republic of the Philippines LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY Tacloban City, Leyte, Philippines RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE	
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LNU-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
FORM 5.34.2
SOP TEMPLATE

DOCUMENT NO.	LEYTE NORMAL UNIVERSITY-RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE		
	MANUAL TITLE	VERSION NO.	
	DOCUMENT NAME	APPROVAL DATE	
		EFFECTIVITY DATE	
		PAGE NO.	

1. POLICY STATEMENT
2. OBJECTIVE/S
3. SCOPE
4. WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY

5. DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF PROCEDURES
6. FORMS
7. HISTORY OF SOP



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Version No.	Date (mm/dd/yyyy)	Authors	Main Change
1			
2			
3			

8. REFERENCES